



Student Subject Handbook

HSC and IBDP

2026/2027 - YEAR 11 AND 12



ST ANDREW'S
CATHEDRAL SCHOOL

Contents

Foreword by the Head of School	3
From the Director of Learning Senior College	4
From the Director of Learning (IB Diploma Programme)	5
From the Head of Further Education and Career Development	6
Timeline for HSC and	7
IB Diploma Programme (IBDP)	7
The Higher School Certificate	9
Aboriginal Studies	13
Ancient History	15
Biology	17
Business Studies	19
Chemistry	21
Chinese Continuers	23
Christian Development	25
Design and Technology	27
Drama	29
Earth and Environmental Science	31
Economics	33
Engineering Studies	35
English Studies	37
English Standard	39
English Advanced	41
English Extension 1	43
English Extension 2	45
French Continuers	47
Geography	49
Health and Movement Science	51
History Extension	53
Industrial Technology – Timber and Furniture Technologies	55
Japanese Beginners	57
Legal Studies	59
Mathematics Standard 2	61
Mathematics Advanced	63
Mathematics Extension 1	65
Mathematics Extension 2	67
Modern History	69
Music 1	71
Music 2	73
Music Extension	75
Physics	77

Science Extension	79
Society and Culture	81
Software Engineering	83
Spanish Beginners	85
Spanish Continuers	87
Studies of Religion I	89
Visual Arts	91
External Language Courses - HSC	93
TVET Courses	94
The International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme	95
IB Mission Statement	96
The Diploma Programme	96
Creativity, Activity Service (CAS)	103
Extended Essay (EE)	104
Theory of Knowledge (TOK)	105
Language and Literature Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	106
Literature Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	108
Chinese B Standard Level (SL)	110
French B Standard Level (SL)	111
Japanese ab initio Standard Level (SL)	112
Spanish ab initio Standard Level (SL)	113
Spanish B Standard Level (SL)	114
Business Management	115
Standard & Higher Level	115
(SL & HL)	115
Global Politics Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	117
History Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	119
Philosophy Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	121
Psychology Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	123
Environmental Systems and Societies Standard Level (SL & HL)	125
Biology Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	127
Chemistry Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	129
Computer Science Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	131
Design Technology Higher Level (HL)	133
Physics Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	135
Sports, Exercise and Health Science Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	137
Mathematics: Analysis and Approaches Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	139
Mathematics: Applications and Interpretation Standard (SL)	141
Film Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	143
Music Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	145
Theatre Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	147
Visual Arts Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)	149
St Andrew's Cathedral School Outdoor Education OET / Year 13 and Sports Assistants positions	151
Sport and Cocurricular Activities	152

Foreword by the Head of School



Dear students and parents

As you look forward towards Years 11 and 12, 2026 and 2027, you have an important choice to make about which credential you will choose. I believe this choice is best made in conversation between students and parents, after full consideration of all the information presented, verbally and in writing. Both are good choices: the Higher School Certificate (HSC) is widely regarded as the strongest of the Australian State credentials (this is not just a 'home town' view), and has served as a model for the recently developed Senior Australian Curriculum. The International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme (IBDP) is taught all over the world and has widespread international recognition and acclaim in Australia and internationally. In that respect, either decision is a good decision.

Some students will be more suited to one credential than the other. Our intention is to provide the fullest possible advice in order to equip each family to make the best decision for them. The HSC is a well-known credential, although some parents may not realise the extent to which it has changed from 2001, with an array of new subjects and a restructure of courses and requirements (see within). The IB Diploma is growing exponentially at a rate of 20 – 25 per cent annually across the world. Either is perfectly acceptable for entry into Australian universities. For tertiary study, each will be commuted to an ATAR (Australian Tertiary Admission Rank), which is applicable to universities, both public and private, across the nation.

St Andrew's Cathedral School's position is that it will neither encourage nor discourage your choice of either curriculum in principle (both are excellent) but may well contextualise either to the needs and abilities of individual students. Typically, a normal pattern is that around 2/3rds of students choose the HSC and about 1/3rd the IB Diploma.

In order to give some baseline material with which to begin the choice process, the following might be helpful.

Our intention is to provide fulsome information to parents and students about the characteristics of both the Higher School Certificate and the International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme as credentials. We will also make extensive information on the actual subjects available. Students will be interviewed and advised by senior staff.

It is then up to families to agonise – I use the word deliberately – over which credential is the better one for them. It is in fact not uncommon over time for students from the same family to make different choices.

In past years, both the HSC and IB Diploma have seen St Andrew's students excel. I wish you good thinking!

Dr Julie McGonigle
Head of School
St Andrew's Cathedral School

From the Director of Learning Senior College



The HSC offers students a wide range of subject choices, allowing them to explore their interests and strengths, giving them flexibility in selecting subjects and enabling them to tailor their studies to suit individual career aspirations or academic interests. In the HSC, it is possible to specialise, as the only compulsory subject is English. Beyond that, should a student so wish, their entire course selection can be from the Humanities or from Maths/Science/Technology or any combination of subjects which the school offers. English, Mathematics, History, Music, Science and Languages are all made available by NESA at the Extension 1 level, with Mathematics and English also offered at an Extension 2 level.

Overall, the HSC is a rigorous academic program that challenges students intellectually and helps them develop critical thinking, problem-solving and analytical skills. It encourages self-motivation, time management and independent learning. The knowledge and skills gained through the HSC can have a lasting impact on personal and intellectual growth, regardless of future career paths.

Mrs Eleni Tatsis
Director of Learning (Senior College)

Higher School Certificate

The Higher School Certificate (HSC) is the highest educational award in New South Wales schools. It is awarded to students who successfully complete Years 11 and 12 in New South Wales. The HSC is an internationally recognised credential that provides a foundation for students entering tertiary study, vocational training or employment.

The HSC consists of two parts, the Preliminary Year (which concludes at the end of Term 3, 2026), and the HSC Year (which commences in Term 4, 2026). The Preliminary Year allows students to build the skills required for their HSC Year and as such no results are carried across to Year 12. Only the HSC Year is examinable. The HSC Year utilises a combination of internal assessments and external examinations which can provide students with a balanced and comprehensive assessment experience.

From the Director of Learning (IB Diploma Programme)



International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme (IBDP)

St Andrew's Cathedral School is an authorised IB World School, offering the International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme (IBDP) as one of the two options for senior study. The IB Diploma Programme, a globally recognised, two-year pre-university curriculum and credential offered by the International Baccalaureate (IB), is rigorous and comprehensive in scope, and provides students with breadth and depth of subject knowledge, as well as a truly holistic education. It is international in outlook and prepares students very well for tertiary study.

The Diploma Programme assumes a student who is conscientious, takes initiative, has good self-management skills, can organise and complete projects and has the ability to undertake some independent learning. In most subject areas, courses are examination based, the exceptions being Music, Theatre and Visual Arts, which do not have written examinations.

In the Diploma Programme, students must complete subjects in at least five of the six areas: Language and Literature, Language Acquisition, Individuals and Societies, Experimental Sciences, Mathematics and the Arts. The Group 6 Arts Group is the only subject which is optional. In the IBDP, St Andrew's

offers a very wide range of subject choices, which also allows some level of specialisation in one area. Students can study two first languages and receive a Bilingual Diploma, study two second languages (three languages in total), three humanities, three sciences and two arts subjects. With the exception of ab initio languages, all IB Diploma subjects can be pursued at the Higher Level. In practice, students must complete three Higher Level and three Standard Level courses.

To earn their IB Diploma, students are also required to complete the 3 core requirements. The Extended Essay (EE) requires students to prepare a 4000-word research essay on a topic of their choosing. Theory of Knowledge (TOK) engages students to reflect on the nature of knowledge focussing on evidence gathering in contemporary contexts. The third core area is Creativity, Activity, Service (CAS) where students can engage in a range of creative arts-based or creative thinking, physical and service-learning activities.

There is a direct conversion table from the IB score out of 45 to ATAR (Australia Tertiary Admissions Rank), which is known in advance. For further information, please click on the link under the heading "University Entry" found in the International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme section of this Handbook.

Through the Approaches to Teaching, all IB subjects are developed in local and global contexts, inquiry based, develop conceptual understanding, engender collaboration skills and are informed by assessment. The Approaches to Learning allow students to further develop and consolidate their thinking, communication, social, self-management and research skills. The IB Diploma Programme develops students as both independent and collaborative learners whilst also developing the intellectual, social, emotional and physical well-being of students and preparing them effectively for the world beyond St Andrew's.

Sharon Munro
*Director of Learning: Middle School and
International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme*

From the Head of Further Education and Career Development

Through the further education and career development program at St Andrew's in Years 10, 11 and 12, we endeavour to inform and accompany you towards reaching the best starting point for further study or training after Year 12. Your career prospects will emerge later.

With choosing courses (HSC or IBDP) and subjects for Years 11 and 12, there are three main things to consider:

1. Do you **like a subject** or the nature of a subject?

You need to carefully read the information provided about each subject and attend the subject sessions where you can ask questions about subjects.

2. Are you **good or reasonably good** at a subject already studied or in an area in which you are considering further study in Years 11 and 12?

Consider your current academic performance as well as strengths and weaknesses in particular subjects.

3. If you have some idea about possible further study and career interests, you need to explore what school subjects may be **prerequisites** for entry into certain tertiary programs. Mathematics (Advanced or Extension), Chemistry, Physics, Visual Arts and Music are typical prerequisites for certain tertiary courses. You also need to consider the level at which a subject is studied i.e. Advanced, Standard (HSC) or Higher Level or Standard Level (IBDP). This information will be provided by the Head of Further Education and Career Development.

If you are not sure what you want to study after Year 12, you should keep your options open and select a broad range of subjects.

Do not select subjects based on:

* Scaling – this is not static. Subjects don't scale; the performance of students in a subject influences the scaling of that subject. For more information: <https://www.uac.edu.au/media-centre/news/5-facts-about-scaling>

* Pressure from friends or classmates – select your subjects based on the 3 considerations listed earlier.

Head of Further Education and Career Development

Timeline for HSC and IB Diploma Programme (IBDP)

2025 (Year 10)



- Begin the process of identifying course of study and subjects that you would like to study in Years 11 and 12.
- Consider university pre-requisites and those subjects in which you have a proven record of success and those subjects you have enjoyed.



- Subject Selections for HSC and IBDP courses are done online, and web choices will be open from **Wednesday 18 June 2025**.
- Go to <https://my.edval.education/login> and enter login details which will be supplied



- Subject Selections will close on Sunday 22 June 2025 at 10pm



- Following Subject Selection, a review of preferences will take place.
- Students will be interviewed by the Directors of Learning and the Head of Careers and Pathways to discuss the appropriate courses, subjects and levels.
- If a course or combination of courses is not possible then the student will be notified, and other options explored.
- This process will take place throughout Term 3.

2026 (Year 11)



HSC

For a variety of reasons, students may wish to amend their subject choices. This should take place within the first five weeks of Term 1.

A change will not always be possible because:

- The option is now full.
- The option no longer exists because there was not enough interest.
- The new option clashes with existing choices.
- The new option raises concerns from the Head of Department.

Physics, Chemistry, Software Engineering and Engineering Studies:

- If a student chooses to study Physics, Chemistry, Software Engineering or Engineering Studies, they are required to study Mathematics Advanced or higher as a pre-requisite. If a request is subsequently made to change to Mathematics Standard after the end of the Year 11 course, students may no longer be eligible to study Physics, Chemistry, Software Engineering or Engineering Studies. An exception may be made if there is a willingness to engage a tutor to help with the Maths levels required for these subjects. Students will need to have a discussion with the Head of Science (Physics and Chemistry) or Head of TAS (Software Engineering/Engineering Studies) before approval to continue Physics, Chemistry, Software Engineering or Engineering Studies is given.

IB Diploma Programme:

For a variety of reasons, students may wish to amend their subject choices. Changing subjects completely should take place by the end of Week 5 in Term 1, Year 11.

A change will not always be possible because:

- The option is now full.
- The option no longer exists because there was not enough interest.
- The new option clashes with existing choices.
- The new option raises concerns from the Head of Department.
- The change does not satisfy the requirements for HL and SL subjects.

For all subject changes, students need to complete and submit a *Change of Subject Form*.

With the permission of Heads of Department and subject teachers, students may change from HL to SL, or SL to HL, within a subject.



The Higher School Certificate

St Andrew's Cathedral School offers the Higher School Certificate (HSC). The HSC is overseen by the NSW Education Standards Authority (NESA).

It is a two-year curriculum which culminates in external examinations at the end of Year 12.

Key features of the HSC are:

- it is an internationally recognised credential
- it provides a foundation for students entering tertiary study, vocational training or employment
- it provides rigour through external syllabus documents and external examinations.

The HSC is well-suited to students who:

- are seeking tertiary study at a university in Australia or overseas
- would like to undertake a more specialised programme of study, for example to specialise in Humanities or in Mathematics and Science. However, it is also possible to undertake a broad range of subjects as part of an HSC programme.

It is also an appropriate choice for students who wish to pursue vocational training once they complete school.

Course structure

Most courses offered for the Higher School Certificate have a 2 Unit Preliminary and a 2 Unit HSC component. Each unit requires approximately 60 hours of classroom study per year. Preliminary courses are studied in Terms 1, 2 and 3 of Year 11. HSC courses are studied in Term 4 of Year 11 and Terms 1, 2 and 3 of Year 12.

Most HSC extension courses are 1 Unit courses. Extension study is available in English, Mathematics, History, Music, and some Languages. Extension courses build on the content of the 2 Unit course and requires students to study beyond the 2 Unit course.

Course and study restrictions

The following restrictions that apply to students presenting for the Higher School Certificate Examination include:

- One course per subject

A candidate may not, in the same year, present for examinations in more than one course in the same subject. The only exception to this is extension courses.

- Prescribed texts, topics, projects and works

In some courses, candidates are not permitted to study or prepare any of the prescribed texts, topics, projects or works set for the year they will present the subject for the Higher School Certificate, until the course requirements for the Preliminary Course have been completed. The restrictions are specified in "HSC Prescribed Texts, Topics, Projects and Works".

- Science

Students may study 7 Units of Science. The following Science courses are available for study within these 7 Units:

- Biology
- Chemistry
- Earth and Environmental Science
- Physics
- Science Extension (Year 12 only)

Eligibility requirements for the HSC

To be eligible for the award of the HSC, students must:

- have completed Year 10 and
- have attended a government school, an accredited non-government school, a school outside NSW recognised by NESA or a TAFE NSW Institute and have completed All My Own Work (AMOW) or its equivalent and
- have demonstrated the Minimum Standard of literacy and numeracy and
- have satisfactorily completed courses that comprise the pattern of study required by NESA for the award of the HSC and
- undertake and make a serious attempt at the requisite HSC exams.

In addition, NESA requires the school to provide evidence that each student has:

- followed the course developed or endorsed by NESA and
- applied themselves with diligence and sustained effort to the set task and experiences provided in the course by the school and
- achieved some or all of the course outcomes.

HSC examination entries

Entries for Preliminary and HSC are completed early in the calendar year. Candidates will receive confirmation of their entry showing their personal details and the courses in which they are to be examined.

Students may not change the courses for which they have entered or add courses, after entries have closed. They may withdraw their entry or withdraw from a course.

Internal Assessments

In accordance with NESA requirements, the School has a comprehensive Policy on Internal Assessments for Preliminary and HSC Courses. Students will be issued with an Assessment Policy and Procedures Student Guide at the commencement of the Preliminary Course and the HSC Course. It is imperative that students are aware of the assessment requirements for each course and follow the procedures outlined in this booklet.

Assessment marks are intended to provide an indication of a student's abilities in a wider range of outcomes than can be measured in a single HSC Examination. It gives students credit for what they have achieved throughout their courses in addition to their final Examination Mark. Students will therefore have gained 50% of their HSC mark for a course from their HSC Assessments before they sit for the HSC Examination.

At the end of the Preliminary Course, students are awarded an A to E ROSA Grade for each course. Grades are defined through descriptors and are monitored by NESA.

At the end of the HSC Course, students receive a HSC mark for each course. The mark is linked to standards of performance and is a 50:50 combination of a student's external examination mark and their school-based assessment mark for each course.

Study requirements

English is the only compulsory HSC subject.

To be eligible for the award of the HSC you must satisfactorily complete at least 12 units in your Preliminary study pattern and at least 10 units in your HSC study pattern. Both study patterns must include:

- two units of a Board Developed course in English
- at least four more units of Board Developed Courses in English
- at least three courses of two or more units (which may be either Board Developed or Board Endorsed)

HSC results

A Higher School Certificate is awarded to students who have met all requirements set by NESA. Results of HSC courses satisfactorily completed appear on the Higher School Certificate Record of Achievement and on a Course Report. The following information is recorded for each Board Developed Course:

- The moderated Assessment Mark based on school-based assessment tasks.
- The Examination Mark awarded for the external examination.
- The HSC Mark – the average of the HSC Examination Mark and the School Assessment Mark.
- The Performance Band showing the level of achievement in a course.

This information will also be included in a Course Report that will be issued for each course completed.

This report will include descriptors for each Performance Band, which provide a description of what a student within that band typically knows, understands and can do.

Performance Bands in each 2 Unit Course will range from 1 to 6 as follows:

Band 1: Mark Range	0 – 49
Band 2: Mark Range	50 – 59
Band 3: Mark Range	60 – 69
Band 4: Mark Range	70 – 79
Band 5: Mark Range	80 – 89
Band 6: Mark Range	90 – 100

Australian Tertiary Admission Rank (ATAR)

The Universities Admission Centre (UAC) calculates an ATAR based on performance in the NSW Higher School Certificate, in order to determine the admission of candidates to degree or diploma programs. To be eligible for an ATAR you must satisfactorily complete:

- A minimum of 10 Units of Board Developed Courses (these are courses examined by NESA and eligible for ATAR calculation).
- These 10 Units must include at least four different subjects.
- Two of these 10 Units must include at least four different subjects
- Two of these 10 Units must include two Units of English

While ATARs are calculated for all ATAR-eligible students, only those students who indicate on their Students Online account that they wish to be notified of their ATAR will receive an ATAR Advice Notice from UAC.

Tertiary requirements

Courses offered at various tertiary institutions will sometimes require certain school subjects for entry to their courses. This can be presented as a pre-requisite, assumed knowledge or recommended studies.

Each institution will indicate what these are and the most reliable information for this will be available on their respective websites. The UAC website also contains information about this.

Changing subjects and courses

There is limited opportunity to change subjects once the timetable has been written and classes have been filled in Year 11. In some circumstances, changes may be possible by Week 5 of Term 1 in Year 11. No changes to subjects will be allowed after this period.

There may be rare cases in which a change of subject or credential is in the student's best interest. Such cases must be referred to the Director of Learning (Senior College) for consideration and approval.

Students wishing to transfer from IB to HSC:

- should do so as soon as possible. The transition deadline is before the last 2 weeks of Term 1
- should have had discussions with the Directors of Learning: IB Diploma and HSC, in order to change credentials
- should have comparable subjects, otherwise no change is possible
- can only move into HSC subjects if the classes have space
- must complete two assessment tasks in the Preliminary HSC Course
- must catch up on the missed Preliminary coursework in their own time. In some cases, parents will need to organise a private tutor to assist students in catching up with the course material. Teachers will only provide guidance towards relevant materials/coursework
- will be responsible for organising their own textbooks
- must have filled out the Request to Transfer from IB to HSC form

Disability Provisions

Disability Provisions will be granted by NESA, in accordance with their guidelines for external examinations for the Higher School Certificate.

For internal assessment tasks in Year 11, adjustments will be granted on a case-by-case basis for those students with a diagnosed disability. Adjustments will be provided to these students allowing them to be assessed on 'the same basis as their cohort. Documentation will need to be provided to the Head of Specialised Learning before a decision is made.

The process for applications for Disability Provisions in the HSC Examinations will begin in Term 4, of the Preliminary Year. Students will then be notified as early as possible when the application process begins. Provisions applied for will be granted for internal assessment tasks in Year 12 until the HSC Examination Disability Provisions are approved, after which time only those provisions approved by NESA will be provided.

Students who wish to apply for Disability Provisions should contact the Head of Specialised Learning in Term 4 of the Preliminary Year. Students will be provided with information of documentation and processes involved for their application.

Disability Provisions also apply to temporary and emergency-related disabilities. A typical example of an 'emergency' is where a student breaks their writing arm a week before an examination.

Students who become ill during an examination period may be eligible to make an Illness/Misadventure application rather than a Disability Provisions application.

HSC: All My Own Work

The HSC All My Own Work program is designed to help HSC students follow the principles and practices of good scholarship. This includes understanding and valuing ethical practices when locating and using information as part of their HSC studies.

This program has been developed as part of the NSW Government's Respect and Responsibility strategy and complements other approaches such as brochures for teachers, students and parents and strengthens student and teacher declarations for the HSC.

Students at St Andrew's complete the modules in this program in Year 10. Students who commence at St Andrew's in Year 11 will need to complete the program at the beginning of Year 11 or provide results to show that they have satisfactorily completed the program at their previous school. A student cannot commence their studies in Year 11 without the satisfactory completion of this unit of work.

Minimum Standards

Students need reading, writing and numeracy for everyday life after school. Therefore, students in NSW are being supported to meet a minimum standard of literacy and numeracy in order to be eligible to receive the HSC. To show they meet the HSC Minimum Standard, students need to achieve Level 3 or 4 in short online reading, writing and numeracy tests of skills for everyday life. Some students with a disability studying Life Skills courses may be exempt from meeting the minimum standard to receive their HSC credential.

HSC Pathways

Most students follow a two-year program of studies in Year 11 and 12 leading to the award of the HSC. NESA also provides access for those people who wish to combine their studies with employment or other responsibilities/activities. This is called a “Pathways” approach, and the Pathways provisions are as follows:

- Accumulation

Students may accumulate the HSC over a period of up to five years, commencing in the first year the student completes a HSC Course.

- Repeating courses

Students may repeat one or more HSC Courses but must do so within a five-year period. The most recent mark in a course is used to calculate the Australian Tertiary Admission Rank (ATAR).

- Recognition of prior learning

Credit transfer may be granted where a student is able to show that they have achieved the same syllabus outcomes in another way, e.g. overseas study.

- Acceleration

Students may have the opportunity to progress through their study requirements at a faster rate than usual by completing the course content in a shorter time and accumulating the results.

HSC Curriculum

Students entering Years 11 and 12 have a wide range of subjects from which to choose and as far as possible, the courses are arranged and timetabled to meet the needs and preferences of the students.

In past years, the timetable has consistently allowed more than 96% of students to be accommodated with all of their subject choices.

The following information provides broad descriptions of the courses available for study and should be helpful to students as they select the courses they wish to study for the Higher School Certificate.

The School reserves the right to vary the suite of courses offered, the content areas of the courses and the methods of assessment.

Courses will only be offered if sufficient interest is shown, if there is a teacher with the necessary qualifications and if timetabling parameters allow.

Aboriginal Studies

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course	N/A	N/A

Course Description

Aboriginal Studies offers an exciting and unique experience all students. Aboriginal students are provided with the opportunity for cultural affirmation and positive educational experiences while non-Aboriginal students 'learn together' with Aboriginal peoples and communities.

Aboriginal Studies is designed to foster intellectual, social and moral development by enabling students to think critically about the historical and contemporary experiences of Aboriginal peoples and other Indigenous peoples from across the world.

Through this study, students will develop a heightened understanding and appreciation of the concepts of social justice and shared histories and will critically examine their role as active and informed citizens.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Part I – Aboriginality and the Land
- Part II – Heritage and Identity
- Part III – International Case Study: The Māori People of New Zealand
- Part IV – Research and Inquiry Methods: Local Community Case Study

HSC Course (Year 12)

- Part I – Social Justice and Human Rights Issues
- Part II – Comparative Community Case Study
- Part III – Aboriginality and the Land or Heritage and Identity
- Part IV – Research and Inquiry Methods: Major Project

Course Requirements

Preliminary Course: 120 hours

HSC Course :120 hours

Case Studies

Major Project (Year 12)

Aboriginal Studies (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
<i>External Examination</i>	100
HSC Examination	
<i>Internal Assessment</i>	100
Research Study	10
Major Project	40
Aboriginal Community Study	20
Trial HSC Examination	30

Ancient History

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course		

Course Description

Ancient History allows students to study and analyse past societies with the benefit of being separated from it by at least two thousand years. By studying literary works, coins, inscriptions, art, architecture, artefacts and human remains, students piece together their view of the past. The relatively small amount of surviving evidence means students are able to consider the evidence in its entirety and make their own interpretation, which they can compare with the conclusions of published historians.

In the Preliminary Course, students also complete a number of case studies, which bring to life the ancient world and allow students to build up a picture of the people, events and beliefs that shaped particular societies. Some case studies include the study of the historically controversial figure Boudicca, the mystery of Masada, the experience of ancient Greek and Roman women, and the nature of Persian kingship.

In the HSC Course, students of Ancient History study the cities of Pompeii and Herculaneum that for centuries lay buried by the eruption of Mt Vesuvius. They also examine the life and time of an ancient personality such as Agrippina the Younger. A further investigation into the ancient Greek city-state of Sparta OR New Kingdom Egypt society during the Ramesside period is greatly enriching. Students also analyse in depth the events of a specific historical period and are required to make a judgement as to how and why these events took place.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Part I: Investigating Ancient Sites and Sources
- Part II: Case Study – Boudicca
- Part III: Women in Ancient Greece and Rome
- Part III: Case Study – Masada
- Part IV: Power and Image in Ancient Persia and Rome

HSC Course (Year 12)

- Part I: Core – Cities of Vesuvius
- Part II: Period – Rome in the Julio-Claudian Period
- Part III: Personality – Agrippina the Younger
- Part IV: Society – Sparta OR New Kingdom Egypt during the Ramesside period

Course Requirements

N/A

Ancient History (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
<i>A three-hour written examination consisting of:</i>	
Part I: Core – Cities of Vesuvius (Source-based, short answers)	25
Part II: Society – Sparta OR New Kingdom Egypt (Knowledge-based, short answers)	25
Part III: Personality – Agrippina (Two longer responses)	25
Part IV: Period – Julio-Claudian Rome (Extended Response)	25
Internal Assessment	100
• A maximum of 4 assessment tasks • A minimum weighting of 10% for each task • A maximum weighting of 40% for a task • Only one task may be a formal written examination with a maximum weighting of 30% • One task may be an Historical Analysis with a weighting of 20-30%	

Biology

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course		

Course Description

The Biology Stage 6 Syllabus explores the diversity of life from a molecular to a biological systems level. The course examines the interactions between living things and the environments in which they live. It explores the application of biology and its significance in finding solutions to health and sustainability issues in a changing world.

Biology uses Working Scientifically processes to develop scientific investigative skills. It focuses on developing problem-solving and critical thinking skills in order to understand and support the natural environment. When Working Scientifically, students are provided with opportunities to design and conduct biological investigations both individually and collaboratively.

The study of Biology, which is often undertaken in interdisciplinary teams, complements the study of other science disciplines and other STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics) related courses. Through the analysis of qualitative and quantitative data, students are encouraged to solve problems and apply knowledge of biological interactions that relate to a variety of fields.

The Biology course builds on the knowledge and skills of the study of living things found in the Science Stage 5 course. The course maintains a practical emphasis in the delivery of the course content and engages with the technologies that assist in investigating current and future biological applications.

The course provides the foundation knowledge and skills required to study Biology after completing school and supports participation in a range of careers in Biology and related interdisciplinary industries. It is a fundamental discipline that focuses on personal and public health and sustainability issues and promotes an appreciation for the diversity of life on the Earth and its habitats.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Module 1: Cells as the Basis of Life
- Module 2: Organisation of Living Things
- Module 3: Biological Diversity
- Module 4: Ecosystem Dynamics

HSC Course (Year 12)

- Module 5: Heredity
- Module 6: Genetic Change
- Module 7: Infectious Disease
- Module 8: Non-infectious Disease and Disorders

Course Requirements

N/A

Biology (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
The examination will consist of a written paper worth 100 marks. The time allowed is 3 hours plus 5 minutes reading time. NESA approved calculators may be used. There will be approximately equal weighting given to Modules 5 to 8. Questions relating to Working Scientifically Skills will be integrated throughout the examination. The paper will consist of two sections.	
Section I	20
There will be objective-response questions to the value of 20 marks.	
Section II	80
Questions may contain parts. There will be 20 to 25 items. At least two items will be worth 7 to 9 marks. <i>The examination will consist of a written paper worth 100 marks.</i> <i>Time allowed: 3 hours plus 5 minutes reading time.</i>	
Internal Assessment	100
• A maximum of four assessment tasks • All individual tasks have a weighting between 10 and 40 percent. • One task may be a formal written examination with a maximum weighting of 30% • One of the tasks will be based on a depth study worth somewhere between 20–40%	

Business Studies

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units of each Preliminary and HSC Board Development Course		

Course Description

Business activity is a feature of everyone's life. The Business Studies syllabus encompasses the theoretical and practical aspects of business in ways students will encounter throughout their lives. It offers learning from the planning of a small business to the management of operations, marketing, finance and human resource in large businesses.

Contemporary business issues and case studies are embedded in the course to provide a stimulating and relevant framework for students to apply to problems encountered in the business environment. Business Studies fosters intellectual, social and moral development by assisting students to think critically about the role of business and its ethical responsibilities to society.

By completing this course, students will develop general and specific skills, including research, analysis, problem-solving, decision-making, critical thinking and communication. These skills enhance their confidence and ability to participate effectively, not only as members of the business world, but also as citizens dealing with issues emanating from business activity.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Nature of Business – the role and nature of business
- Business Management – the nature and responsibilities of Management
- Business Planning – establishing and planning a small to medium enterprise.

HSC Course (Year 12)

- Operations – strategies for effective operations management
- Marketing – development and implementation of successful marketing strategies
- Finance – financial information in the planning and management of business
- Human Resources – human resource management and business performance

Course Requirements

N/A

Business Studies (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
<i>HSC Examination - A three hour written examination:</i>	
Multiple-choice	20
Short answer	40
Stimulus-based extended response	20
Extended responses	20
Internal Assessment	100
Knowledge and understanding of course content	40
Stimulus-based skills	20
Inquiry and research	20
Communication of business information, ideas and issues in appropriate forms	20

Chemistry

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units of each Preliminary and HSC Board Development Course	Mathematics Advanced or higher Achieved MYP Grade 5, including a minimum of a 5 in Criterion B and C in Year 10 results	

Course Description

The Chemistry Stage 6 Syllabus explores the structure, composition and reactions of and between all elements, compounds and mixtures that exist in the Universe. The discovery and synthesis of new compounds, the monitoring of elements and compounds in the environment, and an understanding of industrial processes and their applications to life processes are central to human progress and our ability to develop future industries and sustainability.

The course further develops an understanding of chemistry through the application of Working Scientifically skills. It focuses on the exploration of models, understanding of theories and laws, and examination of the interconnectedness between seemingly dissimilar phenomena.

Chemistry involves using differing scales, specialised representations, explanations, predictions and creativity, especially in the development and pursuit of new materials. It requires students to use their imagination to visualise the dynamic, minuscule world of atoms in order to gain a better understanding of how chemicals interact.

The Chemistry course builds on students' knowledge and skills developed in the Science Stage 5 course and increases their understanding of chemistry as a foundation for undertaking investigations in a wide range of Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM) related fields. A knowledge and understanding of Chemistry is often the unifying link between interdisciplinary studies.

The course provides the foundation knowledge and skills required to study Chemistry after completing school and supports participation in a range of careers in Chemistry and related interdisciplinary industries. It is an essential discipline that currently addresses and will continue to address our energy needs and uses, the development of new materials, and sustainability issues as they arise.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

Working Scientifically Skills

Core Modules

- Module 1: Properties and Structure of Matter
- Module 2: Introduction to Quantitative Chemistry
- Module 3: Reactive Chemistry
- Module 4: Drivers of Reactions

HSC Course (Year 12)

Working Scientifically Skills

Core Modules

- Module 5: Equilibrium and Acid Reactions
- Module 6: Acid/Base Reactions
- Module 7: Organic Chemistry
- Module 8: Applying Chemical Ideas

Course Requirements

N/A

Chemistry (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Section 1 – Objective Response Questions	20
Section II – Questions may contain parts There will be 20 to 25 items. At least two items will be worth 7 to 9 marks. <i>The examination will consist of a written paper worth 100 marks. Time allowed: 3 hours plus 5 minutes reading time.</i>	80
Internal Assessment	100
• A maximum of 4 assessment tasks • All individual tasks have a weighting between 10% and 40% for each task • One task may be a formal written examination with a maximum weighting of 30% • One of the tasks will be based on a depth study worth somewhere between 20%-40%	

Chinese Continuers

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✓ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course	Student will need to have studied Chinese in Stage 4 and 5	Students who have more than one year's formal education from the first year of primary education (Year 1) in a school where Chinese is the medium of instruction, or students who have had more than three years residency in a country where Chinese is the medium of communication should not undertake the Continuers course.

Course Description		
The study of the Chinese language is of particular importance to Australians, both culturally and economically. Chinese is a significant world language, one of the official languages of the United Nations and is spoken by about a quarter of the world's population. The People's Republic of China has a significant profile in economic, political and cultural developments globally and, in particular, has a major influence on the nations of the Asia-Pacific. Australia	now has a strong connection through trade, political and cultural contacts with both the People's Republic of China and other nations where Chinese communities are important contributors to their growth and diversity. The study of Chinese contributes to the overall education of students, particularly in the areas of communication, cross-cultural understanding, literacy and general	knowledge. Students can gain access to the language and the rich cultural traditions of China, as well as an understanding of different attitudes and values within the wider Australian community and beyond. The study of Chinese enhances enjoyment and appreciation of Chinese culture through film, literature, music, cuisine and sport.
Main Topics Covered		
Prescribed Themes • The Individual • The Chinese-Speaking Communities • The Changing World	Prescribed Topics • Personal Identity • Education and Aspirations • Recreation and Leisure • Travel Experiences • History and Culture • Lifestyles • Youth Issues • The World of Work • Tourism and Hospitality	The course is studied throughout Years 11 and 12. There are three main prescribed themes with topics and sub-topics in the syllabus and a range of grammar points that should be covered. Grammar points can be studied at any time during the two-year course. Indeed, as learning a language is a constant process, themes, topics and grammar points may be revisited, allowing students to improve their usage and understanding of Chinese.
Course Requirements		
Students will be required to complete an Eligibility Statement prior to commencing the course.		

Chinese Continuers (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Listening	30
Reading	30
Writing	20
Speaking	20

Students interested in taking a language at Extension level in Year 12 must contact Head of Languages to obtain further information.

Christian Development

Course Description

As a Christian School, St Andrew's Cathedral School has a responsibility to provide students with a framework in which to understand and reflect upon the Christian faith and its implications for daily life. The Senior Christian Development course presents an opportunity to examine the world in which we live today from a Christian perspective and to consider the claims of Jesus through two options: the first option is to undertake Studies of Religion 1 (see the 'Studies of Religion' entry in this Handbook for more information); the second option is doing Christian Development.

In Year 11 Christian Development, students study a selection of topics such as theology, ethics, apologetics and history, discussing views and practical implications of religion in daily life. In Year 12 Christian Development, students continue to engage with a range of topics including theology, ethics, apologetics and history. Students also consider the topics of identity, stories and relationships, reflecting on questions such as: What are our loves? Who am I? What does our Western world believe today? How have Christian beliefs shaped people's lives and our modern world? What do I believe?

Ultimately, the course is designed to provide students with the opportunity to consider the claims of Jesus and the tools to make considered and personal decisions regarding mature faith. These classes are compulsory and are supplemented by Chapels, volunteer Christian Groups, seminars with visiting speakers, camps and the life and witness of Christians within the School community. Only one option will need to be undertaken through the two years (Studies of Religion I or Christian Development).

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

In Year 11, the Christian Development course will offer two options. The first option is aligned with HSC Studies of Religion I. The second option is Christian Development.

- Option 1: Studies of Religion I (See 'Studies of Religion' entry)
- Option 2: Christian Development potential topics: theology, ethics, apologetics and history

HSC Course (Year 12)

In Year 12, students will either continue Studies of Religion into their final HSC year or will take Christian Development. Students who elect to drop Studies of Religion will be placed in a Christian Development class.

- Option 1: Studies of Religion I (See 'Studies of Religion' entry)
- Option 2: Christian Development potential topics: identity, stories, relationships, theology, ethics, apologetics and history.

Course Requirements

N/A

Christian Development (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)
Assessment Component
CD – Class sizes are intended to facilitate discussion and interaction appropriate to the nature of the course. There are no formal assessment tasks in Years 11 and 12 Christian Development.

Design and Technology

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units of each Preliminary and HSC Board Development Course	Studying Design and Technology in Years 9 and 10 and an average MYP grade of 5 or higher in Year 10.	

Course Description

The Design and Technology course is for students who enjoy high order problem solving. There are practical elements requiring students to design and make artefacts as part of the problem-solving process, but the main thrust of the course will be addressed by work on computers using a variety of programs to research and develop solutions to problems. Students will make projects as part of the confirmation of the validity of solutions.

The Preliminary Course will develop skills and knowledge to be further enhanced in the HSC Course. Two design projects will be completed. Each project will place emphasis on the development of the skills and knowledge used in designing and producing.

To achieve the course outcomes, students will participate in hands-on, practical activities. Class work will

develop knowledge and skills in designing and producing. Students will study the activities within industrial and commercial settings that support Design and Technology and relate these processes to the processes used in their own design activities. This involves extensive reading, writing and reporting. A strong background in these skills is essential.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Knowledge and understanding about design theory and design processes.
- Knowledge, understanding and appreciation of the interrelationship of design, technology, society and the environment.
- Creativity and an understanding of innovation and entrepreneurial activity in a range of contexts
- Skills in the application of design processes to design, produce and evaluate quality design projects that satisfy identified needs and opportunities.
- Skills in research, communication and management in design and production
- Knowledge and understanding about current and emerging technologies

HSC Course (Year 12)

The HSC Course includes the following requirements to be completed over 120 hours:

- The development and realisation of a major design project
- A case study of an innovation including related knowledge requirements.

The major design project involves students selecting and applying appropriate design, production and evaluation skills to a product system or environment, which satisfies an identified need or opportunity. The objective is to apply the skills developed in the preliminary course. Students relate techniques and technologies used in commercial and industrial settings to those used in the development of their major design project.

The case study involves the critical analysis of an innovation. Students conduct a detailed study of an

innovation so that they are able to identify the factors underlying its success; analyse the ethical issues in relation to the innovation; and discuss the impact of the innovation on Australian society. These processes may then be applied during development of the major design project.

Project Budgeting

The TAS department aims to provide what it can in Year 11, however as students design and create such a diverse range of products there is an expectation that students will order and purchase specific materials or components needed in Year 11. In Year 12, there is a NESA project management requirement for students to budget and purchase resources for their major project, this cost on average is \$500.

Subject specific laptop

There is a cost of \$200 per year for a subject specific laptop. This device will be able to handle complex modelling and photo realistic rendering.

Course Requirements

There is an entry requirement of an MYP grade of 5 or higher in Design and Technology in Year 10. Students need a good working knowledge of SolidWorks.

Design and Technology (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
<i>External Examination</i>	<i>100</i>
• A written paper worth 40 marks taking 90 minutes • A major design project worth 60 marks • Each student will undertake, on an individual basis, a major design project for submission. This is to include the practical hands-on activity of carrying the project through to realisation and the documentation, in a folio, of all the steps involved in the process. • The project is to be a product, a system, or an environment.	
<i>Internal Assessment</i>	<i>100</i>
• Proposal Presentation • Innovation and Emerging Technologies Case Study • Trial Examination • Project Development	

Drama

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units of each Preliminary and HSC Board Development Course		

Course Description

Drama is an art form that explores the world through enactment. It is a collaborative activity that involves the creative interaction of individuals using a range of artistic skills. 2 Unit Drama is an academically rigorous subject, which explores theory through practice and analysis.

By studying this major art form, students acquire skills in interpretation, communication, performance, and critical analysis while becoming aware

of the technical processes and technologies that may be used to heighten dramatic presentations. Drama will develop the physical, emotional, intellectual, social, spiritual, creative and expressive capacities of all students — as well as developing self-confidence and self-esteem.

The Preliminary Drama Syllabus makes no presumption that students have previously studied Drama. There are many opportunities for performance of

both original and text-based work. Assessment tasks are both individual and group based.

The School's city location allows regular visits to the theatre. We encourage our students to audition for our annual productions and to get involved in interschool activities such as Theatresports and the technical aspects of both theatre production and mixed media presentation.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Improvisation, Playbuilding & Acting
- Elements of Production in Performance
- Theatrical Traditions & Performance Styles Stanislavski and Realism - monologues
- Creating original works exploring Non-Realist theatrical conventions and techniques - group performance
- Theatre design in set, costume or poster/promotions – design task

HSC Course (Year 12)

Australian Drama & Theatre - aspects of Australian Theatre with research, workshopping and devised performance based around text.

Studies in Drama & Theatre - exploring in theory and practice, key theatrical figures from the twentieth century such as Boal from South America and Lecoq from France.

Group Performance - three to six students create, refine and perform a short piece of original theatre.

It provides opportunity for each student to demonstrate their performance skills. Individual Project - students choose between:

- Critical Analysis: applied research, theatre reviews or director's folio
- Design: costume, lighting, promotion and program, set
- Performance: a solo piece
- Scriptwriting
- Video Drama

Course Requirements

N/A

Drama (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
<i>External Examination</i>	<i>100</i>
Group Performance	30
Individual Project	30
Australian Drama & Theatre Essay	20
Studies in Drama & Theatre Essay	20
<i>Internal Assessment</i>	<i>100</i>
Making	40
Performing	30
Critically Studying	30

Earth and Environmental Science

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units of each Preliminary and HSC Board Development Course		

Course Description

The Earth and Environmental Science Stage 6 Syllabus explores the Earth's renewable and non-renewable resources and also environmental issues. An understanding of the Earth's resources and the ability to live sustainably on the planet is a central purpose of the study of Earth and Environmental Science.

The course uses the Working Scientifically skills to develop knowledge through the application of those skills. Students engage with inquiry questions to explore knowledge of the Earth. They also undertake practical and secondary-sourced investigations to acquire a deeper understanding of the Earth's features and naturally occurring phenomena and cycles. Fieldwork is an integral part of these investigation processes.

Earth and Environmental Science involves the analysis, processing and evaluation of qualitative and quantitative data in order to formulate explanations and solve problems. In conjunction with knowledge and understanding, communication skills are essential in forming evidence-based conclusions or arguments.

The Earth and Environmental Science course builds on the knowledge and skills of Earth and Space gained in the Science Stage 5 course. The course maintains a practical emphasis in the delivery of the course content and engages with technologies that assist in developing Earth and Environmental Science applications.

The course provides the foundation knowledge and skills required to study Earth and Environmental Science after completing school and supports participation in careers in a range of related industries. The application of Earth and Environmental Science is essential in addressing current and future environmental issues and challenges. It is also necessary for the use and management of geological resources that are important to Australia's sustainable future.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

Working Scientifically Skills

Core Modules

- Module 1: Earth's Resources
- Module 2: Plate Tectonics
- Module 3: Energy Transformations
- Module 4: Human Impacts

HSC Course (Year 12)

Working Scientifically Skills

Core Modules

- Module 1: Earth's Processes
- Module 2: Hazards
- Module 3: Climate Science
- Module 4: Resource Management

Course Requirements

N/A

Earth and Environmental Science (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
The examination will consist of a written paper worth 100 marks. The time allowed is 3 hours plus 5 minutes reading time. NESA approved calculators may be used. There will be approximately equal weighting given to Modules 5 to 8. Questions relating to Working Scientifically Skills will be integrated throughout the examination. The paper will consist of two sections.	
Section I	20
There will be objective-response questions to the value of 20 marks.	
Section II	80
Questions may contain parts. There will be 20 to 25 items At least two items will be worth 7 to 9 marks.	
Internal Assessment	100
• A maximum of 4 assessment tasks • All individual tasks have a weighting between 10% and 40% for each task • One task may be a formal written examination with a maximum weighting of 30% • One of the tasks will be based on a depth study worth somewhere between 20%-40%	

Economics

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units of each Preliminary and HSC Board Development Course		

Course Description

Economics provides understanding for students about many aspects of the economy and its operation that are frequently reported in the media. It investigates issues such as why unemployment or inflation rates change and how these changes will impact on individuals in society.

Economics develops students' knowledge and understanding of the operation of the global and Australian economy. It develops the analytical, problem solving and communication skills of students. There is a strong emphasis on the problems and issues in a contemporary Australian economic context within the course.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Introduction to Economics – the nature of economics and the operation of an economy
- Consumers and Business – the role of consumers and business in the economy
- Markets – the role of markets, demand, supply and competition
- Labour Markets – the workforce and the role of labour in the economy
- Financial Markets – the financial market in Australia including the share market
- Government in the Economy – the role of government in the Australian economy

HSC Course (Year 12)

- The Global Economy – features of the global economy and globalisation
- Australia's Place in the Global Economy – Australia's trade and financial performance
- Economic Issues – issues including growth, unemployment, inflation, external stability, distribution of income and wealth, and environmental management
- Economic Policies and Management – the range of policies to manage the economy

Course Requirements

N/A

Economics (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
<i>External Assessment</i>	<i>100</i>
A three-hour written examination, including multiple-choice, short answer and extended response questions	100
<i>Internal Assessment</i>	<i>100</i>
Knowledge and understanding of course content	40
Stimulus-based skills	20
Inquiry and research	20
Communication of economic information, ideas and issues in appropriate forms	20

Engineering Studies

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units of each Preliminary and HSC Board Development Course	Mathematics Advanced	

Course Description

Both Preliminary and HSC Courses offer students' knowledge, understanding and skills in aspects of engineering that include communication, engineering mechanics/hydraulics, engineering materials, historical/societal influences, engineering electricity/electronics and the scope of the profession.

Students study engineering by investigating a range of applications and fields of engineering.

Each focus module within both the Preliminary and HSC Courses, are further broken into; Analysis, Materials, Drawing, Graphics and Historical Development.

Engineering Studies is essentially a theoretical based subject and is best suited to those students undertaking higher level Mathematics and Physics.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

Students undertake the study of four compulsory modules:

- Three application modules based on engineering concepts and impacts through the study of engineering products. Engineering concepts and impacts are studied in each of the following categories: Engineering fundamentals, engineering products and braking systems
- One focus module relating to the field of Biomedical Engineering

HSC Course (Year 12)

Students undertake the study of four compulsory modules:

- Two application modules relating to the fields of Civil Structures and Personal and Public Transport
- Two focus modules relating to the fields of Aeronautical Engineering and Telecommunications Engineering

Course Requirements

Engineering Report:

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

Students are required to produce a component of an engineering report in Engineering Application Module 3, Braking systems and then a complete engineering report in Engineering Focus Module 4, Biomedical Engineering.

HSC Course (Year 12)

Students are required to produce **one** engineering report from either of the two engineering application modules and **one** from either of the two engineering focus modules.

One engineering report from the Preliminary Course and one engineering report from the HSC Course must be the result of collaborative work, reflecting the importance of teamwork for successful engineering projects.

Engineering Studies (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
<i>External Examination</i>	<i>100</i>
A three-hour written examination, including multiple-choice, short answer and extended response questions	100
<i>Internal Assessment</i>	<i>100</i>
Knowledge and understanding of course content	40
Stimulus-based skills	20
Inquiry and research	20
Communication of economic information, ideas and issues in appropriate forms	20

English Studies

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course	Students must have the approval of the Head of English before applying for this course	

Course Description

This course is designed to meet the specific needs of students who wish to refine their skills and knowledge in English and consolidate their literacy skills. The English Studies course provides students with opportunities to become competent, confident and engaged communicators and to study and enjoy a breadth and variety of texts.

Students explore the ideas, values, language forms, features and structures of texts in a range of personal, social, cultural, academic, community and workplace contexts.

Through responding to and composing texts, students strengthen their ability to access and comprehend information, assess its reliability, and synthesise the knowledge gained from a range of sources for a variety of purposes.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- In the English Studies Year 11 course, students study the mandatory module, *Reading to write: Transition to English Studies* to develop an understanding of, and practical competence in, the use of language that can be applied in a variety of contexts.
- Students study two to three additional elective focus areas (selected based on their needs and interests).

HSC Course (Year 12)

The HSC Common Content consists of two modules, *Narrative and Human Experiences* where students analyse and explore texts and apply skills in synthesis; and *Writing for Purpose* where students develop their skills at writing for particular audiences, purposes and contexts.

- Students study two additional elective focus areas (selected based on their needs and interests).

Course Requirements

N/A

English Studies (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Paper 1 – 2 hours writing and 10 minutes reading time	
Section 1: Narrative and human experience (short answer questions)	15 marks
Section 2: Narrative and human experiences (extended response based on prescribed text)	15 Marks
Section 3: Writing for a purpose (2-3 items, including informative, analytical, imaginative or persuasive responses)	30 marks
HSC Requirements Students can sit for an optional HSC examination and will be reported on a common scale with the English Standard and English Advanced courses. Students choosing not to sit for the English Studies HSC examination will still be eligible for the HSC if they have satisfactorily completed courses that comprise the pattern of study required by NESA. To be eligible for an ATAR, students studying the English Studies course must complete the optional HSC examination and include a further 8 Units of Category A courses in their pattern of study.	
Internal Assessment	100
- a maximum of four assessment tasks including: a critical response, creative response and formal written examination - weighting for tasks is between 10% and 40%	

English Standard

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course		English Advanced; English Studies; English EAL/D, English Extension 1.

Course Description

In the English Standard Year 11 course, students learn about language and literature by exploring and experimenting with the ways events, experiences, ideas and processes are represented in and through texts. Students study a range of text types to prepare them for the HSC Course.

In the English Standard Year 12 course, students further strengthen their knowledge and understanding of language and literature by reflecting on and demonstrating the effectiveness of texts, including their own, for different audiences and purposes.

In this course, students will consolidate their English literacy skills to become confident and effective communicators.

Students are required to closely study four prescribed texts, with at least ONE drawn from each of the following categories:

- prose fiction
- poetry
- drama OR non-fiction OR film OR media

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Content common to the English Standard and English Advanced courses is undertaken through a unit of work called *Reading to Write: Transition to Senior English*. Students explore a range of texts and consolidate skills required for senior study including analytical, creative and reflective writing.
- Two additional modules:
Close Study of Literature: students explore one substantial literary print text, developing a personal response through detailed analysis of the text construction.
Contemporary Possibilities: students explore the creative possibilities of storytelling within newer modes of communication.

HSC Course (Year 12)

- The HSC Common Content consists of one module *Texts and Human Experiences* which is common to the HSC Standard and HSC Advanced courses where students analyse how texts represent individual and collective human experiences.
- *Language, Identity and Culture*: through understanding and responding to texts, students explore how language can shape and reflect individual and collective identity.
- *Close Study of Literature*: students explore one substantial literary print text, developing a personal response through detailed analysis of the text construction.
- *The Craft of Writing*: through engagement with quality writing, students strengthen and extend their ability to compose imaginative, persuasive, discursive and reflective styles of writing.

Course Requirements

N/A

English Standard (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Paper 1 – Common Module. 1 hour and 30 minutes plus 10 minutes reading time	
Short answer questions in response to unseen texts related to Texts and Human Experiences	20
Extended response based on a prescribed text	20
Paper 2 - focus areas. 2 hours plus 5 minutes reading time	
Language, Identity and Culture: extended response based on a prescribed text	20
Close Study of Literature: extended response based on a prescribed text	20
The Craft of Writing: imaginative, persuasive, discursive or reflective response	
Internal Assessment	100
• a maximum of four assessment tasks • weightings can range between 10-40%. • A task assessing the craft of writing with a total weighting of 20-30% • Formal written examinations	

English Advanced

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course	See Conditions of entry below	English Standard; English Studies; English EAL/D.

Course Description

In the English Advanced Year 11 course, students explore, examine and analyse a range of texts to refine their understanding of the relationship between language, texts, context and meaning. They explore the ways events, experiences, ideas, values and processes are represented in and through texts and analyse the ways texts reflect different attitudes and values.

In the English Advanced Year 12 course, students further strengthen their knowledge and understanding of language and literature by analysing and evaluating texts and the ways they are valued in their contexts. They evaluate how meaning is achieved through textual construction and emulate this within their own compositions. Students are required to closely study 4 prescribed texts, with at least ONE drawn from each of the following categories:

- prose fiction
- poetry
- drama OR nonfiction OR film OR media

At least ONE of the texts selected must be authored by Shakespeare.

In this course, students develop their higher order thinking skills to enhance their personal, social, educational, and vocational lives.

Conditions of entry

Year 10 results:

- An average of 6 across in MYP Criterion.

Year 11 results:

- To remain in English Advanced for Year 12, students must achieve above 70% in their Semester 2 Examination.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Content common to the English Standard and English Advanced courses is undertaken through a unit of work called *Reading to Write: Transition to Senior English*. Students explore a range of texts and consolidate skills required for senior study including analytical, creative and reflective writing.
- *Narratives That Shape Our World*: students explore a range of narratives from different contexts that are connected through ideas, values and attitudes.
- *Critical Study of Literature*: students develop analytical and critical knowledge of a substantial literary text.

HSC Course (Year 12)

- The HSC Common Content consists of one module *Texts and Human Experiences* which is common to the HSC Standard and HSC Advanced courses where students analyse how texts represent individual and collective human experiences.
- *Textual Conversations*: students explore the ways in which the comparative study of texts can reveal resonances and dissonances within and between texts.

- *Critical Study of Literature*: students develop detailed analytical and critical knowledge of a substantial literary text.
- *The Craft of Writing*: through engagement with quality writing, students strengthen and extend their ability to compose imaginative, persuasive, discursive and reflective styles of writing.

Course Requirements

N/A

English Advanced (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Paper 1 – Common Module. 1 hour and 30 minutes plus 10 minutes reading time	
Short answer questions in response to unseen texts related to Texts and Human Experiences	20
Extended response based on a prescribed text	20
Paper 2 - Focus Areas. 2 hours plus 5 minutes reading time	
Textual Conversations: comparative extended response based on two prescribed texts	20
Critical Study of Literature: extended response based on a prescribe text	20
The Craft of Writing: imaginative, persuasive, discursive or reflective response	20
Internal Assessment	100
• a maximum of four assessment tasks • weightings can range between 10-40%. • a task assessing the craft of writing with a total weighting of 20-30% • formal written examinations	

English Extension 1

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
1 Unit for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course	- English Advanced Preliminary - English Extension in Year 11 is a prerequisite for English Extension 1 in Year 12 - English Extension 1 in Year 12 is a prerequisite for English Extension 2 See Conditions of entry below	English Standard; English Studies; English EAL/D.

Course Description

In the English Extension Year 11 course, students explore the ways in which aspects and concerns of texts from the past have been carried forward, borrowed from and/or appropriated into more recent culture. They consider how and why cultural values are maintained and changed.

In the English Extension 1 Year 12 course, students explore, investigate, experiment with and evaluate the ways texts represent and illuminate the complexity of individual and collective lives in literary worlds.

In studying these courses, students will develop skills to work independently to experiment with language forms, features and structures and to engage with complex levels of conceptualisation.

Conditions of entry

Year 10 results:

- An average of 6 across the MYP Criteria, with a minimum of 6 in Criteria A and D.

Year 11 results:

- To remain in English Extension 1 for Year 12, students must achieve above 70% in their English Extension 1 Semester 2 Examination and 80% in their English Advanced Semester 2 examination.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- One mandatory module: *Texts, Culture and Value* as well as a related research project.
- The course requires students to develop analytical and imaginative composition skills in response to a range of texts.

HSC Course (Year 12)

The course has one common module, *Literary Worlds*, with five associated electives. Students must complete one elective chosen by the teacher from one of the five electives offered for study.

The course requires students to develop analytical and imaginative composition skills in response to a range of texts.

The electives are:

- Confessional Worlds
- Historical Worlds
- Hybrid Worlds
- Natural Worlds
- Shakesperean Worlds

Course Requirements

N/A

English Extension 1 (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
<i>External Examination</i>	50
A 2-hour online examination with 10 minutes reading time, consisting of:	
Section 1 – Common Module	25
Section 2 - Elective	25
<i>Internal Assessment</i>	100
- Three assessment tasks: a creative response, a task integrating student-selected related material and a formal written examination - All tasks are weighted between 20% - 40%	

English Extension 2

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
1 Unit for HSC Board Developed Course. Studied in addition to English Extension 1 in Year 12.	- English Advanced - English Extension 1 in Year 11 is a prerequisite for English Extension 2 in Year 12 - English Extension 1 in Year 12 is a prerequisite for English Extension 2 - A Band 5 (80%) in the Extension 1 course	English Standard; English Studies; English EAL/D.

Course Description

In the English Extension 2 Year 12 course, students study one core unit called *Author and Authority* in which they learn about how and why the ways we create and read literature have changed over time and evaluate the relationship between texts and literary criticism.

Students also develop a sustained composition and document their reflection on this process through a Viva Voce, Literature review and Major Work journal.

In studying this course, students will develop skills to work independently to experiment with language forms, features and structures and to engage with complex levels of conceptualisation.

Conditions of entry

Year 11 results:

To enrol in English Extension 2 in Year 12, students must achieve above 80% in their English Extension 1 Semester 2 Examination and 85% in their English Advanced Semester 2 examination.

Main Topics Covered

The core unit *Author and Authority* requires students to complete an author study selected by the teacher from the prescribed author list. In their study, students evaluate the primacy of the author in creating a text's meaning. They develop their understanding of significant thinkers, theories and movements by exploring the chosen author.

Course Requirements

The course requires students to undertake a composition process in order to complete a Major Work and Reflection Statement.

English Extension 2 (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Major Work	60
1 hour 30-minute online examination	40
Section 1: Author and Authority – response to an unseen stimulus/question	20
Section 2: Author study – extended response regarding their author study	20
Internal Assessment	100
- There will be three assessment tasks which include: - a Viva Voce - a Literature Review - a formal written examination - The Major Work Journal must be submitted for monitoring with each assessment task.	30 40 30

French Continuers

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units of each Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course	Students will need to have studied French in Stage 4 and 5	

Course Description

The study of French contributes to the overall education of students, particularly in the areas of communication, cross-cultural understanding, literacy and general knowledge. The study of French promotes understanding of different attitudes and values within the wider Australian community and beyond. It will better equip students as travellers and provide access to a significant part of the culture, traditions and attitudes of French-speaking countries and communities.

French is an official language in 29 countries and is one of the most important languages of international diplomacy.

French is an official language for the United Nations, the Olympic Games, the European Union, the South Pacific Commission, the Organisation for African Unity and International conferences. Students will develop linguistic ability and gain cultural understanding through the study of the French language. The ability to

communicate in French should also promote understanding, harmony and cooperation with French-speaking communities in Australia.

The study of French enhances enjoyment and appreciation of French culture through film, literature, music, cuisine, art and sport.

Main Topics Covered

Prescribed Themes

- The Individual
- The French-Speaking Communities
- The Changing World

Prescribed Topics

- Personal Identity
- Relationships
- School Life and Aspirations
- Leisure and Interests
- Lifestyles
- Arts and Entertainment
- Travel and Tourism
- The World of Work
- Current Issues and The Young Person's World

The course is studied throughout Years 11 and 12. There are three main prescribed themes with topics and sub-topics in the syllabus and a range of grammar points that should be covered. For specific grammar details please refer to NESA Syllabus. Grammar points can be studied at any time during the two-year course. As learning a language is a constant process, themes, topics and grammar points may be revisited from time to time, allowing students to improve and enrich their usage and understanding of French.

Course Requirements

N/A

French Continuers (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Listening	30
Reading	30
Writing	20
Speaking	20

Students interested in taking a language at Extension level in Year 12 must contact the Head of Languages to obtain further information.

Geography

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course		

Course Description

Geography is an exploration of our world, aiming to provide a clear description and interpretation of the diverse characteristics of the Earth and its inhabitants. It enables students to develop the skills to recognise and understand environmental changes and the interactions that occur within our world.

The Preliminary Course focuses on both biophysical and human geography, enhancing students' knowledge and understanding of the spatial and ecological aspects of geography. Through inquiry methodologies, students investigate the unique features of our world by engaging in fieldwork, honing geographical skills and studying contemporary geographical issues

The HSC Course deepens students' appreciation of geographical perspectives on the contemporary world through fieldwork and a diverse range of case studies of biophysical and human processes, interactions and trends. Studying Stage 6 Geography equips students for post-school education, future careers and active participation as informed citizens.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- **Earth's Natural System** (the Earth's system and human interactions)
- **People, Patterns and Processes** (global demographic trends and an in-depth study of Venice)
- **Human-Environment Interactions** (challenges posed by climate change)

HSC Course (Year 12)

- **Ecosystems and Global Biodiversity** (sustainable management strategies, including case studies of coral reefs and kelp forests)
- **Rural and Urban Places** (liveability and promotion of sustainability, including New York, Tamworth and Barangaroo)
- **Global Sustainability** (global economic activity, the principles of sustainable development and the circular economy)

Key concepts incorporated across all topics: change, environment, sustainability, spatial and ecological dimensions, interaction, technology, management and cultural integration.

Course Requirements

Students complete a Geographical Investigation in the Preliminary Course.

Students must undertake 12 hours of fieldwork in both Preliminary and HSC Courses

Geography (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
<i>External Examination</i>	<i>100</i>
A three-hour written examination:	
Multiple-choice	20
Short answers	40
Extended responses	40
<i>Internal Assessment</i>	<i>100</i>
Knowledge and understanding of course content	40
Geographical tools and skills	20
Geographical enquiry and research including fieldwork	20
Communication of geographical information, ideas and issues in appropriate forms	20

Health and Movement Science

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course		

Course Description

Health and Movement Science draws on a multitude of fields and the application of scientific concepts to actively engage students in learning about the factors that influence health and movement. While there is tremendous opportunity for good health, there are numerous conflicting influences on lifestyle, which are impacting health outcomes. In this syllabus, students investigate the health status of Australians and the interrelated factors that affect the health of individuals and communities. Students explore the factors that influence

movement and performance and develop the skills to enhance movement for themselves and others throughout their lifetime. Participation in physical activity plays a significant role in improving the health and wellbeing of individuals and communities. Learning in, through and about the movement sciences involves exploring and thinking critically about the interrelationships between anatomy, physiology, biomechanics, psychology, sociology, nutrition, skill acquisition, injury prevention and rehabilitation.

Acquiring the knowledge and skills to be physically active can optimise individual and team performance and develop positive movement habits across the lifespan. The course provides opportunities to explore areas of interest in greater depth and apply health and movement concepts to various contexts and groups. To equip students to navigate the dynamic nature of health and movement, emphasis is given to developing skills of collaboration, analysis, communication, creative thinking, problem-solving and research.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Health for Individuals and Communities
- The Body and Mind in Motion
- Collaborative Investigation

HSC Course (Year 12)

- Health in an Australian and Global Context
- Training for Improved Performance

Course Requirements

The Year 11 course comprises 4 components. Students are required to study all 4 components of the course.

Health and Movement Science	Indicative hours
Health for Individuals and Communities	40
The Body and Mind in Motion	40
Collaborative Investigation	20
Depth Studies (a minimum of 2)	20

The Year 12 course comprises 3 components. Students are required to study all 3 components of the course.

Health and Movement Science	Indicative hours
Health in an Australian and Global Context	45
Training for Improved Performance	45
Depth Studies (a minimum of 2)	30

Health and Movement Science (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
The examination will consist of a written paper worth 100 marks. Written examination Time allowed: 3 hours plus 10 minutes reading time. Questions relating to Health and Movement Science skill outcomes will be integrated throughout the examination. The paper will consist of three sections. There will be approximately equal weighting given to the two focus areas: Health in an Australian and Global Context and Training for Improved Performance. Health and Movement Science HSC examination specifications Section I (20 marks) - There will be objective response questions to the value of 20 marks. Section II (56 marks) - This section will contain short-answer questions. - Questions may contain parts. - There will be 9 to 12 items in total. - At least 3 items will be worth 6 to 8 marks. Section III (24 marks) There will be 2 extended-response questions worth 12 marks each – one question based on each focus area: Health in an Australian and Global Context, Training for Improved Performance.	
Internal Assessment	100
- Knowledge and understanding of course content - Skills in critical thinking, research, analysis and communicating	40 60
The formal school-based assessment program reflects the following requirements: - a maximum of 4 assessment tasks - the minimum weighting for an individual task is 10% - the maximum weighting for an individual task is 40%	

History Extension

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✕ Exclusions
1 Unit for the HSC NESA Developed Course	Students will be required to have a Band 5 (80%) or above for their existing History course/s.	

Course Description

In Year 12, students who display strong critical and reflective skills, initiative in research and very good writing skills during the Preliminary Course are offered the opportunity to study History Extension.

The History Extension course is about the nature of history and how and why historical interpretations are developed from different perspectives and approaches over time. It offers a higher level of challenge than the Ancient History and Modern History courses with its greater emphasis on historiography.

The History Extension course requires students to examine the way history is constructed and the role of historians.

This involves reviewing the types of history that have been produced over time and the contexts in which they were developed. Students explore problems and issues associated with the construction of history through sampling the works of various writers, historians and others involved in the practice of history from ancient times to the present day. Students focus on an area of debate to consider how an historian's context, methodology and

purpose shape their interpretation of a person, group, event or issue. Students apply their understanding and skills of historical inquiry by designing and conducting their own historical investigation. History Extension appeals to students who appreciate the intellectual challenge of grappling with an area of debate and constructing and defending a position through a reasoned and cohesive argument. It offers students the opportunity to work independently and apply the historiographical understanding developed through the course to an individual project of personal interest.

Main Topics Covered

HSC Course (Year 12)

- Part I (a): Constructing History – Key Questions
- Part I (b): Constructing History – Case Studies (The Crusades)
- Part II: History Project

Course Requirements

N/A

History Extension (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	50
A two-hour written examination consisting of:	
Section I: Extended Response Question: May include reference to one or two unseen passages as a stimulus for the exploration of issues of historiography.	25
Section II: Extended Response Question: Analyse historiographical issue with specific reference to the case study.	25
Internal Assessment	100
3 assessment tasks	
• Trial Examination with two sections	30
• One task must be the History Project – Historical Process	30
• One task must be the History Project – Essay	40

Industrial Technology – Timber and Furniture Technologies

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each for Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course		
Course Description		
Both Preliminary and HSC Courses offer students' knowledge, understanding and skills in aspects of Industrial Technology, focusing on Timber Products and Furniture Technologies, highlighting the importance of design, management and production through practical experiences.	Students undertake project work and an Industry Study that will develop a broad range of skills and knowledge related to the Timber Products and Furniture Technologies industries.	
Main Topics Covered		
<i>Preliminary Course (Year 11)</i> Students will study and then apply the following: • Industry Study (15%) – organisation and management of an individual business. • Design (10%) – design and plan timber projects for a purpose. • Management and Communication (20%) – to record and reflect on the processes and procedures linked to each project produced. • Production (40%) – through the development of knowledge and skills through the construction of a number of student-developed projects. • Industry Related Manufacturing Technology (15%) – develop the knowledge and understanding of a range of materials, processes, tools, equipment and machinery through the construction of a number of projects.	<i>HSC Course (Year 12)</i> Industry Related Manufacturing Technology (25%) – development of knowledge and understanding of a range of materials, processes, tools, equipment, machinery and technologies that relate to the focus area through practical experiences including the development of a Major Project. Industry Study (15%) – study of an organisation and management of the industry including; structural, technical, environmental, sociological, personnel, sectors within the industry, legislation, WH&S issues, career opportunities, sales and marketing.	Major Project (60%) • Design, Management and Communication – application of design principles in the production of a Major Project, development and management of a folio which reflects; design, analysis, evaluation, ICT, WH&S and presentation techniques. • Production – applies knowledge and skills through the construction of a Major Projects which reflects; quality, a range of high skills, degree of difficulty, links with planning and production, selection and use of appropriate materials, components, evidence of problem solving, WH&S and safe working practices. • Major Project Budgeting All materials are provided in Year 11. Students will need to budget for their raw materials for their major project in Year 12, the average cost per student is normally around \$800.
Course Requirements		
N/A		

Industrial Technology - Timber Products and Furniture Technologies (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
A written examination worth 40 marks and taking 90 minutes	40
A major project worth 60 marks	60
Each student will undertake, on an individual basis, a major timber project for submission. This is to include the practical hands-on activity of carrying the project through to realisation and the documentation, in a folio, of all the steps involved and equipment used in the process	
Internal Assessment	100
School based assessment through tasks and an examination reflecting knowledge and understanding of course content	40
Knowledge and skills in the design, management, communication and production of a major project	60

Japanese Beginners

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course		Students who have had more than 100 prior hours (or equivalent) of Japanese language instruction, significant experience with the language or more than three months spent in Japan should not undertake the Beginners course.

Course Description		
The study of the Japanese language is of particular importance to Australians, both culturally and economically. Japan is one of Australia's leading trading partners and there are significant cultural ties between Australia and Japan. Both Australia and Japan are members of the Asia Pacific Economic Community. Japanese has been identified as one of the priority languages in the Asia-Pacific region to be taught in Australian Schools. This	recognises the close economic and cultural ties between the two countries. The study of Japanese provides access to the language and culture of one of the global community's most technologically advanced societies and economies. The study of Japanese contributes to the overall education of students, particularly in the areas of communication, cross-cultural	understanding, literacy and general knowledge. Students can gain access to the language and the rich cultural traditions of Japan, as well as an understanding of different attitudes and values within the wider Australian community and beyond. The study of Japanese enhances enjoyment and appreciation of Japanese culture through film, literature, music, cuisine and sport.
Main Topics Covered		
Prescribed Themes - The Personal World - The Japanese-Speaking Communities	Mandatory Topics - Family Life, Home and Neighbourhood - People, Places and Communities - Education and Work - Friends, Recreation and Pastimes - Holidays, Travel and Tourism - Future Plans and Aspirations	The course is studied throughout Year 11 and 12. The prescribed topics for this course are studied from two perspectives. In addition, a range of grammatical features are covered throughout the course. For specific details on grammatical items please refer to the NESA Syllabus. Due to the cumulative process involved in the learning of a language, perspectives, topics and grammatical features are taught using a spiral approach, allowing students to improve their command of Japanese at increasing levels of complexity.
Course Requirements		
This course is designed for students who wish to begin their study of Japanese at senior secondary level. It is intended to cater only for students with no prior knowledge or experience of the Japanese language, either spoken or written or whose experience is derived solely from, or is equivalent to, its study for 100 hours or less in Stage 4 or Stage 5. Students will be required to complete an Eligibility Statement prior to commencing the course.		

Japanese Beginners (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Listening	30
Reading	30
Writing	20
Speaking	20

Legal Studies

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course		

Course Description

Legal Studies is designed to foster intellectual, social and moral development by empowering students to think critically on the role of law and legal institutions in society. This is achieved through a review of selected legal rules, institutions and processes at the domestic and international level.

This subject has a significant impact on students' confidence in approaching and accessing the legal system and provides them with a better appreciation and understanding of the relationship

between social and legal structures in society. It further fosters a respect for cultural diversity and promotes tolerance.

Legal Studies provides a flexible learning structure. It allows students to acquire skills in analysis, independent research and the development of coherent arguments. All of this helps to prepare students for further education, training and employment. It allows for full and active participation as citizens by encouraging diverse opinions, open

rational debate, respect for persons and equality before the law and involvement in democratic processes and structures.

Legal Studies develops students' knowledge, understanding and skills in relation to the legal system and its effectiveness in promoting a just and fair society, with a view to empowering students to participate effectively as citizens, at local, national and international levels.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- The Legal System
- The Individual & the Law
- The Law in Practice

HSC Course (Year 12)

- Crime
- Human Rights
- Two Option Topics - Option 1: Family. Option 2: World Order OR Consumers

Course Requirements

N/A

Legal Studies (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Multiple-choice	20
Short answer	30
2 x extended responses	50
Internal Assessment	100
Knowledge and understanding of course content	40
Analysis and evaluation	20
Inquiry and research	20
Communication of Legal Studies information, issues and ideas in appropriate forms	20

Mathematics Standard 2

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Year 11 and HSC Board Developed Course		Students may not study any other Stage 6 Mathematics course.

Course Description		
The Mathematics Standard 2 course is designed to promote the application of mathematics. In considering various applications of mathematics, students will be required to construct and use mathematical	models. In following a modelling process, students view a problem through their past experience, prior knowledge and areas of confidence. As a model emerges, it extends their thinking in new ways as well as enhancing what they have observed.	Modelling opportunities will involve a wide variety of approaches such as generating equations or formulae that describe the behaviour of an object, or alternatively displaying, analysing and interpreting the data values from a real-life situation.
Main Topics Covered		
<i>Preliminary Course (Year 11)</i> • Algebra • Financial Mathematics • Measurement • Networks • Statistics	<i>HSC Course (Year 12)</i> • Algebra • Financial Mathematics • Measurement • Networks • Statistics	
Course Requirements		
Assumed prior knowledge is the NSW Year 10 Stage 5 Mathematics Core.		

Mathematics Standard 2 (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
The external HSC examination measures student achievement in a range of syllabus outcomes. Section 1: Objective response question to the value of 15 marks Section 2: Questions may contain parts. There will be 30 to 35 questions. Questions to the value of 85 marks • The examination will consist of a written paper worth 100 marks. • The time allowed is 2 hours and 30 minutes with 5 minutes reading time. • A reference sheet will be provided. • NESA approved calculators, a pair of compasses and a protractor may be used.	
Internal Assessment	100
The two components of assessment with equal weighting in each of Year 11 and 12 are: • Understanding, Fluency and Communication • Problem solving, Reasoning and Justification In Year 11 students are assessed through three tasks. In Year 12 students are assessed through four tasks. In each of Year 11 and Year 12 one assessment will be a formal examination and one will be an assignment or investigation with an in-class component.	

Mathematics Advanced

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Year 11 and HSC Board Developed Course	See Conditions of entry below	Mathematics Standard

Course Description

The course is intended to give students who have demonstrated general competence in the skills of Mathematics Core and Pathways, an understanding of and competence in some further aspects of mathematics which are applicable to the real world. It is useful for concurrent studies in Science and Commerce.

The course is a sufficient basis for further studies in Mathematics as a minor discipline at tertiary level in support of courses such as the life Sciences or Commerce.

Conditions of entry

Year 10 results:

- Achieve a Level 3 or above in the Minimum Standards test for Numeracy
- For Year 10 Core and Pathway: An average of Level 5 or higher Criterion A-D in assessments
- For Year 10 Core Students: An average of Level 7 or higher Criterion A-D in assessments

Year 11 results:

- To remain in Mathematics Advanced for Year 12, students must achieve above 50% in their Semester 2 examination

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Functions
- Trigonometric Functions
- Calculus
- Exponentials and Logarithmic Functions
- Statistical Analysis

HSC Course (Year 12)

- Graphing Technique
- Sequence and Series
- Calculus
- Statistical Analysis
- Financial Mathematics

Course Requirements

For students who intend to study the Mathematics course, it is recommended that they have studied the Mathematics Core and Pathways topics - Algebraic Techniques, Surds and Indices, Equations, Linear Relationships, Trigonometry and Pythagoras' Theorem, Single Variable Data Analysis and at least some of the content of the following sub-strands: Non-Linear Relationships and Properties of Geometrical Figures.

Mathematics Advanced (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Section I (10 marks) There will be objective-response questions to the value of 10 marks. Section II (90 marks) Questions may contain parts. There will be 37 to 42 items. At least two items will be worth 4 or 5 marks. The time allowed is 3 hours with 10 minutes reading time. • A Reference Sheet will be provided. • NESA approved calculators may be used.	
Internal Assessment	100
The two components of assessment with equal weighting in each of Year 11 and 12 are: • Knowledge and understanding of course content 50 • Skills in Working Mathematically. In Year 11, students are assessed through three tasks. In Year 12, students are assessed through four tasks. 50 There will be three formal assessment tasks in the Preliminary Course and four in the HSC Course. In each of Year 11 and Year 12, one assessment will be a formal examination, the others will be in-class tests.	

Mathematics Extension 1

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
1 Unit for each of Year 11 and HSC Board Developed Course	Mathematics Advanced See Conditions of entry below	Mathematics Standard

Course Description

Studied in addition to the Mathematics course.

The content of this course and its depth of treatment indicate that it is intended for students who have demonstrated a mastery of the skills of Year 10 Mathematics Core and Pathways and are interested in the study of further skills and ideas in mathematics.

The course is intended to give these students a thorough understanding of and competence in aspects of mathematics, including many which are applicable to the real world. It is useful for concurrent studies of science, Business Studies and Design courses.

The course is a recommended minimum basis for further studies in Mathematics as a major discipline at a tertiary level and for the study of Mathematics in support of the Physical Sciences, Computer Science and Engineering Sciences.

Conditions of entry

Year 10 results:

For Year 10 Core and Pathway:
An average of Level 6 or higher
Criterion A-D in assessments

Year 11 results:

To remain in Mathematics Extension 1 for Year 12, students must achieve above 50% in Mathematics Extension 1 and above 60% in Mathematics Advanced in their Semester 2 Examination

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Functions
- Trigonometric Functions
- Combinatorics

HSC Course (Year 12)

- Proof
- Vectors
- Trigonometric Functions
- Statistical Analysis

Course Requirements

Students must also be studying the Mathematics Advanced course.

Mathematics Extension 1 (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Section I (10 marks) There will be objective-response questions to the value of 10 marks. Section II (60 marks) Questions may contain parts. There will be 23 to 28 items. At least one item will be worth 4 or 5 marks. The examination will be based on the Mathematics Extension 1 Year 12 course and will focus on the course objectives and Year 12 outcomes. The Mathematics Advanced and Mathematics Extension 1 Year 11 courses will be assumed knowledge for this examination and may be examined. Candidates will also be required to complete either the Mathematics Advanced examination paper or the Mathematics Extension 2 examination paper, in addition to the Mathematics Extension 1 paper. • The time allowed is 2 hours plus 10 minutes reading time. • A Reference Sheet will be provided. • NESA approved calculators may be used.	
Internal Assessment	100
In the Year 11, students are assessed through three assessments tasks. In the HSC course, students are assessed through four assessment tasks. The internal HSC assessment mark may be based on the whole course (ie both Preliminary and HSC courses). All internal assessments have two components. The components being: • Knowledge and understanding of course content • Skills in Working Mathematically Students must sit Mathematics task and the Mathematics Extension 1 tasks.	
	50
	50

Mathematics Extension 2

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
1 Unit HSC course. Studied in addition to the Mathematics Extension 1 course.	Mathematics Extension 1 See Conditions of entry below	Mathematics Standard

Course Description

The course offers a suitable preparation for study of Mathematics at tertiary level, as well as a deeper and more extensive treatment of certain topics than is offered in other Mathematics courses. It represents a distinctly high level in school Mathematics involving the development of considerable manipulative skill and a high degree of

understanding of the fundamental ideas of Algebra and Calculus. These topics are treated in some depth. Thus, the course provides a sufficient basis for a wide range of useful applications of mathematics as well as an adequate foundation for the further study of the subject.

Conditions of entry

Year 11 results:

To study Mathematics Extension 2 for Year 12, students must achieve above 60% in the Mathematics Extension 1 Exam and above 70% in the Mathematics Advanced Exam

Main Topics Covered

- Proof
- Vectors
- Complex Numbers
- Calculus
- Mechanics

Course Requirements

The course is designed for students with a special interest in mathematics who have shown that they possess special aptitude for the subject.

Mathematics Extension 2 (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Section I (10 marks) There will be objective-response questions to the value of 10 marks.	10
Section II (90 marks) Questions may contain parts. There will be 37 to 42 items. At least two items will be worth 4 or 5 marks.	90
The examination will be based on the Mathematics Extension 2 Year 12 course and will focus on the course objectives and outcomes. The Mathematics Advanced and Mathematics Extension 1 courses will be assumed knowledge for this examination and may be examined. Candidates will also be required to complete the Mathematics Extension 1 paper in addition to the Mathematics Extension 2 paper. • The time allowed is 3 hours plus 10 minutes reading time. • A Reference Sheet will be provided. • NESA approved calculators may be used.	
Internal Assessment	100
Students are assessed through four assessment tasks.	
All internal assessments have two components. The components being:	
• Knowledge and understanding of course content	50
• Skills in Working Mathematically	50
Students must sit the Mathematics Extensions 1 tasks and Mathematics Extension 2 tasks.	

Modern History

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC NESA Developed Course		

Course Description

Modern History gives students an opportunity to investigate historical evidence and develop their own interpretation of people and events. The study of history allows students to better understand the world in which they live and their place in it. Modern History is especially relevant to the lives of students, as the events and issues that form its content are, in many cases, still current.

Year 11 Modern History begins with an investigation of revolutions from around the world. Revolutions that are often studied include the Russian Revolution (which overthrew the rule of the Romanov Tsar) and the Meiji Restoration in Japan (the opening of a closed society which resulted in rapid industrial and military growth). Students also learn about the world at the beginning of the Twentieth Century including an extensive investigation of how World War I shaped the modern world.

In Year 12, students of Modern History will all study the authoritarian states of Nazi Germany and the Soviet Union Pre-World War II. Students also complete a Peace and Conflict Study (Indochina, leading into the Vietnam War) and a study on Change in the Modern World through the lens of America.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Part I: Case Study – The Romanovs
- Part II: Case Study – The Meiji Restoration
- Part III: The Making of the Modern World – World War I

HSC Course (Year 12)

- Part I: Core – Power and Authority in the Modern World (with a focus on Nazi Germany)
- Part II: National Study (The Soviet Union)
- Part III: Peace and Conflict (Conflict in Indochina)
- Part IV: Change in the Modern World (with a focus on America)

Course Requirements

N/A

Modern History (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
A three-hour written examination consisting of:	
Part I: Core – Power and Authority (Source-based, short answers)	25
Part II: National Study (Extended Response)	25
Part III: Peace and Conflict (Extended Response)	25
Part IV: Change in the Modern World – (Short and long answers)	25
Internal Assessment	100
• A maximum of 4 assessment tasks • A minimum weighting of a task is 10% and a maximum of 40% • Only one task may be a formal written examination with a maximum weighting of 30% • One task may be an Historical Analysis with a weighting of 20-30%	

Music 1

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course	Whilst there is no official course prerequisite to study Music 1, it is assumed that students are proficient in performance on an instrument or voice.	Music 2, Music Extension

Course Description

Music 1 provides an alternative course of study to Music 2 and the curriculum structure is adaptable enough to meet the needs and interests of students with varying degrees of prior formal and informal learning in music. It accommodates the widely differing needs and abilities of students, ranging from the broadly based to the desire to specialise, by allowing flexibility in the topic choice and areas of study.

Music 1 builds on the Years 7–10 Mandatory course. It caters for students who have diverse musical backgrounds and musical interests, including those with an interest in popular music.

Music 1 assumes no prior knowledge of musical notation beyond the basic introduction in the Years 7–10 Mandatory course. It recognises that students who have had no further involvement in Music beyond their

introduction in the Mandatory course will need to revisit elementary musical skills and understanding.

Students study: The Concepts of Music (duration, pitch, dynamics and expressive techniques, tone colour, texture and structure) through learning experiences of Performance, Composition, Musicology and Aural within the context of a range of styles, periods and genres.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Music for Large Ensembles
- Music for Small Ensembles
- Jazz

HSC Course (Year 12)

- An Instrument and its Repertoire
- Music of the 20th and 21st Centuries
- One additional topic chosen from either the Preliminary course or the list below:
 - Australian Music
 - Baroque Music
 - Music for Radio, Film, TV and Multimedia
 - Music of a Culture
 - Music of the 18th Century
 - Music of the 19th Century
 - Music of the 20th and 21st Century
 - Popular Music
 - Rock Music
 - Technology and its Influence on Music
 - Theatre Music

Music 1 (continued)

Course Requirements

Students in the Music 1 course agree to commit to, for the duration of the course:

- undertake regular private tuition on their chosen instrument or voice
- perform on their instrument or voice as a soloist on a regular basis
- attend Music excursions (at an additional cost, outlined at the start of the year)

Students are highly encouraged to be involved in the St Andrew's Cocurricular Music Programme.

Note: Previously, it was mandatory for all Music elective students to be in Senior choir for the full duration of Elective Music study. From 2026, students new to Elective Music must be in Senior Choir for the first semester only; after this point, it is optional to continue Senior Choir.

Additional Considerations

The School provides an accompanist (piano) to rehearse and perform as required for student performances presented as course work. This includes the provision of a rhythm section (band) in the final term of the HSC course. There may be instances where a student elects to perform with additional musicians outside of what the School provides; these optional costs are not covered by the School and should be factored in by the student and their parents.

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)

Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100*
Written paper – Aural Skills	30
Core performance	20
Elective 1 – Performance, Composition or Musicology	20
Elective 2 – Performance, Composition or Musicology	20
Elective 3 – Performance, Composition or Musicology	20
<i>*The marks for Core Performance and the Electives will be converted to a mark out of 70, giving a total mark out of 100 for the examination.</i>	
Internal Assessment	100
Core – Performance	10
Core – Composition	10
Core – Musicology	10
Core – Aural	25
Elective 1 – Performance, Composition or Musicology	15
Elective 2 – Performance, Composition or Musicology	15
Elective 3 – Performance, Composition or Musicology	15

Music 2

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course	The strongly recommended pre-requisite is completing Elective Music in Year 9 and 10. There is some flexibility, however, this is rare. It is assumed that students have pre-existing musical knowledge, abilities and experience in: • Music Theory (assumed knowledge of, as a minimum, all theory material covered up to and including AMEB Grade 3 Music Craft, Musicianship or equivalent) • Music Literacy Skills (in sight reading and sight singing) • Solo Performance Skills on their chosen instrument or voice (minimum standard of approximately AMEB 6th Grade, though this guideline is flexible depending on the instrument)	Music 1

Course Description

The aim of Music 2 is to provide students with the opportunity to build on their musical knowledge and skills, and to emerge as musically sensitive and critical individuals with the capacity and desire for music to play a significant and continually developing role in their lives. Music 2 builds on the Years 7-10 Mandatory and Elective courses and focuses on the study of western art music but requires students to place this study in a broader musical context.

Students study:

The Concepts of Music (duration, pitch, dynamics and expressive techniques, tone colour, texture and structure) through learning experiences of Performance, Composition, Musicology and Aural within the context of a range of styles, periods and genres. Revisiting these concepts, at increasing levels of difficulty, leads to the ability to synthesise musical ideas and understanding and to evaluate music critically.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

Mandatory Topic: Music 1600 – 1900

Additional Topic: Medieval Music

HSC Course (Year 12)

Mandatory Topic: Music of the last 25 years (Australian focus)

Additional Topics: Study one additional topic from the list below:

- Music of a Culture
- Baroque Music
- Renaissance Music

- Music in the Nineteenth Century
- Classical Music
- Music 1900 - 1945
- Music 1945 to Music 25 Years Ago

Music 2 (continued)

Course Requirements

Students in the Music 2 course agree to commit to, for the duration of the course:

- undertake regular private tuition on their chosen instrument or voice
- perform on their instrument or voice as a soloist on a regular basis
- attend Music excursions (at an additional cost, outlined at the start of the year)

Note: Previously, it was mandatory for all Music elective students to be in Senior choir for the full duration of Elective Music study. From 2026, students new to Elective Music must be in Senior Choir for the first semester only; after this point, it is optional to continue Senior Choir.

Students are highly encouraged to be involved in the St Andrew's Cocurricular Music Programme.

Additional Considerations

The School provides an accompanist (piano) to rehearse and perform as required for student performances presented as course work. There may be instances where a student elects to perform with additional musicians outside of what the School provides; these optional costs are not covered by the School and should be factored in by the student and their parents.

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)

Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Written Paper – Musicology and Aural Skills	35
Practical Examination	20
• Performance (15)	
• Sight Singing (5)	
Core – Composition	15
Elective (Performance OR Composition OR Musicology)	30
Internal Assessment	100
Core – Performance	20
Core – Composition	20
Core – Musicology	20
Core – Aural	20
Elective (Performance OR Composition OR Musicology)	20

Music Extension

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
1 Unit HSC Board Developed Course	Music 2 Available in Year 12 only. This course is by invitation only.	

Course Description

The Music Extension course provides an opportunity for musically and academically talented students to undertake rigorous musical study commensurate with their academic and musical sophistication.

The course offers a high degree of specialisation in which each student follows an individual program of study which will be negotiated between the teacher and student.

Students will specialise further in ONE of the learning experiences of Performance or Composition or Musicology. Students have the opportunity to pursue excellence in a particular area of interest and expertise in the contexts of their choosing.

Main Topics Covered

The course offers a flexible, student-focused opportunity to undertake study in an area of musical interest. Students choose from either:

- Performance (three contrasting pieces on chosen instrument or voice, including one ensemble piece)
OR
- Composition (submitted work comprising two original contrasting pieces/movements – 6 minutes)
OR
- Musicology (submitted 3000-word essay on an aspect or aspects of music studied in-depth)

Students in Music Extension will develop a deeper understanding of the characteristics of musical styles, periods and/or genres through their specialisation in Performance, Composition or Musicology. In addition, students will extend their musical understanding through a more detailed study of the relationship between the musical concepts of:

- Duration
- Pitch
- Dynamics and Expressive Techniques
- Tone Colour
- Texture
- Structure

Music Extension (continued)

Course Requirements

Students in the Music Extension course agree to commit to, for the duration of the course:

- undertake regular private tuition on their chosen instrument or voice
- perform on their instrument or voice as a soloist on a regular basis
- attend Music excursions (at an additional cost, outlined at the start of the year)

Note: Previously, it was mandatory for all Music elective students to be in Senior choir for the full duration of Elective Music study. From 2026, students new to Elective Music must be in Senior Choir for the first semester only; after this point, it is optional to continue Senior Choir.

Students are highly encouraged to be involved in the St Andrew's Cocurricular Music Programme.

Additional Considerations

The School provides an accompanist (piano) to rehearse and perform as required for student performances presented as course work. The School may provide some assistance in sourcing musicians to perform in the Ensemble piece where applicable. There may be instances where a student elects to perform with additional musicians outside of what the School provides; these optional costs are not covered by the School and should be factored in by the student and their parents.

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)

Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	50
Performance practical examination	50
One Ensemble Piece Two Solo Pieces – OR Composition Two submitted works OR Musicology Submitted essay	
Internal Assessment	100
Performance OR Composition OR Musicology	100

Physics

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units HSC Board Developed Course	Mathematics Advanced or higher Achieved MYP Grade 5, including a minimum of a 5 in Criterion B and C in Year 10 results	

Course Description

The Physics Stage 6 Syllabus involves the study of matter and its motion through space and time, along with related concepts that include energy and force. Physics deals with the study of phenomena on scales of space and time – from nuclear particles and their interactions up to the size and age of the Universe. This allows students to better understand the physical world and how it works, appreciate the uniqueness of the Universe, and participate in navigating and influencing the future.

The problem-solving nature of physics further develops students' Working Scientifically skills by focusing on the

exploration of models and the analysis of theories and laws, which promotes an understanding of the connectedness of seemingly dissimilar phenomena.

Students who study Physics are encouraged to use observations to develop quantitative models of real-world problems and derive relationships between variables. They are required to engage in solving equations based on these models, make predictions, and analyse the interconnectedness of physical entities.

The Physics course builds on students' knowledge and skills developed in the Science Stage 5 course and help them

develop a greater understanding of physics as a foundation for undertaking post-school studies in a wide range of Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM) fields. A knowledge and understanding of physics often provides the unifying link between interdisciplinary studies.

The study of Physics provides the foundation knowledge and skills required to support participation in a range of careers. It is a discipline that utilises innovative and creative thinking to address new challenges, such as sustainability, energy efficiency and the creation of new materials.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- Module 1: Kinematics
- Module 2: Dynamics
- Module 3: Waves and Thermodynamics
- Module 4: Electricity and Magnetism

HSC Course (Year 12)

- Module 5: Advanced Mechanics
- Module 6: Electromagnetism
- Module 7: The Nature of Light From the Universe to the Atom

Course Requirements

N/A

Physics (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
The paper will consist of two sections:	
Section I	20
There will be objective-response questions to the value of 20 marks.	
Section II	80
- Questions may contain parts. - There will be 20 to 25 items. - At least two items will be worth 7 to 9 marks. - The examination will consist of a written paper worth 100 marks.	
The time allowed is 3 hours plus 5 minutes reading time.	
NESA approved calculators, a pair of compasses, a protractor and set squares may be used.	
There will be approximately equal weighting given to Modules 5 to 8. Questions relating to Working Scientifically Skills will be integrated throughout the examination.	
Internal Assessment	100
- A maximum of 4 assessment tasks - All individual tasks have a weighting between 10% and 40% for each task - One task may be a formal written examination with a maximum weighting of 30% - One of the tasks will be based on a depth study worth somewhere between 20%-40%	

Science Extension

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
1 Unit HSC Board Development Course	2 Unit Mathematics or higher and at least one other 2 Unit Science Course. This course is by invitation only.	

Course Description

The Science Extension Stage 6 Syllabus focuses on the nature, development and processes of science. The course requires students to engage with complex concepts and theories and to critically evaluate new ideas, discoveries and contemporary scientific research. Students are challenged to examine a scientific research question influenced by their study of one or more of the scientific disciplines. In doing this, students extend their knowledge of the discipline(s), conduct further analysis and authentic scientific investigations, and uniquely for this course, produce a detailed scientific research report that reflects the standards generally required for publication in a scientific journal.

Through designing and conducting their own scientific research, initially using small datasets, students deepen and build upon their understanding of analysing and interpreting data. They are provided with opportunities to refine and extend their skills of Working Scientifically by applying these interrelated processes to contemporary authentic scientific research reflecting the skills used by practising research scientists. Students gather, examine, model and critically assess evidence that is informed by analysis of primary and secondary-sourced data and examining this data in relation to relevant publicly available data sets.

Students interrogate and refine their ideas of and about science through analysing historic and cultural observations and significant scientific research within the relevant ethical frameworks and philosophical arguments of the time.

Science Extension is designed for students with an interest in scientific research. The course lays a foundation for students planning to pursue further study in Science, Technology, Engineering or Mathematics (STEM) based courses offered at the tertiary level and to engage in new and emerging industries.

Main Topics Covered

HSC Course (Year 12)

Working Scientifically Skills

- Module 1: The Foundations of Scientific Thinking
- Module 2: The Scientific Research Proposal
- Module 3: The Data, Evidence and Decisions
- Module 4: The Scientific Research Report

Course Requirements

N/A

Science Extension (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	50
Section I	20
In this section students will be required to answer questions on the development of scientific knowledge and scientific methods of inquiry. Questions may contain brief stimulus material.	
Section II	30
In this section students will be required to answer questions that relate to student experiences and learnings from undertaking the Scientific Research Report. Some questions will contain stimulus material including scientific journal articles, statistical and graphical information and multimedia.	
Questions in this section will require students to refer to decisions and actions that they made in undertaking their Scientific Research Report. Some questions will require students to explain, justify or evaluate some aspect(s) of their research or the processes they undertook in reaching their research conclusions.	
Questions will require students to apply and integrate knowledge, understanding and skills developed through studying the course and undertaking the Scientific Research Report.	
Internal Assessment	100
<i>The components and weightings for Year 12 are mandatory</i>	
Communicating Scientifically	30
Gathering, Recording, Analysing and Evaluating Data	30
Application of Scientific Research Skills	40
The Year 12 formal school-based assessment program is to reflect the following requirements:	
- the minimum weighting for an individual task is 20% - the maximum weighting for an individual task is 40%	
Three assessment tasks:	
- task one must assess the skills developed in Section 1 of the Scientific Research Portfolio - task two must assess the skills developed in Section 2 of the Scientific Research Portfolio - task three must assess the Scientific Research Report with a weighting of 40%	

Society and Culture

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units each for Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course		

Course Description

The central concern of Society and Culture is the development of social and cultural literacy and a clear understanding of the interaction of persons, societies, cultures, environments and time. Society and Culture draws on cross-disciplinary concepts and social research methods from anthropology, media studies, communication, philosophy, psychology and sociology.

Society and Culture has direct relevance to the immediate needs of students and to their future lives by enabling students to develop understanding of:

- themselves

- their own society and culture
- the societies and cultures of others

Students are provided with the essential concepts, skills, competencies and knowledge to encourage a process of independent thinking that may be used to explain patterns of behaviour, solve problems, and engage in and actively contribute to all of society.

Society and Culture is a conceptually based course that promotes students' awareness of the cultural continuities and changes within societies and cultures. It provides them with skills to critically analyse social theories and

complementary and contrasting viewpoints about people, societies and cultures. Society and Culture promotes an awareness of individuals, groups and institutions and facilitates intercultural understanding and communication.

The study of Society and Culture prepares students for adult life by developing qualities associated with effective citizenship. In doing so, it forms a basis for moving towards a more just society through positive participation in community life and, social and cultural literacy.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- The Social and Cultural World
- Personal and Social identity
- Intercultural Communication

HSC Course (Year 12)

- Personal Interest Project
- Social and Cultural Continuity and Change
- Depth Studies example:
 - Popular Culture
 - Social Inclusion and Exclusion

Course Requirements

N/A

Society and Culture (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
A two-hour written examination, including multiple choice, short answer and extended responses.	60
Personal Interest Project	40
Internal Assessment	100
Knowledge and understanding of course content	50
Application and evaluation of social and cultural research methods	30
Communication of information, ideas and issues in appropriate forms	20

Software Engineering

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units each for Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course	Mathematics Advanced	

Course Description

Software Engineering offers an exciting opportunity for students to experience the complete process of making solutions to real problems. The subject is technical but also centres around the impacts of technology on society and the individual.

The course fosters deep technical understanding including how websites are built to be dynamic and responsive, how machine learning assists people to make better decisions and how to protect software from bad actors across the internet.

Software Engineering promotes a deeper understanding of fundamental concepts, programming languages and innovative technologies leading to greater flexibility when developing software solutions.

Students will develop specific skills in:

- Programming fundamentals
- The Object-Oriented Paradigm
- Programming mechatronics

- Secure software architecture
- Programming for the web
- Software automation

The course is of benefit to students who would like to further their specialised interest in, and knowledge of software engineering and tertiary study of Sciences and Mathematics. It is also of benefit to students who would like to enhance their understanding of computer-based technologies.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

Programming Fundamentals

- Software Development
- Designing Algorithms
- Data for Software Engineering
- Developing Solutions with Code

The Object-Oriented Paradigm

- Understanding OOP
- Programming in OOP

Programming Mechatronics

- Understanding Mechatronic Hardware and Software
- Programming and Building

HSC Course (Year 12)

Secure Software Architecture

- Designing Software
- Designing Secure Code
- Impact of Safe and Secure Software Development

Programming for the Web

- Data Transmission Using the Web
- Designing Web Applications

Software Automation

- Algorithms in Machine Learning
- Programming for Automation
- Significance and Impact of ML and AI

Software Engineering Project

- Identifying and Defining
- Research and Planning
- Producing and Implementing
- Testing and Evaluating

Course Requirements

N/A

Software Engineering (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
HSC Examination The examination will consist of an online examination worth 80 marks Time allowed: 2 hours 30 minutes including 10 minutes reading time It will be undertaken by students using a computer. Headphones will be required for questions with video or audio stimulus. The examination will consist of two types of test item. Objective-response items (approx. 20 marks) Each item will be worth 1 to 4 marks Short-answer items (approx. 60 marks) At least 3 questions will be worth 4 to 8 marks	
Internal Assessment	100
Knowledge and understanding of course content	50
Knowledge and skills in the practical application of content	50

Spanish Beginners

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units each for Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course		This course is designed for students who wish to begin their study of Spanish at senior secondary level. It is intended to cater only for students with no prior knowledge or experience of the Spanish language, either spoken or written, or whose experience is derived solely from, or is equivalent to, its study for 100 hours or less in Stage 4 or Stage 5.

Course Description

Spanish is one of the most widely spoken languages in the world, spoken by more than 500 million people. There are 20 million students of Spanish as a foreign language. Spanish is the official language of 21 countries in addition to being one of the official languages of the European Union, the United Nations and Mercosur. The Spanish language is widely spoken within the Australian community, giving students the opportunity to hear and use the language in real-life situations. Spanish speakers in Australia make significant contributions to the economic, intellectual, cultural and social affairs of the nation.

The Spanish Beginners course provides students with the language skills needed to function effectively in any of the Spanish-speaking countries around the world. It also enables them to experience and develop their understanding of the traditions and culture of these communities.

Spanish Beginners provides students with a better understanding and appreciation of different values and traditions within Spanish-speaking communities in Australia and overseas.

Throughout the course, students are given the opportunity to experience and embrace the richness and diversity of Spanish and Latin American cultures, by

focusing on lifestyles, the arts, cuisine and sport.

The course is studied throughout Years 11 and 12. The prescribed topics for this course are studied from two perspectives. In addition, a range of grammatical features are covered throughout the course. For specific details on grammatical items please refer to the NESA Syllabus. Due to the cumulative process involved in the learning of a language, perspectives, topics and grammatical features are taught using a spiral approach, allowing students to improve their command of Spanish at increasing levels of complexity.

Main Topics Covered

Prescribed Themes

- The Personal World
- The Spanish-Speaking Communities

Mandatory Topics

- Family Life, Home and Neighbourhood
- People, Places and Communities
- Education and Work
- Friends, Recreation and Pastimes
- Holidays, Travel and Tourism
- Future Plans and Aspirations

Course Requirements

This course is designed for students who wish to begin their study of Spanish at senior secondary level. It is intended to cater only for students with no prior knowledge or experience of the Spanish language, either spoken or written, or whose experience is derived solely from, or is equivalent to, its study for 100 hours or less in Stage 4 or Stage 5. Students will be required to complete an Eligibility Statement prior to commencing the course.

Spanish Beginners (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Listening	30
Reading	30
Writing	20
Speaking	20

Spanish Continuers

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units each for Preliminary and HSC Board Developed Course	Students will need to have studied Spanish in Stages 4 and 5	

Course Description

The study of Spanish contributes to the overall education of students, particularly in the areas of communication, cross-cultural understanding, literacy and general knowledge. The study promotes understanding of different attitudes and values within the wider Australian community and beyond.

Spanish is one of the most widely spoken languages in the world, spoken by more than 500 million people. There are 20 million students of Spanish as a foreign language. Spanish is the official language of 21 countries in addition to being one of the official languages of the European Union, the United Nations and Mercosur.

The Spanish language is widely spoken within the Australian community, giving students the opportunity to hear and use the language in real-life situations. Spanish speakers in Australia make significant contributions to the economic, intellectual, cultural and social affairs of the nation.

Spanish Continuers provides students with a better understanding and appreciation of different values and traditions within Spanish-speaking communities in Australia and overseas. Throughout the course, students are given the opportunity to experience and embrace the richness and diversity

of Spanish and Latin American cultures, by focusing on lifestyles, the arts, cuisine and sport.

The course is studied throughout Years 11 and 12. There are three main prescribed themes with topics and sub-topics in the syllabus and a range of grammar points that should be covered. Grammar points can be studied at any time during the two-year course. Indeed, as learning a language is a constant process, themes, topics and grammar points may be revisited, allowing students to improve their usage and understanding of Spanish.

Main Topics Covered

Prescribed Themes

- The Individual
- The Spanish-Speaking Communities
- The Changing World

Prescribed Topics

- Personal Identity
- Education and Future Aspirations
- Leisure and Interests

- Feelings, Opinions, Attitudes and Preferences
- Lifestyles
- Arts and Entertainment
- Travel and Tourism
- The World of Work
- Current Issues and Youth Issues

Course Requirements

N/A

Spanish Continuers (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Listening	30
Reading	30
Writing	20
Speaking	20

Students interested in taking a language at Extension level in Year 12 must contact the Head of Languages to obtain further information.

Studies of Religion I

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
1 Unit for each Preliminary and HSC NESA Developed Course This course must be taken as a 13th unit or in conjunction with another extension course.		

Course Description

Studies of Religion I is a NESA HSC Course that focuses on different religions and beliefs, considering their origins, core beliefs, development and modern practice and implications. The course provides students with a rigorous academic context in which to develop an understanding and critical awareness of the nature and significance of religion and the influence of belief systems and religious traditions on individuals and within society. Students develop comprehension, communication and critical thinking skills as they read texts, discuss interpretations, draw connections between faith and praxis and communicate complex and nuanced information in an accurate and balanced way.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

Nature of Religion and Beliefs

- Includes study of the nature of religion and beliefs, including Australian Aboriginal beliefs and spiritualities, as a distinctive response to the human search for meaning in life.

Two Religious Traditions Studies including Christianity, and one other religion from Buddhism, Hinduism, Judaism and Islam, chosen by the class teacher. Includes study of:

- Origins
- Principal Beliefs
- Sacred Texts and Writings
- Core Ethical Teachings
- Personal Devotion/Expression of Faith/Observance

HSC Course (Year 12)

Religion and Belief Systems in Australia post-1945

- Involves study of religious expression in Australia's multi-cultural and multi-faith society since 1945, including an appreciation of Aboriginal spiritualities and their contribution to an understanding of religious beliefs and religious expression in Australia today.

Two Religious Depth Studies that build on content from the Preliminary Course Religious Tradition Studies (Christianity and one religion from Buddhism, Hinduism, Judaism and Islam). Includes three facets of study relating to each chosen religious depth study:

- Significant People and Ideas
- Ethical Teachings
- Significant Practices in The Life of Adherents

Course Requirements

N/A

Studies of Religion I (continued)

Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	50
Section 1: Religions and Belief Systems in Australia Post-1945	15
Section 2: Religious Traditions Depth Study – short answers	15
Section 3: Religious Traditions Depth Study – extended responses	20
Internal Assessment	50
Knowledge and understanding of course content	20
Sourced based skills	10
Investigation and research	10
Communication of information, ideas and issues in appropriate forms	10

Visual Arts

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC NESAs Developed Course	Students to have studied Stage 5 (Yr 9 and 10) VA or PDM or can give evidence of entrance level technical skills in at least two mediums as judged by the HSC VA teachers and HOD VA	

Course Description

It is helpful to have studied Visual Arts or PDM in Years 9 and 10. Students should enter Year 11 with proficient skills in at least two art mediums.

A high level of personal organisation and time management skills are required to design and make the final Body of Work for the HSC submission. It may also involve extra costs in materials or specialist classes.

The Visual Arts Preliminary and HSC courses enable students to engage with traditional, modern and contemporary art.

Students manage and develop their own skills and explore ideas and concepts that are personally meaningful to them. They visit galleries and exhibitions to gain first-hand knowledge of both historical and current trends in the Visual Arts. Their study encompasses a broad framework of art movements as well as focused research in the form of specialised case studies.

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

This course provides opportunities in artmaking for students to learn how to build a Body of Work which communicates a single theme and showcases the personal interests and skills of the individual student.

They will be encouraged to take risks, explore a range of artmaking practises, be innovative and to experiment with artforms, media and themes. These processes will be documented in their Visual Arts Process diaries, which will be submitted with their Body of Works.

Students learn about art history and criticism through a foundational study of Traditional art movements, Modernism and Post-Modern art. They will practice and develop substantial essay writing skills which identify how the artworks reflect the artists, the artists practice and the cultural context.

HSC Course (Year 12)

This course builds on the Preliminary Course and requires the student to embark on a more mature and self-directed approach to art making and art study.

At this stage, the students will be able to identify their artmaking strengths and apply them to a deep and sustained personal investigation culminating in a more developed Body of Work. They will also have developed their capacity to critique the artwork of others in a more scholarly way.

Year 12 students benefit from the workshop atmosphere of the art room but will also have the confidence to seek resources and resource people outside the classroom.

Their knowledge of artists and art movements will have developed so that students are able to make broad connections from art to other subjects and be able to make sophisticated judgements about unseen as well as known artworks.

Main Topics Covered

Preliminary Course (Year 11)

- From Prehistoric Art to the Renaissance
- Modernism
- Postmodernism
- Visual Arts Writing Essay
- The Frames, Conceptual Framework and Practice
- 3 Independent Case Studies
- Workshops Building Artmaking Skills
- 2 Independent Collections of Artworks
- Focus on Artmaking Process and Documentation

HSC Course (Year 12)

- Undertaking of an Independent Body of Work and Process Documentation in Visual Arts Process Diary
- Exhibition of Artworks
- Examination Technique and Essay Writing
- 5 Independent Case Studies which may include: International Contemporary Sculpture, Contemporary Chinese Art, Curatorial Study of the Sensations Exhibition, Contemporary Australian Indigenous Art, Body and Gender Issues

Visual Arts (continued)

Course Requirements	
N/A	
Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)	
Assessment Component	Weighting
External Examination	100
Written Paper (1 hour 30 minutes)	50
Body of Work	50
Internal Assessment	100
Art making	50
Art Criticism/Art History	50

External Language Courses - HSC

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC NESA Developed Course	Language and level of study must not be available at SACS Vary with course studied, please discuss with Mrs Phipps	Only one course may be studied in any given Language. For other conditions, please discuss with Mrs Phipps

Course Description		
Language Courses may be studied through either NSW School of Languages or Secondary College of Languages.	NSW School of Languages Courses will be timetabled here at St Andrew's and you will be expected to do your work during those lessons, including one Speaking Lesson per week.	Secondary College of Language Courses are run on a Saturday morning at a number of campuses across Sydney. Students who study these courses will have Study Periods on their timetable which should be used to study for their other subjects.
Main Topics Covered		
Please see Mrs Phipps for Course specific details.		
Course Requirements		
Students will be required to complete enrolment forms which will need to be accepted prior to confirmation of subject choice. You will also be required to complete school-specific agreements. There is an additional cost associated with these courses. Please see Mrs Phipps for more details. <i>Students interested in taking a language at Extension level in Year 12 will also need to apply next year. Similar conditions will apply.</i>		
Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)		
Assessment Component	Weighting	
External Examination	100	

TVET Courses

+ Units	✓ Prerequisites	✗ Exclusions
1 or 2 Units for each of Preliminary and HSC Board Developed and Board Endorsed Course	There are no prerequisites for most courses Please see Mrs Phipps for details	Exclusions will vary between courses. For these and other conditions, please discuss with Mrs Phipps

Course Description		
TVET Courses are studied at TAFE Colleges, generally but not always one afternoon per week	Different TAFE Colleges offer different courses at any given time. Students will be expected to make their own arrangements to travel to and from TAFE.	Students undertaking TVET Courses will have Study Periods placed on their timetable. It will be their responsibility to catch up on work missed due to TAFE at these times. Teachers will not be available to provide individual tuition and the students should ascertain what work needs to be completed on their own initiative, teachers will provide relevant materials and instructions as necessary via the usual communication channels for that subject.
Please see Mrs Phipps for Course-specific details		
Main Topics Covered		
Please see Mrs Phipps for details		
Course Requirements		
Students will be required to complete enrolment forms which will need to be accepted prior to confirmation of subject choice. You will also be required to complete school-specific agreements. There is an additional cost associated with these courses. Please see Mrs Phipps for more details.		
Assessment Information (HSC Course Only)		
Assessment Component	Weighting	
All courses will have competencies that must be completed	N/A	
Framework Courses will have a Work Placement Requirement	N/A	
Framework Courses have an optional External Examination	100	



International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme



IB Mission Statement

“The International Baccalaureate aims to develop inquiring, knowledgeable and caring young people who help to create a better and more peaceful world through intercultural understanding and respect.

To this end the IB works with schools, governments and international organisations to develop challenging programmes of international education and rigorous assessment.

These programmes encourage students across the world to become active, compassionate and lifelong learners who understand that other people, with their differences, can also be right.”

The Diploma Programme

The Diploma Programme is a two-year programme for senior students in the final two years of school. The Diploma Programme curriculum model consists of six academic subject groups which students study concurrently, surrounding the IB Learner Profile, Approaches to Teaching and Learning and the core requirements of Theory of Knowledge (TOK), Creativity Activity Service (CAS) and the Extended Essay (EE). The aim is to provide international understanding, encourage responsible citizenship, and to provide student-centred learning. Students are provided with expanded focus, international recognition, depth and breadth of curriculum, inclusion of all subjects studied and the opportunity for collaborative learning and rigour, which prepares students well for the demands of university.

The IB Diploma Programme is also based on inquiry, focused on conceptual understanding, developed in local and global contexts, focused on effective teamwork and collaboration, differentiated to meet the needs of all learners and informed by assessment.

Students who satisfy the requirements for an IB Diploma demonstrate a strong commitment to learning, both in terms of mastery of subject content and in the development of the skills and discipline necessary for success in a competitive and ever-changing world. All IB Diploma Programme students are required to take one subject from each of the six subject groups (with the exception of Group 6, where students can choose to study another subject from Groups 2, 3 or 4 instead of a Group 6 subject). Environmental Systems and Societies (ESS) is the exception, as it covers both Groups 3 and 4. If a student chooses this subject, they could then choose two Group 6 subjects or pick up another subject from Group 2, 3 or 4. At least three and not more than four subjects are taken at higher level (HL), while the remaining subjects are taken at standard level (SL).

When students are selecting IB Diploma Programme subjects, they should not only keep in mind those subjects which they enjoy and are good at, but they should also be thinking about their likely university courses and possible careers, as these can have a significant effect on their subject selection.

Each examined subject is marked on a scale of 1 (minimum) to 7 (maximum). The award of the Diploma requires a minimum of 24 points, the satisfactory completion of an Extended Essay (EE) and a course entitled Theory of Knowledge (TOK) and satisfactory participation in Creativity, Activity, Service (CAS). There are also other conditions that need to be satisfied.

The maximum IB Diploma score is 45, as Theory of Knowledge and the Extended Essay contribute to the overall score through a matrix system which awards up to three points, called 'core points,' based on the candidate's combined performance.

The IB Diploma Programme is offered by St Andrew's Cathedral School as it:

- Complements the ethos of St Andrew's Cathedral School
- Complements the school's current curricular, co-curricular and community service programmes.
- Provides an internationally recognised academic programme of study, the IB Diploma Programme.

Who should study in the IB Diploma Programme?

The IB Diploma Programme is suitable for students who aspire to university study in Australia or overseas and are interested in a senior credential which is international in curriculum content and is recognised by universities around the world for its combination of in-depth academic study and activities which encourage a sense of adventure and social responsibility. The IB Diploma Programme caters for a great range of student needs and talents and fosters an intrinsic interest in learning in a broad range of areas.

Students who wish to study the IB Diploma Programme should be:

- Seeking to study at university in Australia or overseas.
- Independent learners.
- Critical thinkers.
- Willing to work with diligence and commitment and be serious about their study.
- Flexible
- Conscientious and consistent workers.
- Motivated and focused.
- Interested in a range of areas.
- Broadly based in their knowledge.
- Interested in developing international awareness.
- Seeking a challenge.

Potential IB Diploma Programme students must also have:

- An understanding and willingness to study a second language, as well as subjects from the areas of the Humanities, Sciences and Mathematics.
- An understanding of what is expected to fulfil the requirements of CAS, TOK and the EE.

- An understanding that the IB Diploma Programme is for those who can engage across subject areas.
- The ability to achieve an ATAR of approximately 80 and above.

When choosing between studying the IB Diploma Programme and the HSC, students should take into account which one best suits them. The two programmes should be considered as equal, but different, educational options. It is essential that students work with consistency, commitment and dedication from the beginning of Year 11. Students should consider the following when deciding whether or not the IB Diploma Programme or the HSC is more suited to their needs:

- Course structure (the IBDP is a two-year course)
- Styles of learning
- Methods of assessment
- Student requirements
- University entry

Students should read the IB Learner Profile carefully and reflect upon their ability to develop the IB Learner Profile characteristics in all of their subject areas, over the two years.

Student suitability for the IB Diploma Programme

Students electing to study the IB Diploma Programme at St Andrew's will be advised as to their suitability. This will take into account:

- Course structure
- Style of learning
- Methods of assessment
- Subject Choices
- Work ethic
- Level of independence and organisation
- Likelihood of achieving a pass level in the IB (equivalent to an ATAR of 80+)

Staff will be asked to provide feedback on a student's compatibility with the course. Heads of Department will sign off on the suitability of subject choices for subjects within their departments, for each student.

All Year 10 students are interviewed by the Director of Learning: Middle School and IB Diploma Programme, Head of Careers and Pathways. The purpose of these interviews is to assess student suitability for the IBDP. Feedback will also be provided on the suitability of the subjects chosen by the student. Any concerns will be expressed to the student's parents following these interviews.

IB Fees

Are there additional charges to do the IBDP?

Yes, the school charges an additional IB charge as follows:

Year 11: \$310 each term (4 terms)

Year 12: \$310 each term (3 terms)

This charge covers the IB Diploma Programme registration fee and examination fees.

Assessment and Reporting

The main purpose for assessment in the Diploma Programme is to support and encourage student learning. It is formative, as it develops students' skills and knowledge, and also summative in that it provides an assessment of student achievement. Criteria based referencing is used in the IB Diploma Programme to measure how a student's score compares to a pre-determined distribution of performance. Carefully defined grade descriptors and appropriate moderation strategies help to achieve consistency of standards in internal assessments.

Classroom teachers and IB examiners work in partnership to ensure that students have ample opportunity to demonstrate what they have learned. Responsibility for all academic judgements about the quality of candidates' work rests with examiners worldwide, led by Chief Examiners with international authority in their fields.

External examinations and written assessments

External assessments are assessed by an examiner who is not the candidate's teacher. These include a written examination taken in the November of the second year of the IBDP which could consist of two or three papers, taken separately and sometimes on different days. Examinations vary in length and may include aural and written, long and short responses, data-based questions, essays and multiple-choice questions. Assessment components other than examination papers could include Extended Essays, Theory of Knowledge Essays, language oral examinations and a process portfolio. The finished product is the focus for these assessments. External assessment can count for up to 80% of the final grade in the subject.

Internal Assessment

Internally assessed work usually counts for a minimum of 20 per cent of the final grade in the subject. Internally assessed work is evaluated by examiners in a process called external moderation of internal assessment and grades may be adjusted to ensure consistency for all candidates.

Internal Assessments could include speaking tasks, project work, field work, laboratory practical work and mathematical investigations.

School Based Tasks are formative assessments developed within the school. These assessments do not contribute to the final IB Diploma Grade but may be used to determine the predicted grade which is submitted for each subject to the IB by the school prior to the final examinations. These tasks are set by teachers and are used to develop, improve and refine the skills necessary for success in IB Diploma Programme examinations and assessments.

School reports in each subject are based on a combination of Internal Assessments and School Based Tasks. The emphasis on formal Internal Assessments increases as the student progresses through Year 11 and 12.

Final Grading Scale

Each subject is graded on the following scale:

- Grade 7 Excellent performance
- Grade 6 Very Good performance
- Grade 5 Good performance
- Grade 4 Satisfactory performance
- Grade 3 Mediocre performance
- Grade 2 Poor performance
- Grade 1 Very Poor performance

Up to an additional three core points may be earned from the Extended Essay and Theory of Knowledge. A candidate's performance in each will fall into one of five grades:

- Grade A Work of an excellent standard
- Grade B Work of a good standard
- Grade C Work of a satisfactory standard
- Grade D Work of a mediocre standard
- Grade E Work of an elementary standard

The total number of core points awarded is determined according to the following matrix:

Theory of Knowledge							
Extended Essay		Grade A	Grade B	Grade C	Grade D	Grade E	No Grade N
	Grade A	3	3	2	2	Failing Condition	Failing Condition
	Grade B	3	2	2	1	Failing Condition	Failing Condition
	Grade C	2	2	1	0	Failing Condition	Failing Condition
	Grade D	2	1	0	0	Failing Condition	Failing Condition
	Grade E	Failing Condition	Failing Condition	Failing Condition	Failing Condition	Failing Condition	Failing Condition
	No Grade N	Failing Condition	Failing Condition	Failing Condition	Failing Condition	Failing Condition	Failing Condition

The total IB grade is calculated by adding the six subjects, each scored out of 7, and the additional points (up to a maximum of 3 points) from the Extended Essay and Theory of Knowledge. The maximum score possible is 45 points.

Award of the Diploma

All assessment components for each of the six subjects and the additional IB Diploma requirements must be completed in order to qualify for the award of an IB Diploma. The IB Diploma will not be awarded to a candidate in the following circumstances:

1. CAS requirements have not been met.
2. Candidate's total points are fewer than 24.
3. An N has been given for Theory of Knowledge, Extended Essay or for a contributing subject.
4. A grade E has been awarded for one or both of Theory of Knowledge and the Extended Essay.
5. There is a grade 1 awarded in a subject/level.
6. A Grade 2 has been awarded three or more times (HL or SL).
7. A Grade 3 or below has been awarded four or more times (HL or SL).
8. A Candidate has gained fewer than 12 points on HL subjects (for candidates who register for four HL subjects, the three highest grades count).
9. A Candidate has gained fewer than 9 points on SL subjects (candidates who register for two SL subjects must gain at least 5 points at SL).

Academic Integrity

Academic integrity is being truthful about one's own academic work and always acknowledging the work of others.

Academic integrity is a significant component of learning in all subjects and is relevant in all areas of the Diploma Programme. It includes respecting intellectual property, producing authentic work in examinations and hand in submissions of all types, and behaving appropriately in examinations.

The IB takes academic integrity very seriously. At St Andrew's Cathedral School, students are taught how to act with academic integrity throughout the Diploma Programme in each of their subjects and also in IB Meetings which are held fortnightly. There is a focus on producing work of a high academically honest standard and students are extensively counselled on their own work.

Students will be expected to conform to the highest standards of academic integrity and ethical scholarship and will be asked to sign the Academic Code of Honour as an indication of their intention to do so. Individual students are ultimately responsible for ensuring that all work submitted for assessment is authentic, with the work or ideas of others fully and correctly acknowledged. Students are expected to comply with all internal school deadlines and are also encouraged to submit work early so as to allow time to do a thorough check of the final draft, including referencing. It is important to note that issues of academic integrity are serious and are potential failure conditions for a course and therefore the Diploma.

Retaking a Subject

Students who perform poorly on a subject and wish to retake it may re-sit individual subjects in a later examination session, including May sessions. St Andrew's students can re-sit these exams at St Andrew's Cathedral School. Students should contact the Director of Learning: IB Diploma Programme to make arrangements for re-sits. These examinations incur extra costs, which are outlined to students and parents at the conclusion of Year 12 in the document "Release of Results Booklet".

University Entry

The IB Diploma Programme provides an alternative method of achieving tertiary entrance that is highly regarded by universities in Australia and around the world. The IB Diploma gives direct access to the most prestigious universities. Since 1969, universities in multiple countries have accepted the IB Diploma. IBDP scores are automatically sent to any university in the world chosen by the student. IB graduates are held in very high regard by universities and in some cases, students can apply for advanced standing for strong results in Higher Level subjects.

For entry to Australian universities, the Diploma results translate into an Australian Tertiary Admission Ranking (ATAR). The student's final score out of 45 (based on a maximum of 7 points awarded per subject and 3 core points for Extended Essay and Theory of Knowledge) is automatically converted, without scaling, to an ATAR rank. Higher Level and Standard Level courses contribute equal value for the ATAR. The table for Year 12IBDP 2024 university entries for 2024 can be found at:

<https://ibaustralasia.org/university-entrance/>

- a. *The Universities Admissions Centre (UAC) which services application for NSW and ACT universities, has introduced a new conversion system where each IBDP score now has four levels of ATAR conversion value. This is known as the IB Admissions Score (IBAS) and will be used as course entry requirements by universities. For more information, please refer to the above link.*
- b. *To be eligible for the award of an IB Diploma students must obtain a minimum of 24 points and meet other completion requirements. Up to three core points may be awarded for the performance in the Extended Essay and Theory of Knowledge.*
- c. *If the student is not eligible for the award of the IB Diploma, the qualification is deemed not assessable.*

Course Structure

The International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme runs across two full years with no division between work undertaken in Years 11 and 12. All content covered in both Years 11 and 12 is examinable.

To be eligible for the award of the Diploma all candidates must complete:

- Six academic subjects
- A Theory of Knowledge course
- An Extended Essay
- Creativity, Activity, Service (CAS)
- Christian Development (this is a requirement specific to St Andrew's Cathedral School students)

The programme consists of a study of six subjects.

- Group 1: Studies in Language and Literature
- Group 2: Language Acquisition
- Group 3: Individuals and Societies
- Group 4: Sciences
- Group 5: Mathematics
- Group 6: The Arts



IBO. (n.d.). *Logos and programme models : IB Diploma Programme model*. Retrieved May 15, 2022 from <https://www.ibo.org/globalassets/digital-toolkit/logos-and-programme-models/dp-model-en.png>

Inclusive Access Arrangements (IAA)

Applications for Inclusive Access Arrangement provisions may be made via the Director of Learning: Middle School and IB Diploma Programme in consultation with the Head of Specialised Learning. The Director of Learning: Middle School and IB Diploma Programme will then submit an application to the IB. The IB may approve Inclusive Assessment Arrangements if a student has a special need that would, in a normal examination situation, prevent him/her from reading and interpreting the examination questions or communicating his/her response. If the application is approved by the IB, where possible, the school will implement these arrangements for school-based assessments. It is important that students lodge their applications with the Director of Learning: Middle School and IB Diploma Programme at the earliest opportunity.

IB Diploma Programme Curriculum

Students proceeding into Years 11 and 12 have a wide range of subjects from which to choose and, as far as possible, the courses are arranged and timetabled to meet student needs and preferences. In past years the timetable has consistently allowed a very high percentage of students to be accommodated with all of their subject choices.

The following information provides broad descriptions of the courses available for study and should be helpful to students as they select the courses they wish to study for the IBDP. The descriptions provide information about the course aims, content, and Internal Assessment and External Assessment requirements for each course.

The school reserves the right to vary the suite of courses offered, the content areas of the courses, and the methods of assessment. Courses will only be offered if sufficient interest is shown, if there is a teacher with the necessary qualifications and if timetabling parameters allow.

Academic Subjects

Subject groups

The curriculum consists of six subject groups. Subjects may be offered at Higher and/or Standard Level. Students must:

- Undertake a compulsory study of Christian Development (which will not count towards the Diploma Programme)
- Choose 1 Subject from each of Groups 1, 2 and 5
- Choose a Group 3 and a Group 4 subject. Environmental Systems and Societies (ESS) covers both Groups 3 and 4. If students choose ESS, they can then choose two more subjects from Groups 2, 3, 4, and 6. If students do not choose ESS, they must choose one Group 3 subject and 1 Group 4 subject, and then one further subject from Groups 2, 3, 4 or 6
- Take at least three and not more than four of the six subjects at Higher Level (240 hours) and the others at Standard Level (150 hours)

Group 2 Japanese ab initio and Spanish ab initio are beginner's language courses. All other IB Diploma languages offered at the school require that students have studied that language up to Year 10 level. There will be eligibility checks to determine student eligibility for all language courses.

As with all subjects offered at Senior Level at St Andrew's, a subject will run only if there are sufficient students to form viable classes. Not all combinations of subjects may be possible.

Higher Level or Standard Level?

Most IBDP subjects are offered at both Higher Level (HL) and Standard Level (SL). The difference between HL and SL depends on the subject studied. In some subjects the difference is one of depth, with HL students undertaking more detailed study of topics common to both the HL and SL course. In other subjects the difference is evident in both the depth and breadth of study; in such HL subjects, students are exposed to a broader range of topics than their SL counterparts.

The choice between two different levels in each subject allows students to pursue an intensive study of their preferred specialities, while still maintaining sufficient exposure to the other fields of knowledge to ensure that balance is achieved. The HL subjects allow for depth, whilst the SL subjects allow for breadth.

Group	Subject Group	Subjects offered at St Andrew's Cathedral School in 2020/2021	Levels available
1	Studies in Language and Literature	Language and Literature (English) Literature (English)	Higher & Standard
2	Language Acquisition	Chinese B, French B, Japanese ab initio, Spanish ab initio, Spanish B	Standard
3	Individuals and Societies	Business Management, Global Politics, History, Philosophy, Psychology	Higher & Standard
3/4*	Interdisciplinary	Environmental Systems and Societies	Higher & Standard
4	Experimental Sciences	Biology, Chemistry, Computer Science, Design Technology, Physics, Sports Exercise Health Science	Higher & Standard
5	Mathematics	Mathematics Analysis and Approaches Mathematics Applications and Interpretation	Higher & Standard
6	The Arts	Film, Music, Theatre, Visual Arts or second subject from Group 2, 3 or 4	Higher & Standard

*Students may select this subject as either subject 3 or subject 4

Subjects languages – should you have any queries regarding language offerings, please contact Mrs Munro.

Creativity, Activity Service (CAS)



The Core of the IB Diploma Programme

Course Description

Creativity, Activity, Service (CAS) is a framework for experiential learning and reflection about that learning. CAS is intended to provide experiences for students to develop self-confidence and empathy, and a willingness to help others. They may directly confront or indirectly engage in work on global problems or work directly with other people at a local level, developing their capacity to function collaboratively and effectively with others. CAS provides a counterbalance to the academic load of the School curriculum. The IB's aim of educating the whole person comes alive in a practical, demonstrable way through CAS, when students are involved in the community, whether at a local, national or international level.

To be eligible for the IB Diploma, students must engage in extra-curricular community service experiences representing Creativity, Activity and Service.

"...if you believe in something, you must not just think or talk or write, but you must act." (Peterson 2003)

CAS is at the heart of the Diploma Programme and is organised around the three strands of Creativity, Activity and Service.

The three strands of CAS are mutually reinforcing. Together, they enable students to recognise that there are many opportunities to learn about life, self and others and to inspire confidence, determination and commitment.

Creative and physical experiences are particularly important for adolescents, and they offer many favourable situations for the involvement and enjoyment at a time that is for young people, stressful and uncertain.

The service element of CAS is perhaps the most significant of the three, in terms of the development of respect for others, and responsibility and empathy.

The CAS Programme should be both challenging and enjoyable; a personal journey of self-discovery. The experiences undertaken must have tangible results and offer real benefits to others. Reflection on their experience is also an important part of student involvement in CAS.

Main Topics Covered

CAS involves:

- Students engaging in CAS experiences that involve one or more of the three CAS strands.

- Students undertaking a CAS project of at least one month's duration. This project would include collaboration, problem solving and decision making.

- Students achieving the seven CAS learning outcomes.

Assessment Component Information

External Examination

There is no formal assessment in CAS. Students will enter experiences and reflections into an electronic journal in ManageBac. CAS Advisers can access this journal to monitor progress.

Students will successfully complete CAS when the CAS Coordinator, CAS Advisors and the Director of Learning: IB Diploma Programme are satisfied that the seven CAS learning outcomes set out in the CAS programme have been successfully covered.

It is essential that the CAS activities do not replicate other parts of the student's Diploma Programme work.

Extended Essay (EE)

Core

The Core of the IB Diploma Programme

Course Description

The Extended Essay is one of the three core components of the IB Diploma Programme. Students are required to research and write an independent research paper of 4000 words on a topic of their choice and in response to a research question they formulate.

Their topic is chosen from one of the IB Diploma Programme Subjects they are studying. Students are allocated a supervisor who will guide them in this process according to the guidelines set out in the Extended Essay Guide.

Throughout the process students are required to reflect on the process of researching and writing their essay.

Main Topics Covered

The aims of the Extended Essay (as outlined in The IB Diploma Programme: Extended Essay Guide) are to provide students with the opportunity to:

- pursue independent research on a focused topic

- develop research and communication skills.
- develop the skills of creative and critical thinking.
- engage in a systematic process of research appropriate to the subject

- experience the excitement of intellectual discovery

Assessment Component Information

External Assessment

The Extended Essay is externally assessed against common criteria, which are interpreted appropriately for each subject. Combined with the grade for Theory of Knowledge, the Extended Essay contributes up to three points to the total score for the IB Diploma.

The essay must be:

- approximately 4000 words
- based on individual research
- written on any topic related to an IB subject offered by the school.
- Students should spend approximately 40-60 hours writing the Extended Essay, which is completed over an approximately 10-month period beginning during Term 2 in Year 11, with final submission towards the ends of Term 2 in Year 12.

Theory of Knowledge (TOK)



The Core of the IB Diploma Programme		
Course Description		
The TOK course is a central element of the Diploma Programme and makes up part of the core. It is a course that encourages and enables students to think critically about different kinds of knowledge, providing them with an explicit opportunity as learners to reflect on what they know and how they know it.	Students focus on asking analytical abstract questions, giving reasoned, well-supported arguments in response to such questions and exploring different perspectives. As they study each of their Group Subjects, students analyse, evaluate and compare knowledge across five key areas of knowledge.	Students also reflect on themselves as knowers, analysing and evaluating their own perspectives, assumptions and approaches, as well as those of the society we live in. The TOK course aims to embody many of the attributes needed by a citizen of the world: self-awareness, a reflective, critical approach, interest in other people's points of view, and a sense of responsibility.
Main Topics Covered		
Five areas of knowledge: • Arts • History • Natural sciences • Human sciences • Mathematics	Core theme: knowledge and the knower Two optional themes out of: • Knowledge and technology • Knowledge and politics • Knowledge and religion • Knowledge and language • Knowledge and indigenous societies	Each area of knowledge and each theme is explored using the knowledge framework: • Scope • Perspectives • Methods and tools • Ethics

Assessment Component Information	Weighting
External Assessment	20
Essay (1,200–1,600 words) on a prescribed title chosen from a list of six titles prescribed by the IB for each examination session.	
Internal Assessment	10
Exhibition (950 words), in which three objects are analysed in relation to a complex question about knowledge. This assessment task is marked internally and submitted to the IB for moderation.	

Language and Literature Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 1: Studies in Language and Literature

Course Description

In this course, students study a wide range of literary and non-literary texts in a variety of media. Text types that will be studied range from more traditional literary forms, such as novels, plays and poetry, while also covering more modern mediums such as articles, advertising, speeches, cartoons and film.

By examining communicative acts across literary form and textual type alongside appropriate secondary readings, students will investigate the nature of language itself and the ways in which it shapes and is influenced by identity and culture. Approaches to study in the course are meant to be wide ranging and can include literary theory, sociolinguistics, media studies and critical discourse analysis among others.

In the Language A: Language and Literature course, students will learn about the complex and dynamic nature of language and explore both its practical and aesthetic dimensions.

Throughout the course, students will explore the various ways in which language choices, text types, literary forms and contextual elements all effect meaning. Through close analysis of various text types and literary forms, students will consider their own interpretations, as well as the critical perspectives of others, to explore how such positions are shaped by cultural belief systems and to negotiate meanings for texts.

Students will engage in activities that involve them in the process of production and help shape their critical awareness of how texts and their associated visual and audio elements work together to influence the audience/reader, and how audiences/readers open up the possibilities of texts.

With its focus on a wide variety of communicative acts, the course is meant to develop sensitivity to the foundational nature, and pervasive influence, of language in the world at large.

In addition, HL students will have a fourth assessment component, the Higher Level (HL) essay, a written coursework task that requires students to explore a line of inquiry in relation to a studied non-literary text or texts, or a literary text or work. The outcome of this exploration is a 1200-1500 word essay, in which HL students are expected to demonstrate a deeper understanding of the nature of linguistic or literary study.

Subject entry requirements:

Year 10 results:

HL: Average of 6 across all MYP criteria as well as a 6 or above in criteria A and D.

SL: Average of 6 across all MYP criteria as well as a 6 or above in criteria A and D.

Main Topics Covered

Area of Exploration 1: Readers, Writers and Texts

This study includes the investigation of how texts themselves operate, as well as the contexts and complexities of production and reception. Focus is on the development of personal and critical responses to the particulars of communication: how texts effectively communicate their purpose to an audience.

Area of Exploration 2: Time and Space

Their study focuses on the contexts of language use and the variety of ways literary and non-literary texts might both reflect and shape society at large. The focus is on the consideration of personal and cultural perspectives, the development of broader perspectives and an awareness of the ways in which context is tied to meaning.

Area of Exploration 3: Intertextuality: Connecting Texts

Their study focuses on intertextual relationships with possibilities to explore various topics, thematic concerns, genre conventions, modes or literary traditions that have been introduced throughout the course. The focus is on the development of critical response grounded in an understanding of the complex relationships among texts.

Language and Literature Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Assessment	70
Paper 1: Guided literary analysis (1 hour 15 minutes)	35
The paper consists of two non-literary passages, from two different text types, each accompanied by a question. Students choose one passage and write an analysis of it. (20 marks).	35
Paper 2: Comparative essay (1 hour 45 minutes).	
The paper consists of four general questions. In response to one question, students write a comparative essay based on two works studied in the course. (30 marks)	
Internal Assessment	30
This component consists of an Individual Oral which is internally assessed by the teacher and externally moderated by the IB at the end of the course.	
Individual Oral (15 minutes)	30
Supported by an extract from both one non-literary text and one from a literary work, students will offer a prepared response of 10 minutes, followed by 5 minutes of questions by the teacher, to the following prompt:	
Examine the ways in which the global issue of your choice is presented through the content and form of two of the works that you have studied (40 marks).	
Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	Weighting
External Assessment	80
Paper 1: Guided textual analysis (2 hours 15 minutes)	35
The paper consists of two non-literary passages, from two different text types, each accompanied by a question. Students write an analysis of each of the passages. (40 marks)	
Paper 2: Comparative essay (1 hour 45 minutes)	25
The paper consists of four general questions. In response to one question students write a comparative essay based on two works studied in the course. (30 marks)	
HL Essay:	20
Students submit an essay on one non-literary text or a collection of non-literary texts by one same author, or a literary text or work studied during the course. The essay must be 1,200-1,500 words in length. (20 marks).	
Internal Assessment	20
This component consists of an individual oral which is internally assessed by the teacher and externally moderated by the IB at the end of the course.	
Individual Oral	20
Individual Oral (15 minutes) 20%	
Supported by an extract from both one non-literary text and one from a literary work, students will offer a prepared response of 10 minutes, followed by 5 minutes of questions by the teacher, to the following prompt:	
Examine the ways in which the global issue of your choice is presented through the content and form of two of the works that you have studied. (40 marks).	

Literature Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 1: Studies in Language and Literature

Course Description

In the Language A: Literature course, students will learn about the various manifestations of literature as a powerful mode of writing across cultures and throughout history. They will explore and develop an understanding of factors that contribute to the production and reception of literature, such as:

- The creativity of writers and readers.
- The nature of the interaction with the writers' and readers' respective contexts and with literary tradition.
- The ways in which language can give rise to meaning and/or effect.
- The performative and transformative potential of literary creation and response.

Through close analysis of literary texts in a number of forms and from different times and places, students will consider their own interpretations, as well as the critical perspectives of others. In turn, this will encourage the exploration of how viewpoints are shaped by cultural belief systems and how meanings are negotiated within them.

The focus of textual study will be on the following text types:

- Novels/novellas
- Plays
- Poetry
- Short stories
- Graphic novels

Students will be involved in processes of critical response and creative production, which will help shape their awareness of how texts work to influence the reader and how readers open up the possibilities of texts. With its focus on literature, this course is particularly concerned with developing sensitivity to aesthetic uses of language and empowering students to consider the ways in which literature represents and constructs the world and social and cultural identities.

Subject entry requirements

Year 10 results:

HL: Average of 6 across all MYP criteria as well as a 6 or above in criteria A and D.

SL: Average of 6 across all MYP criteria as well as a 6 or above in criteria A and D.

Main Topics Covered

Area of Exploration 1: Readers, Writers and Texts

This study includes the investigation of how texts themselves operate, as well as the contexts and complexities of production and reception. Focus is on the development of personal and critical responses to the particulars of communication: how texts effectively communicate their thematic ideas to an audience.

Area of Exploration 2: Time and Space

Their study focuses on the contexts of language use and the variety of ways literary texts might both reflect and shape society at large. The focus is on the consideration of personal and cultural perspectives, the development of broader perspectives, and an awareness of the ways in which context is tied to meaning.

Area of Exploration 3: Intertextuality: Connecting Texts

Their study focuses on intertextual relationships with possibilities to explore various topics, thematic concerns, genre conventions, modes or literary traditions that have been introduced throughout the course. The focus is on the development of critical response grounded in an understanding of the complex relationships among texts.

Literature (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Assessment	70
Paper 1: Guided literary analysis (1 hour 15 minutes) The paper consists of two passages from two different literary forms, each accompanied by a question. Students choose one passage and write an analysis of it. (20 marks)	35
Paper 2: Comparative essay (1 hour 45 minutes) The paper consists of four general questions. In response to one question, students write a comparative essay based on two works studied in the course. (30 marks)	35
Internal Assessment	30
This component consists of an Individual Oral that is internally assessed by the teacher and externally moderated by the IB at the end of the course.	
Individual Oral: (15 minutes) Supported by an extract from one work written originally in the language studied and one from a work studied in translation, students will offer a prepared response of 10 minutes, followed by 5 minutes of questions by the teacher, to the following prompt: Examine the ways in which the global issue of your choice is presented through the content and form of two of the works that you have studied. (40 marks)	
Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	Weighting
External Assessment	80
Paper 1: Guided literary analysis (2 hours 15 minutes) The paper consists of two literary passages, from two different literary forms, each accompanied by a question. Students write an analysis of each of the passages. (40 marks)	35
Paper 2: Comparative essay (1 hour 45 minutes) The paper consists of four general questions. In response to one question, students write a comparative essay based on two works studied in the course. (30 marks)	25
Higher Level (HL) essay: Students submit an essay on one literary text or work studied during the course. (20 marks). The essay must be 1,200-1,500 words in length.	20
Internal Assessment	20
This component consists of an Individual Oral that is internally assessed by the teacher and externally moderated by the IB at the end of the course.	
Individual Oral (15 minutes) Supported by an extract from one work written originally in the language studied and one from a work studied in translation, students will offer a prepared response of 10 minutes, followed by 5 minutes of questions by the teacher, to the following prompt: Examine the ways in which the global issue of your choice is presented through the content and form of two of the works that you have studied. (40 marks)	20

Chinese B Standard Level (SL)

Group
2

Group 2: Language Acquisition

Course Description

The Chinese B Course is to be offered at standard level. It is for students with previous experience of the target language and focuses on the continued acquisition and development of the language through equal emphasis on listening, speaking, reading and writing. The Chinese B Course allows students to attain a high degree of competence

in the language and to explore the Chinese-speaking world, thus increasing students' cultural awareness and understanding of the importance of internationalism in today's society. Over a two-year period, students will be able to learn to communicate effectively in a number of situations and within the culture(s) where Chinese is spoken,

with the ability to work with and produce a range of text types. The four primary language skills of listening, speaking, reading and writing are developed in an integrated way, through use of a wide range of texts or material that serve particular communicative purposes and make students aware of how culture may influence the language.

Main Topics Covered

The course is divided into five prescribed themes:

- Identities
- Experiences
- Human ingenuity
- Social organisation
- Sharing the planet

The themes allow students to compare the target language and culture(s) to other languages and cultures with which they are familiar. The themes also provide opportunities for students to make connections to other disciplinary areas in the Diploma Programme.

In the Language B course, the five themes are prescribed, but the recommended topics and possible questions are to be considered indicative content. The five themes will all be addressed equally. However, teachers will work with the themes and topic areas in a way that best helps them to organise a course plan and build upon students' interests and that best helps students to meet the expectations of the syllabus.

Assessment Component Information

Weighting

External Examination

75

Paper 1 (1 hour 15 minutes)

25

Productive skills - writing (30 marks)

One writing task of 300-480 characters from a choice of three, each from a different theme, choosing a text type from among those listed in the examination instructions.

Paper 2 (1 hour 45 minutes)

Receptive skills—separate sections for listening and reading (65 marks)

Listening comprehension (45 minutes) (25 marks)

25

Reading comprehension (1 hour) (40 marks)

25

Comprehension exercises on three audio passages and three written texts, drawn from all five themes.

Internal Assessment

25

This component is internally assessed by the teacher and externally moderated by the IB at the end of the course.

25

Individual oral assessment

A conversation with the teacher, based on a visual stimulus, followed by discussion based on an additional theme (30 marks).

French B Standard Level (SL)

Group
2

Group 2: Language Acquisition		
Course Description		
The French B Course is to be offered at standard level. It is for students with previous experience of the target language and focuses on the continued acquisition and development of the language through equal emphasis on listening, speaking, reading and writing. The French B courses allow students to attain a high degree of competence in	the language and to explore the French-speaking world, thus increasing students' cultural awareness and understanding of the importance of internationalism in today's society. Over a two- year period students will be able to learn to communicate effectively in a number of situations and within the culture(s) where French is spoken,	with the ability to work with and produce a range of text types. The four primary language skills of listening, speaking, reading and writing are developed in an integrated way, through use of a wide range of texts or material that serve particular communicative purposes and make students aware of how culture may influence the language.
Main Topics Covered		
The course is divided into five prescribed themes: - Identities - Experiences - Human ingenuity - Human ingenuity - Social organisation - Sharing the planet.	The themes allow students to compare the target language and culture(s) to other languages and cultures with which they are familiar. The themes also provide opportunities for students to make connections to other disciplinary areas in the Diploma Programme.	In the Language B course, the five themes are prescribed, but the recommended topics and possible questions are to be considered indicative content. The five themes will all be addressed equally. However, teachers will work with the themes and topic areas in a way that best helps them to organise a course plan and build upon students' interests and that best helps students to meet the expectations of the syllabus.

Assessment Component Information	Weighting
External Examination	75
Paper 1 (1 hour 15 minutes)	25
Productive skills—writing (30 marks)	
One writing task of 250–400 words from a choice of three, each from a different theme, choosing a text type from among those listed in the examination instructions.	
Paper 2 (1 hour 45 minutes)	
Receptive skills—separate sections for listening and reading (65 marks)	
Listening comprehension (45 minutes) (25 marks)	25
Reading comprehension (1 hour) (40 marks)	25
Comprehension exercises on three audio passages and three written texts, drawn from all five themes.	
Internal Assessment	25
This component is internally assessed by the teacher and externally moderated by the IB at the end of the course.	25
Individual oral assessment - A conversation with the teacher, based on a visual stimulus, followed by discussion based on an additional theme (30 marks).	

Japanese ab initio Standard Level (SL)



Group 2: Language Acquisition

Course Description

Japanese ab initio is a beginner's subject for students who have no previous experience of learning the target language or for those students with very limited previous exposure. The focus of the IB Japanese ab initio course is on the initial acquisition of the language through equal emphasis on reading, writing, listening and speaking,	with special focus on pronunciation. The standard achieved at this level prepares the individual for everyday social interaction using appropriate communicative skills and cross-cultural understanding. In this way, the Japanese ab initio curriculum allows students to achieve a basic degree of competence in the language and to	explore the Japanese world, thus increasing the students' cultural awareness and understanding of the importance of internationalism in today's society. Over a two-year period students will learn to communicate effectively in a number of situations and within the cultures where Japanese is spoken.
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Main Topics Covered

The ab initio course is organised into five prescribed themes: • Identities • Experiences • Human ingenuity • Social organisation • Sharing the planet.	The themes allow students to compare the target language and culture(s) to other languages and culture with which they are familiar. The themes also provide opportunities for students to make connections to other disciplinary areas in the Diploma Programme.	Because a structured learning environment is crucial for the success of beginning language learners, the language ab initio syllabus prescribes four topics for each of the five prescribed themes. Thus, in total there are 20 topics that must be addressed in the language ab initio course.
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Assessment Component Information

Weighting

External Examination

75

Paper 1 (1 hour)

25

Productive skills - writing (30 marks)

Two written tasks of 70–150 words (140-300 characters) each from a choice of three tasks, choosing a text type for each task from among those listed in the examination instructions.

Paper 2 (1 hour 45 minutes)

Receptive skills - separate sections for listening and reading (65 marks)

Listening comprehension (45 minutes) (25 marks)

25

Reading comprehension (1 hour) (40 marks)

25

Comprehension exercises on three audio passages and three written texts, drawn from all five themes.

Internal Assessment

25

This component is internally assessed by the teacher and externally moderated by the IB at the end of the course.

Individual oral assessment

A conversation with the teacher, based on a visual stimulus and at least one additional course theme (30 marks).

Spanish ab initio Standard Level (SL)



Group 2: Language Acquisition		
Course Description		
Spanish ab initio is a beginner's subject for students who have no previous experience of learning the target language or for those students with very limited previous exposure. The focus of the IB Spanish ab initio course is on the initial acquisition of the language through equal emphasis on reading, writing, listening and speaking	with special focus on pronunciation. The standard achieved at this level prepares the individual for everyday social interaction using appropriate communicative skills and cross-cultural understanding. In this way, the Spanish ab initio curriculum allows students to achieve a basic degree of competence in the language and to explore the	Spanish world, thus increasing the students' cultural awareness and understanding of the importance of internationalism in today's society. Over a two-year period students will learn to communicate effectively in a number of situations and within the cultures where Spanish is spoken.
Main Topics Covered		
The ab initio course is organised into five prescribed themes: • Identities • Experiences • Human ingenuity • Social organisation • Sharing the planet.	The themes allow students to compare the target language and culture(s) to other languages and cultures with which they are familiar. The themes also provide opportunities for students to make connections to other disciplinary areas in the Diploma Programme.	Because a structured learning environment is crucial for the success of beginning language learners, the Language ab initio syllabus prescribes four topics for each of the five prescribed themes. Thus, in total there are 20 topics that must be addressed in the Language ab initio course.
Assessment Component Information		Weighting
<i>External Examination</i>		75
Paper 1 (1 hour)		25
Productive skills - writing (30 marks)		
Two written tasks of 70–150 words each from a choice of three tasks, choosing a text type for each task from among those listed in the examination instructions.		
Paper 2 (1 hour 45 minutes)		
Receptive skills - separate sections for listening and reading (65 marks)		
Listening comprehension (45 minutes) (25 marks)		25
Reading comprehension (1 hour) (40 marks)		25
Comprehension exercises on three audio passages and three written texts, drawn from all five themes.		
<i>Internal Assessment</i>		25
This component is internally assessed by the teacher and externally moderated by the IB at the end of the course.		25
Individual oral assessment		
A conversation with the teacher, based on a visual stimulus and at least one additional course theme (30 marks).		

Spanish B Standard Level (SL)



Group 2: Language Acquisition		
Course Description		
The Spanish B Course is to be offered at standard level. It is for students with previous experience of the target language and focuses on the continued acquisition and development of the language through equal emphasis on listening, speaking, reading and writing. Spanish B courses allow students to attain a high degree of competence in the language and to explore the	Spanish-speaking world, thus increasing students' cultural awareness and understanding of the importance of internationalism in today's society. Over a two-year period, students will be able to learn to communicate effectively in a number of situations and within the culture(s) where Spanish is spoken, with the ability to work with and produce a	range of text types. The four primary language skills of listening, speaking, reading and writing are developed in an integrated way, through the use of a wide range of texts or material that serve particular communicative purposes and make students aware of how culture may influence the language.
Main Topics Covered		
The Language B course is organised into five prescribed themes: • Identities • Experiences • Human ingenuity • Social organisation • Sharing the planet.	The themes allow students to compare the target language and culture(s) to other languages and cultures with which they are familiar. The themes also provide opportunities for students to make connections to other disciplinary areas in the Diploma Programme.	In the Language B course, the five themes are prescribed, but the recommended topics and possible questions are to be considered indicative content. The five themes will all be addressed equally. However, teachers will work with the themes and topic areas in a way that best helps them to organise a course plan and build upon students' interests and that best helps students to meet the expectations of the syllabus.
Assessment Component Information		Weighting
External Examination		75
Paper 1 (1 hour 15 minutes) Productive skills - writing (30 marks) One writing task of 250–400 words from a choice of three, each from a different theme, choosing a text type from among those listed in the examination instructions. Paper 2 (1 hour 45 minutes) Receptive skills - separate sections for listening and reading (65 marks) Listening comprehension (45 minutes) (25 marks) Reading comprehension (1 hour) (40 marks) Comprehension exercises on three audio passages and three written texts, drawn from all five themes.		25 25 25
Internal Assessment		25
This component is internally assessed by the teacher and externally moderated by the IB at the end of the course. Individual oral assessment A conversation with the teacher, based on a visual stimulus and at least one additional course theme (30 marks).		25

Business Management Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 3: Individuals and Societies

Course Description

Business Management is a rigorous, challenging and dynamic discipline in the individuals and societies subject group. The role of businesses, as distinct from other organisations and actors in a society, is to produce and sell goods and services that meet human needs and wants by organising resources. Profit-making, risk-taking and operating in a competitive environment characterise most business organisations.

A strong focus is on the study of decision-making within an organisation and the use of information technology in business contexts. Students learn to analyse, discuss and evaluate business activities at local, national and international levels. The course covers a range of organisations from all sectors, as well as the socio-cultural and economic contexts in which those organisations operate.

Business Management also explores how individuals and groups interact within an organisation, how they may be successfully managed and how they can ethically optimise the use of resources in a world with increasing scarcity and concern for sustainability.

Emphasis is placed on strategic decision-making and the operational business functions of human resource management, finance and accounts, marketing and operations management. Links between the topics are central to the course, as this integration promotes a holistic overview of business management. Through the exploration of key concepts underpinning the subject (ethics, sustainability, change and creativity)

The Business Management course allows students to develop their understanding of interdisciplinary concepts from a business management perspective.

The course encourages the appreciation of ethical concerns, as well as issues of corporate social responsibility (CSR), at both a local and global level. Through the study of topics such as human resource management, organisational growth and business strategy, the course aims to develop transferable skills relevant to today's students. These include the ability to: think critically; make ethically sound and well-informed decisions; appreciate the pace, nature and significance of change; think strategically; and undertake long term planning, analysis and evaluation. The course also develops subject-specific skills, such as financial analysis.

Main Topics Covered

Five compulsory units:

- Business organisation and environment
- Human resource management
- Finance and accounts
- Marketing
- Operations Management

Business Management Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	75
Paper 1 - Two sections based on an unseen case-study. The sections include structured questions and extended responses.	35
Paper 2 - Two sections based on unseen stimulus material with a quantitative focus. The sections include structured questions and extended responses.	35
Internal Assessment	30
A research project about a real business issue or problem facing a particular organisation using a conceptual lens.	30

Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Paper 1 - Two sections based on an unseen case study. The sections include structured questions and extended responses.	25
Paper 2 - Two sections based on unseen stimulus material with a quantitative focus. The sections include structured questions and extended responses.	30
Paper 3 - Extended response based on unseen stimulus material about a social enterprise.	25
Internal Assessment	20
A research project about a real business issue or problem facing a particular organisation using a conceptual lens.	20

Global Politics Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 3: Individuals and Societies

Course Description

Global Politics is a course for students who want to understand more about how the world they live in works, what makes it change, or what prevents it from changing. The course draws on a variety of disciplinary traditions in the study of politics and international relations, and more broadly in the social sciences and humanities. Students build their knowledge and understanding by critically engaging with contemporary political issues and challenges that interest them.

The scope of Global Politics extends over a wide range of topics and areas of study, many of which will find links with other subjects in the individuals and societies group. Students develop their understanding of political concepts and their knowledge of specific content by exploring and researching real-world case studies and examples.

Developing an understanding of power is critical for analysing how political systems work and how they change. Global Politics students encounter the complexity and nuances of power from the beginning of the course. They build their understanding of how power works across multiple and interconnected dimensions, affecting the everyday lives of people around the world.

Main Topics Covered

Global Politics core topics:

- Understanding power and global politics

Thematic studies:

- Rights and Justice
- Development and sustainability
- Peace and Conflict

HL extensions: Global Political challenges:

- Extended enquiries focused on global political challenges.
- Students conduct independent research on case studies that connect to the following HL topic areas:
 - Borders
 - Environment
 - Equality
 - Health
 - Identity
 - Poverty
 - Security
 - Technology

Global Politics Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	75
Paper 1 – Source-based paper that draws from the common SL and HL core topics. Candidates answer four compulsory structured questions.	30 45
Paper 2 – Extended response paper based on the common SL and HL thematic studies.	
Internal Assessment	25
A 2000-word written report on Engagement Activity.	25

Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	
External Examination	80
Paper 1 - Source-based paper that draws from the common SL and HL core topic. Candidates answer four compulsory structured questions.	20 30
Paper 2 - Extended response paper based on the common SL and HL thematic studies.	
Paper 3 - Stimulus- based paper related to the HL extension syllabus (global political challenges). Candidates must respond to three questions drawing from their researched case studies.	30
Internal Assessment	20
A 2000-word written report on Engagement Activity plus 400 word recommendation.	20

History Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 3: Individuals and Societies

Course Description

History matters. In our shared history we study tragedy and triumph, and the grey in between. Studying History is an intellectual exercise of understanding perspectives different to our own that originate from different time periods, regions, and ethnicities.

The IB History course is designed to cultivate an understanding of, and sustained interest in, past events, contexts, and perspectives. For both SL and HL, the course aims to develop student's historical skills and knowledge through in-depth study of multiple regions and periods. The curriculum encourages students to engage with a variety of perspectives, fostering a nuanced appreciation of history's complexity as experienced by individuals and groups, or interpreted by historians.

Through crucial engagement with sources, students develop essential analytical skills, aiding their understanding of historical events and their impacts.

Moreover, the course seeks to connect historical knowledge with contemporary societal issues, enhancing students' self-awareness and their understanding of their place in a globally interconnected society. This reflective approach encourages learners to draw informed parallels between the past and present, equipping them with the insights necessary to navigate today's world.

The IB History course challenges students to develop detailed historical knowledge and a deep understanding of historical concepts and contexts. Aimed at fostering crucial thinking, the course emphasises the analysis and interpretation of diverse sources to form balanced arguments and coherent responses. Students will learn to synthesise evidence and evaluate multiple perspectives on historical events, enhancing their ability to produce structured, focused essays. The course also cultivates skills in research, organisation, and referencing, preparing students for both internal assessments and external examinations. Through rigorous engagement with historical inquiry, learners refine their academic skills and broaden their intellectual horizons.

Main Topics Covered

Standard Level: 20th Century World History

- ONE prescribed topic on Rights and Protests OR Move to Global War covering two case studies:
- Civil Rights in the US (1954-1964) & Apartheid South Africa (1948-1964)

OR

- Pre-World War II expansion of Japan, Italy and Germany.
- TWO topics on World History:
- Authoritarian states
- The Cold War: Super power tensions and rivalries.

Higher Level: 20th Century World History

- ONE prescribed topic as per Standard Level
- TWO topics on World History as per Standard Level

Higher Level Continued:

- ONE Regional Study with THREE sections from the History of Europe OR the History of Asia:
- Imperial Russia, revolutions, emergence of Soviet State (1853-1924), Europe and the First World War (1871-1918), Versailles to Berlin-European diplomacy in Europe (1919-1945)

OR

- The People's Republic of China (1949-2005), Cold War conflicts in Asia, Japan (1912-1990)

History Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	75
Paper 1 - Source-based paper that draws from the prescribed topic. Candidates answer four questions.	30
Paper 2 - Extended response paper based on the World History topics.	45
Internal Assessment	25
A historical investigation into an area of interest including an evaluation of sources extended response and reflection.	25

Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Paper 1 - source-based paper that draws from the prescribed topic. Candidates answer four questions.	20
Paper 2 - Extended response paper based on the World History topics.	25
Paper 3 - Extended response paper based on the History of Europe or Asia topics.	35
Internal Assessment	20
A historical investigation into an area of interest including an evaluation of sources extended response and reflection.	20

Philosophy Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 3: Individuals and Societies

Course Description

The Philosophy course provides an opportunity for students to ask and discuss big questions. Highly transferable skills are developed such as the ability to formulate arguments logically, to make reasoned judgements, to communicate complex ideas and to evaluate complex and multifaceted issues. The emphasis of the course is on 'doing philosophy', that is, actively engaging students in philosophical activity, as well as connecting students' philosophical

thinking with contemporary issues and global challenges, such as personal identity, technology and the environment.

Students are challenged to develop their own philosophical voice and to grow into independent thinkers. They develop their skills through the study of philosophical themes -- with a particular focus on what it means to be human, ethics and politics -- and the close reading of a philosophical text.

Some key questions in the course:

- What is the mind?
- Can machines have minds?
- Do we have free-will?
- What do we mean by equality?
- Is democracy the only good form of government?
- Are moral values merely subjective?
- What does the rise of machines mean for humanity?

Main Topics Covered

Core Theme

"Being human" is the compulsory core theme for all students. Students consider the nature of humanity through six key concepts: human nature, identity, mind and body, self and other, freedom and personhood.

Optional Themes

SL students are required to study one optional theme. HL students are required to study two optional themes. While other options could be chosen depending on the cohort, the options chosen in recent years have been:

1. Ethics: how should we live?
What is the origin and nature of moral values?
How should we make moral decisions?
Applied ethics: bioethics; social justice.
2. Political Philosophy: how should we live together?
What kind of political power, if any, is legitimate?
What is justice? How can we achieve justice?
What are human rights? Are human rights universal?

Prescribed Text

SL and HL students are required to study a complete philosophical text: C. Taylor, *The Ethics of Authenticity*, an analysis of why and how we value authenticity. What does it mean to be authentic? Is it just the common mantra of "be true to yourself" or "you do you"? Are there better and worse forms of authenticity?

HL Extension

HL students reflect on the nature, methods, and purpose of philosophical activity, considering how it may help us face key challenges, such as those posed by technology and the environment.

Philosophy Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	75
Paper 1 – Questions on core theme and optional themes	50
Paper 2 – Questions on prescribed texts	25
Internal Assessment	25
Students write a 2000-word philosophical essay on a topic of their own choice, connecting philosophical thinking with a real-world issues.	25

Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Paper 1 – Questions on core theme and optional themes	40
Paper 2 – Questions on prescribed text	20
Paper 3 – Response to unseen text about the nature, methods, and purpose of philosophy	20
Internal Assessment	20
Students write a 2000-word philosophical essay on a topic of their own choice, connecting philosophical thinking with a real-world issue	20

Psychology Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 3: Individuals and Societies

Course Description

Psychology is the rigorous and systematic study of mental processes and behaviour. It is a complex subject which draws on concepts, methods and understandings from a number of different disciplines. There is no single approach that would describe or explain mental processes and behaviour on its own as human beings are complex animals, with highly developed frontal lobes, cognitive abilities, involved social structures and cultures.

At the core of the course is an introduction to three different approaches to understanding behaviour:

- biological approach to understanding behaviour.
- cognitive approach to understanding behaviour.
- sociocultural approach to understanding behaviour.

The knowledge, concepts, theories and research that have developed the understanding in these fields will be studied and critically evaluated to answer some of the questions being asked by psychologists today. Furthermore, the interaction of these approaches to studying psychology will form the basis of a holistic and integrated approach to understanding mental processes and behaviour as a complex, dynamic phenomenon, allowing students to appreciate the diversity as well as the commonality between their own behaviour and that of others.

Psychologists employ a range of research methods, both qualitative and quantitative, in order to test their observations and hypotheses. As a part of the core syllabus, Diploma Programme Psychology promotes an understanding of the various approaches to research and how they have been used in order to critically reflect on the evidence as well as assist in the design, implementation, analysis and evaluation of the students' own investigations.

Psychology studies human beings and as such it is paramount that the ethical implications in any line of investigation, and at all points in the course, are fully explored and understood to ensure that ethical guidelines are followed at all times.

Main Topics Covered

- Concepts: Bias, Causality, Change, Measurement, Perspective and Responsibility
- Contexts: Health and Well-being, Human Development, Human Relationships and Learning and Cognition
- Content: Biological approach, Cognitive approach, Sociocultural approach and Research methodology
- 4 class practicals: Interview, Survey, Experiment, Observation

HL extensions

- The role of culture, motivation and technology in shaping human behaviour
- Data analysis and interpretation

Psychology Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	70
Paper 1 - Three sections, integrating the concepts, content and contexts. Section A is short answer questions from 2 of the 3 content areas. Section B is questions relating content to the context areas. Section 3 is an extended response based on the concepts.	35
Paper 2 - Applying concepts and content to research contexts. Section A: four compulsory questions that focus on the class practicals. Section B: evaluation of an unseen research study with regard to two or more concepts.	35
Internal Assessment	30
Design a research proposal to investigate a population of interest using one of the four research methods used in the class practicals.	30
Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	
External Examination	80
Paper 1 - Three sections, integrating the concepts, content and contexts. Section A is short answer questions from 2 of the 3 content areas. Section B is questions relating content to the context areas. Section 3 is an extended response based on the concepts.	25
Paper 2 - Applying concepts and content to research contexts. Section A: four compulsory questions that focus on the class practicals. Section B: evaluation of an unseen research study with regard to two or more concepts.	25
Paper 3 - Data analysis and interpretation of research data. Four source-based questions with quantitative and qualitative findings will be provided. The focus of the questions will be from one of the HL extensions.	30
Internal Assessment	20
Design a research proposal to investigate a population of interest using one of the four research methods used in the class practicals.	20

Environmental Systems and Societies Standard Level (SL & HL)



Group 3 and or 4: Transdisciplinary

Course Description

This course offers an exploration of the intricate relationship between the natural environment and human societies. Throughout this subject, students will delve into a wide array of topics ranging from ecology and biodiversity to agriculture, climate change and sustainable development. As an interdisciplinary subject ESS goes beyond traditional biological science and geography courses by integrating social economic, and environmental perspectives, with rigorous inquiry, practical experiments and fieldwork activities, providing a holistic understanding of the complex challenges facing our planet today.

Students studying ESS will develop the tools necessary to become empowered global citizens, ready to confront pressing environmental challenges head-on. ESS students must demonstrate critical thinking open mindedness and problem solving. Through this course, they will delve into a myriad of environmental issues confronting humanity while also exploring the innovative solutions emerging worldwide. Our planet, our home, sustains us all, yet our consumption exceeds its limits. This unsustainable reality underscores the urgency of our discussions on resource utilisation, spanning from individual choices to global initiatives.

Within the realm of ESS, students are not merely passive learners, they are catalysts for change, driven by critical thinking, ethical responsibility, and a profound sense of interconnectedness with the world around them. Note: Interdisciplinary courses can be used as both a group 3 and a group 4 course to enable students to select an additional subject in 1, 2, 3, 4 or 6 groups.

Main Topics Covered

The SL course encompasses 150 teaching hours, compared to 240 hours for the HL course. This difference is reflected in the additional content studied by HL students. Some of the HL content is conceptually more demanding and explored in greater depth. The distinction between SL and HL is therefore one of both breadth and depth.

All students will cover the following topics:

- Perspectives, systems, and sustainability.
- Ecology
- Biodiversity and conservation
- Access to water, aquatic food production overfishing and water pollution
- Soil, agriculture and food production
- The atmosphere, climate change, and the ozone hole
- Nature resources Energy sources, solid waste
- Human populations urban systems and planning and urban air pollution

HL students will additionally study the following:

- Environmental law
- Environmental economics
- Environmental ethics

Environmental Systems and Societies

Standard Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	75
Paper 1 (35 marks) - Students will be provided with a range of data in a variety of forms relating to a specific, previously unseen case study. Questions will be based on the analysis and evaluation of the data in the case study. All questions are compulsory. The question in Paper 1 test assessment objectives 1, 2 and 3.	25
Paper 2 (60 marks) consists of two sections A and B. Section A (40 marks) is made up of short-answer and data-based questions.	50
Section B (20 marks) requires students to answer one structured essay question from a choice of two. Each question is worth 20 marks. The questions in Paper 2 test assessment objectives 1, 2 and 3.	
Internal Assessment	25
Individual independent scientific investigation a personalised investigation of up to 3000 words in a field of inquiry related to ESS.	25

Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Paper 1 (70 marks) - Students will be provided with a range of data in a variety of forms relating to a specific, previously unseen case study. Questions will be based on the analysis and evaluation of the data in the case study. All questions are compulsory. The questions in Paper 1 test assessment objectives 1, 2 and 3.	30
Paper 2 (80 marks) – Section A (40 marks) is made up of short-answer and data-based questions.	50
Section B (40 marks) requires students to answer two structured essay questions from a choice of three. Each question is worth 20 marks. The questions in Paper 2 test assessment objectives 1, 2, 3.	
Internal Assessment	20
Individual independent scientific investigation a personalised investigation of up to 3000 words in a field of inquiry related to ESS.	20

Biology Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 4: Experimental Sciences

Course Description

The scale of life in biology ranges from the molecules and cells of organisms to ecosystems and the biosphere. This way of considering complex systems as simpler components—an approach known as reductionism—makes systems more manageable to study. It is the foundation of controlled experiments and has thus enabled major discoveries, but it provides an incomplete view of life. At each level of biological organisation, different properties exist. Living systems are based on interactions, interdependence and integration of components between all levels of biological organisation. A student of Biology should gain not only a conceptual understanding of the subject, but also an awareness of how biologists construct knowledge claims and the limitations of these methods.

Students at SL and HL share the following.

- An understanding of science through a stimulating experimental programme
- The nature of science as an overarching theme
- The study of a concept-based syllabus
- One piece of internally assessed work, the scientific investigation
- The collaborative sciences project.

The SL course provides students with a fundamental understanding of Biology and experience of the associated skills. The HL course requires students to increase their knowledge.

Integral to the student experience of a biology course is the learning that takes place through scientific inquiry within the classroom, laboratory or in the field. Experimentation through a variety of forms can be used to introduce a topic, address a phenomenon or allow students to consider and examine authentic questions and curiosities.

Subject entry requirements

Year 10 results:

SL & HL: MYP Grade 6, including 6 or higher in Criterion B & C for Year 10 Science. Students need a Grade 5 in Mathematics Core and Pathway

Main Topics Covered

The SL course has a recommended 150 teaching hours, compared to 240 hours for the HL course. This difference is reflected in the additional content studied by HL students. Some of the HL content is conceptually more demanding and explored in greater depth. The distinction between SL and HL is therefore one of both breadth and depth. The increased breadth and depth at HL result in increased networked knowledge, requiring the student to make more connections between diverse areas of the syllabus.

The biology syllabus comprises four themes, each made up of two concepts. Each theme is a lens through which the syllabus content can be viewed.

- Theme A: Unity and diversity
- Theme B: Form and function
- Theme C: Interaction and interdependence
- Theme D: Continuity and change

The arrangement of syllabus content follows four levels of biological organisation, which also serve as conceptual lenses.

- Level 1: Molecules
- Level 2: Cells
- Level 3: Organisms
- Level 4: Ecosystems

All HL students cover the SL Core Experimental Programme of 40 hours AND an additional 20 hours.

- Practical work
- Collaborative sciences project
- Scientific investigation

Biology Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Paper 1 - is presented as two separate booklets:	36
Paper 1A (30 marks) 30 multiple choice questions on standard level material only. No marks are deducted for incorrect answers.	
Paper 1B (25 marks) four data-based questions related to experimental work and the syllabus. The questions on paper 1 test assessment objectives 1, 2 and 3.	44
Paper 2 - Section A (34 marks) Data based question. Short answer questions on standard level material.	
Section B (16 marks) Extended response questions on standard level material. One of two extended response questions to be attempted by candidates. The questions on Paper 2 test assessment objectives 1, 2 and 3.	
Internal Assessment	20
Exploration - a personalised investigation of a maximum of 3,000 words into a field of inquiry related to Biology.	20
Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	
External Examination	80
Paper 1 - Paper 1A (40 marks) 40 multiple choice questions on standard level and additional higher-level material. No marks are deducted for incorrect answers. Paper 1B (35 marks) four data-based questions related to experimental work and the syllabus. The questions on Paper 1 test assessment objectives 1, 2, 3.	36
Paper 2 - Section A (48 marks) data-based question. Short-answer questions on standard level and additional higher-level material. Section B (32 marks) Extended-response questions on standard level and additional higher-level material. Two of three extended response questions to be attempted by candidates. The questions on paper 2 test assessment objectives 1, 2, 3.	44
Internal Assessment	20
Exploration - a personalised investigation of a maximum of 3,000 words into a field of inquiry related to Biology.	20

Chemistry Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 4: Experimental Sciences

Course Description

The structure of this chemistry syllabus is intended to promote concept-based teaching and learning. Chemistry is primarily concerned with identifying patterns that allow us to explain matter at the microscopic level. This then allows us to predict and control matter's behaviour at a macroscopic level. The subject therefore emphasizes the development of representative models and explanatory theories, both of which rely heavily on creative but rational thinking. Given the pattern-seeking nature of chemistry, the development of generalized rules and principles also plays an important part in knowledge production, as do the concrete statements provided by mathematical laws.

The SL course provides students with a fundamental understanding of chemistry and experience of the associated skills. The HL course requires students to increase their knowledge and understanding of the subject, including additional mathematical skills, and so provides a solid foundation for further study at university level.

Students at SL and HL share the following.

- An understanding of science through a stimulating experimental programme
- The nature of science as an overarching theme
- The study of a concept-based syllabus

- One piece of internally assessed work, the scientific investigation
- The collaborative sciences project.

The study of chemistry at HL demands a much higher level of problem-solving skills and the ability to understand and manipulate some abstract concepts. Students who have achieved at "A grade" level in Year 10 Science tend to be particularly suited to HL Chemistry.

Subject entry requirements

Year 10 results:

HL: MYP Grade 7, including 7 or higher in Criterion B & C for Year 10 Science. Students must be studying AA Mathematics.

SL: MYP Grade 6 including 6 or higher in Criterion B & C for Year 10 Science. Students must be studying AA Mathematics.

Main Topics Covered

The SL course has a recommended 150 teaching hours, compared to 240 hours for the HL course. This difference is reflected in the additional content studied by HL students. Some of the HL content is conceptually more demanding and explored in greater depth. The distinction between SL and HL is therefore one of both breadth and depth. The increased breadth and depth at HL result in increased networked knowledge, requiring the student to make more connections between diverse areas of the syllabus.

- Structure 1. Models of the particulate nature of matter
- Structure 2. Models of bonding and structure
- Structure 3. Classification of matter
- Reactivity 1. What drives chemical reactions?
- Reactivity 2. How much, how fast and how far?
- Reactivity 3. What are the mechanisms of chemical change?

All HL students cover the SL Core Experimental Programme of 40 hours AND an additional 20 hours.

- Practical work
- Collaborative sciences project
- Scientific investigation

Chemistry Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Paper 1 is presented as two separate booklets.	36
Paper 1A (30 marks) 30 multiple choice questions on standard level material only. No marks are deducted for incorrect answers.	44
Paper 1B - Data-based questions. Questions on experimental work (25 marks)	
Paper 2 (50 marks)	
Short-answer and extended-response questions on standard level material only. The questions on Paper test assessment objectives 1, 2 and 3.	
Internal Assessment	20
Exploration – a personalised investigation of a maximum of 3,000 words into a field of inquiry related to Chemistry.	20

Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Paper 1 (75 marks) is presented as two separate booklets.	36
Paper 1A (40 marks) 40 multiple choice questions on standard level and additional higher-level material. No marks are deducted for incorrect answers.	44
Paper 1B (35 marks) - Data-based questions. Questions on experimental work. The questions on Paper 1 test assessment objectives 1, 2 and 3.	
Paper 2 (90 marks) short-answer and extended response questions on standard level and additional higher-level material. The questions on paper 2 test assessment objectives 1, 2 and 3.	
Internal Assessment	20
Exploration – a personalised investigation of a maximum of 3,000 words into a field of inquiry related to Chemistry.	20

Computer Science Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 4: Experimental Sciences

Course Description

While young Australians are known to be prodigious consumers of digital content, there is irrefutable evidence to show their levels of computing proficiency are drastically declining. In addition, there is a massive shortage of digital skills in Australia and projections this shortage will become more acute in the coming decade have been very widely publicised. Given this current set of circumstances and the trajectory of the Australian economy, NOW is the perfect time for young people to incorporate the study of computing into their course.

The new IB Computer Science course offers a comprehensive and rigorous curriculum designed to equip students with essential skills for the digital age. This course is structured around two primary themes, each focusing on critical aspects of computer science.

Theme covers the concepts of Computer Science. This theme delves into the practical applications of programming, encompassing computer fundamentals, networks, databases, and machine learning. Mastery of these areas will provide you with a robust foundation in modern technology, enabling you to address and solve real-world problems effectively. For instance, you will learn the fundamentals of network management, create and manipulate databases, and develop machine learning models to predict trends and patterns.

Theme B covers computational thinking and problem solving. This theme emphasizes the development of problem solving, programming skills, object-oriented programming, and abstract data types. These concepts are integral to the discipline of computer science, fostering logical and systematic

thinking. Such skills are not only vital for computer science but are also transferable to various other fields, enhancing your overall academic and professional capabilities.

Each academic year, a new case study will be introduced to bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical application. This approach ensures that students gain a deep understanding of how to apply theoretical concepts to real-life scenarios, thereby enriching their learning experience and preparing students for future challenges.

The course is engaging, accessible, inspiring and rigorous. While Computer Science is not just about programming, past experience with programming is desirable to take it at HL. Students should be able to study Computer Science at SL with little previous knowledge of programming.

Main Topics Covered

Theme A: Concepts of computer science

- Computer fundamentals
- Networks
- Databases
- Machine learning

Theme B: Computational thinking and problem-solving

- Computational thinking
- Programming
- Object-oriented programming
- Abstract data types - HL only

Plus:

Case study

Internal assessment

- The computational solution

Computer Science Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	70
Paper 1 - focuses on theme A and the case study. It consists of two compulsory sections. Section A comprises several compulsory short answer questions. Section B comprises a series of extended responses related to the case study	35
Paper 2 - focuses on theme B. It consists of a mix of short answer and construction questions related to programming and the Object-Oriented Paradigm.	35
Internal Assessment	30
Assessed on application of skills through the completion of a project	30

Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Paper 1 - focuses on theme A and the case study. It consists of two compulsory sections. Section A comprises several compulsory short answer questions. Section B comprises a series of extended responses related to the case study	40
Paper 2 - focuses on theme B. It consists of a mix of short answer and construction questions related to programming and the Object-Oriented Paradigm.	40
Internal Assessment	20
Assessed on application of skills through the completion of a project.	20

Design Technology

Higher Level (HL)



Group 4: Experimental Sciences

Course Description

Design Technology aims to develop internationally minded people whose enhanced understanding of design and the technological world can facilitate our shared guardianship of the planet and create a better world.

The course requires the use of the design cycle as a tool, which provides the methodology used to structure the inquiry and analysis of problems, the development of feasible solutions, and the testing and evaluation of the solution

While the design methodology may take on a wide variety of forms, it is the emphasis on design theory and its application to designing and producing products that characterises this subject.

Project Budgeting

While the TAS Department aims to supply what resources it can, students innovate and create very different products in this course, because of this, there is an expectation that students will source and purchase some of the specific materials needed to create their products.

Subject specific laptop

There is a cost of \$200 per year for a subject specific laptop. This device will be able to handle complex modelling and photo realistic rendering.

Subject entry requirements

Studying Design and Technology in years 9 and 10 is a prerequisite. Students will need an MYP Grade 6 or higher for course entry. A good working knowledge of Solidworks is needed.

Main Topics Covered

Design in theory

People

- A1.1 Ergonomics

Process

- A2.1 User-centred research methods
- A2.2 Prototyping techniques

Product

- A3.1 Material classification and properties
- A3.2 Introduction to structural systems
- A3.3 Introduction to mechanical systems (HL only)
- A3.4 Introduction to electronic systems (HL only)

Production

- A4.1 Manufacturing techniques

Design in practice

People

- B1.1 User-centred design

Process

- B2.1 The design process
- B2.2 Modelling and prototyping

Product

- B3.1 Material selection
- B3.2 Structural systems application and selection
- B3.3 Mechanical systems application and selection
- B3.4 Electronic systems application and selection

Production

- B4.1 Production systems

Design in context

People

- C1.1 Responsibility of the designer
- C1.2 Inclusive design
- C1.3 Beyond usability

Process

- C2.1 Design for suitability
- C2.2 Design for a circular economy

Product

- C3.1 Product analysis and evaluation
- C3.2 Life-cycle analysis

Production

- C4.1 Design for manufacture strategies

Design Technology Higher Level (HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information	Weighting
<i>External Examination</i>	70
Paper 1 focuses on syllabus content drawn from design in theory, design in practice and design in context.	25
Paper 2 focuses on syllabus content and is based on the analysis of a product. The examination paper comprises of several short-answer and extended-response questions assessing outcomes in design in theory, design in practice and design in context.	45
<i>Internal Assessment - Major Design Project</i>	30
The design project is an open-ended task in which a student must identify, analyse, evaluate and redesign an existing product to meet the needs of an intended user(s). As part of the project, students need to develop a physical fidelity model for testing and evaluation purposes. To complete the design project, students must employ the design thinking process, an iterative, non-linear problem-solving approach that places a strong emphasis on empathy, collaboration and iterative prototyping to address user problems. This method encourages students to revisit and repeat stages as needed, fostering flexibility and responsiveness to new insights or changes in project requirements. The iterative nature of the process enables continual refinement and improvement of the intended solution. Subject-specific vocabulary is crucial to provide clarity and accuracy to the students' written material and its use is rewarded across all the assessment criteria.	30

Physics Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 4: Experimental Sciences

Course Description

Physics encompasses everything that we do as human beings. The very meaning of the word is “the study of nature”. Indeed, when the discipline was first defined, it was about observing the Milky Way, the entire known universe at the time, while wondering about the existence of the atom. As with the universe, physics knowledge is constantly expanding. It is above all a creative discipline. Physics requires solid knowledge of basic principles and a willingness to put them to the test in new ways. It requires curiosity and an appetite to explore what might be.

The HL course requires students to increase their knowledge and understanding of the subject,

including additional mathematical skills, and so provides a solid foundation for further study at university level.

Students at SL and HL share the following.

- An understanding of science through a stimulating experimental programme
- The nature of science as an overarching theme
- The study of a concept-based syllabus
- One piece of internally assessed work, the scientific investigation
- The collaborative sciences project

Subject entry requirements

Year 10 results:

HL MYP Grade 7, including 7 or higher in Criterion B & C for Year 10 Science. Students must be studying AA Mathematics.

SL: MYP Grade 6 including 6 or higher in Criterion B & C for Year 10 Science. Students must be studying AA Mathematics.

Main Topics Covered

- The SL course has a recommended 150 teaching hours, compared to 240 hours for the HL course. This difference is reflected in the additional content studied by HL students. Some of the HL content is conceptually more demanding and explored in greater depth. The distinction between SL and HL is therefore one of both breadth and depth. The increased breadth and depth at HL result in increased networked knowledge, requiring the student to make more connections between diverse areas of the syllabus.

There are five organising themes in the physics syllabus.

- Space, time and motion
- The particulate nature of matter
- Wave behaviour
- Fields
- Nuclear and quantum Physics

The themes have been chosen to represent the main areas of physics relevant for this level of study and do not suggest a teaching order.

Each of these themes is subdivided into topics.

All HL students cover the SL Core Experimental Programme of 40 hours AND an additional 20 hours.

- Practical work
- Collaborative sciences project
- Scientific investigation

Physics Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Paper 1 – is presented as two separate booklets.	36
Paper 1A (25 marks) 25 multiple-choice questions on standard level material only. No marks are deducted for incorrect answers.	44
Paper 1B (20 marks) Data-based questions. The questions on paper 1 test assessment objectives 1, 2 and 3 - 45 marks	
Paper 2 – Short answer and extended response questions on standard level material only. The questions on Paper 2 test assessment objectives 1, 2 and 3.	
Internal Assessment	20
Exploration – a personalised investigation of a maximum of 3,000 words into a field of inquiry related to Physics.	20

Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Paper 1 - is presented as two separate booklets.	36
Paper 1A (40 marks) 40 multiple choice questions on standard level and additional higher-level material. No marks are deducted for incorrect answers.	44
Paper 1B (20 marks) Data-based questions. The questions on Paper 1 test assessment objectives 1, 2, and 3.	
Paper 2 - (90 marks) Short-answer and extended response questions on standard level and additional higher-level material. The questions on Paper 2 test assessment objectives 1, 2 and 3.	
Internal Assessment	20
Exploration – a personalised investigation of a maximum of 3,000 words into a field of inquiry related to Physics.	20

Sports, Exercise and Health Science Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 4: Experimental Sciences		
Course Description		
The IB Diploma course in Sports, Exercise and Health Science involves the study of the science that underpins physical performance and provides the opportunity to apply these principles. The course incorporates the disciplines of anatomy and physiology, biomechanics, psychology and nutrition, which are studied in the context of sport, exercise and health	Students cover a range of core and option topics and carry out practical (experimental) investigations in both laboratory and field settings. This will provide an opportunity to acquire the knowledge, skills and understanding necessary to apply scientific principals and critically analyse human performance.	SEHS students at standard level (SL) and higher level (HL) undertake a common core syllabus, a common internal assessment (IA) and have some overlapping elements in the options studied. Students at HL are required to study some topics in greater depth, in the additional higher level (AHL) material and in the common options. The distinction between SL and HL is one of breadth and depth.
Main Topics Covered		
Syllabus content: A. Exercise physiology and nutrition of the human body • Communication • Hydration and nutrition • Response	Syllabus content: B. Biomechanics • Generating movement in the body • Forces, motion and movement • Injury	Syllabus content: C. Sports psychology and motor learning • Individual differences • Motor learning • Motivation • Stress and coping • Psychological skills

Sports, Exercise and Health Science Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	76
Paper 1: Paper 1A Multiple-choice questions.	36
Paper 1 Paper 1B: Data-based questions and questions on experimental work.	
Paper 2 Short answer and extended response questions.	40
Internal Assessment	20
Scientific investigation – The scientific investigation is an open-ended task in which the student gathers and analyses data in order to answer their own formulated research question. The outcome of the scientific investigation will be assessed through the form of a written report. The maximum overall word count for the report is 3,200 words.	

Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	Weighting
External Examination	76
Paper 1: Paper 1A Multiple-choice questions.	36
Paper 1 Paper 1B: Data-based questions and questions on experimental work.	
Paper 2 Short answer and extended response questions.	40
Internal Assessment	20
Scientific investigation – The scientific investigation is an open-ended task in which the student gathers and analyses data in order to answer their own formulated research question. The outcome of the scientific investigation will be assessed through the form of a written report. The maximum overall word count for the report is 3,200 words.	20

Mathematics: Analysis and Approaches Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 5: Mathematics

Course Description

This course caters for students with an aptitude, interest and strong background in Mathematics, and who are capable in a range of analytical and technical skills. The majority of these students will be expecting to include mathematics as a major component of their university studies, either as a subject in its own right or within courses such as Physics, Engineering and Technology. Others may take this subject because they have a strong interest in mathematics and enjoy meeting its challenges and engaging with its problems.

This course recognises the need for analytical expertise in a world where innovation is increasingly dependent

on a deep understanding of mathematics. This course includes topics that are both traditionally part of a pre-university mathematics course (for example, functions, trigonometry, calculus) as well as topics that are amenable to investigation, conjecture, and proof, for instance the study of sequences and series at both SL and HL, and proof by induction at HL. The course allows the use of technology, as fluency in relevant mathematical software and hand-held technology is important regardless of choice of course. However, Mathematics: analysis and approaches have a strong emphasis on the ability to construct, communicate and justify correct mathematical arguments.

Students who choose Mathematics: analysis and approaches at SL or HL should be comfortable in the manipulation of algebraic expressions and enjoy the recognition of patterns and understand the mathematical generalisation of these patterns. Students who wish to take Mathematics: analysis and approaches at higher level will have strong algebraic skills and the ability to understand simple proof. They will be students who enjoy spending time with problems and get pleasure and satisfaction from solving challenging problems.

Subject entry requirements

Achieve a Level 3 or above in the Minimum Standards test for Numeracy.

Year 10 Core and Pathway results HL
an average of 7 or higher in all MYP Criterion.

Year 10 Core and Pathway results SL:
a minimum average of 6 or higher in all MYP Criterion.

Main Topics Covered

Number and algebra
Functions
Geometry and trigonometry
Statistics and probability
Calculus
Investigative problem solving and modelling

Teaching Hours *Standard Level*

19
21
25
27
28
30

Teaching Hours *Higher Level*

39
32
51
33
55
30

Total Hours

150

240

Mathematics: Analysis and Approaches Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Paper 1 - this paper consists of Section A, short-response questions, and section B, extended-response knowledge of all topics is required for this paper (1 hour 30 minutes).	40
Paper 2 - this paper consists of section A, short-response questions, and section B, extended-response questions. Knowledge of all topics is required for this paper (1 hour 30 minutes).	40
Internal Assessment	20
Mathematical exploration A short report based on a topic chosen by the student focused on the mathematics of that particular area. The emphasis is on mathematical communication including formulae, diagrams, graphs and tables.	20

Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Paper 1 – this paper consists of section A, short-response questions, and section B, extended-response questions. Knowledge of all topics is required for this paper (2 hours).	30
Paper 2 – this paper consists of section A, short-response questions, and section B, extended-response questions. Knowledge of all topics is required for this paper (2 hours).	30
Paper 3 – this paper consists of two compulsory extended-response problem-solving questions. Where possible, the first part of each question will be on syllabus content leading to the problem – solving context. Therefore, knowledge of all syllabus topics is required for this paper (1 hour).	20
Internal Assessment	20
Mathematical exploration A short report based on a topic chosen by the student focused on the mathematics of that particular area. The emphasis is on mathematical communication including formulae, diagrams, graphs and tables.	20

Mathematics: Applications and Interpretation Standard (SL)



Group 5: Mathematics

Course Description

This course recognises the increasing role that mathematics and technology play in a diverse range of fields in a data-rich world. As such, it emphasises the meaning of mathematics in context by focusing on topics that are often used as applications or in mathematical modelling. To give this understanding a firm base, this course also includes topics that are traditionally part of a pre-university Mathematics course such as calculus and statistics.

The course makes extensive use of technology to allow students to explore and construct mathematical models. Mathematics: Applications and Interpretation will develop mathematical thinking often in the context of a practical problem and using technology to justify conjectures.

Students who choose Mathematics: Applications and Interpretation at SL or HL should enjoy seeing mathematics

used in real-world context and to solve real-world problems. Students who wish to take Mathematics: Applications and Interpretation at higher level will have good algebraic skills and experience of solving real-world problems. They will be students who get pleasure and satisfaction when exploring challenging problems and who are comfortable to undertake this exploration using technology.

Subject entry requirements

Achieve a Level 3 or above in the Minimum Standards test for Numeracy.

Year 10 Core and Pathway results SL:

An average of 5 or higher in all MYP Criterion.

Year 10 and results SL: an average of 6 or higher in all MYP Criterion.

Main Topics Covered

Teaching Hours Standard Level

Teaching Hours Higher Level

Number and algebra
Functions
Geometry and trigonometry
Statistics and probability
Calculus
Investigative problem solving and modelling

19

29

31

42

18

46

36

52

19

41

30

30

Total Hours

150

240

Mathematics: Applications and Interpretation Standard Level (SL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Paper 1 - this paper consists of compulsory short-response questions. Questions on this paper will vary in terms on length and level of difficulty. Knowledge of all topics is required for this paper (1 hour 30 minutes).	40
Paper 2 - this paper consists of compulsory extended-response questions. Questions on this paper will vary in terms of length and level of difficulty. Knowledge of all topics is required for this paper (1 hour 30 minutes).	40
Internal Assessment	20
Mathematical exploration	20
A short report based on a topic chosen by the student focused on the mathematics of that particular area. The emphasis is on mathematical communication including formulae, diagrams, graphs and tables.	

Film Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 6: The Arts

Course Description

The DP film course aims to develop students as proficient interpreters and makers of film texts. Through the study and analysis of film texts, and practical exercises in film production, students develop critical abilities and appreciation of artistic, cultural, historical and global perspectives in film. They examine concepts, theories, practices and ideas from multiple perspectives, challenging their own views to understand and value those of others. Students are challenged to acquire and develop critical thinking, reflective analysis and the imaginative synthesis through practical engagement in the art, craft and study of film.

Students experiment with film and multimedia technology, acquiring the skills and creative competencies required to successfully communicate through the language of the medium. They develop an artistic voice and learn how to express personal perspectives through film. The course emphasizes the importance of working collaboratively, international and intercultural dynamics, and an appreciation of the development of film across time and culture.

The film syllabus allows for greater breadth and depth in teaching and learning at HL through an additional assessment task, requiring HL students to reflect on the core syllabus areas to formulate their own intentions for a completed film. They work collaboratively as a core production team in order to effectively communicate on screen.

Main Topics Covered

Reading film

Students examine film as an art form, studying a broad range of film texts from a variety of cultural contexts and analysing how film elements combine to create meaning.

Contextualizing film

Students explore the evolution of film across time and culture. They examine various areas of film focus in order to recognize the similarities and differences that exist between films from contrasting cultural contexts.

Exploring film production roles

Students explore various film production roles through engagement with all phases of the filmmaking process. They acquire, develop and apply skills through filmmaking exercises, experiments and completed films.

HL only: Collaboratively producing film

Students focus on the collaborative aspects of filmmaking and experience working in core production teams to fulfil shared artistic intentions. They work in chosen film production

Film Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information	Weighting	
External Assessment (Standard Level/Higher Level)	60	40
	SL	HL
Textual Analysis Textual analysis (max 1,750 words) of a prescribed film text based on a chosen extract (max 5 mins), and list of sources.	30	20
Comparative Study Recorded multimedia comparative study (max 10 mins), and list of sources	30	20
Internal Assessment (Standard Level/Higher Level)	40	60
This component consists of a Film portfolio which is internally assessed by the teacher and externally moderated by the IB at the end of the course.	SL	HL
Film portfolio Portfolio pages (max 9 pages: 3 pages per production role) and list of sources. A film reel (max 9 mins: 3 mins per production role, including 1 completed film).	40	25
Collaborative film project (HL only) Completed film (max 7 mins). Project report (max 2,000 words) and list of sources.		35

Music Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 6: The Arts

Course Description

The study of Music encourages inquiry into creative practices and performance processes. Music study develops listening, creative and analytical skills, as well as encouraging cultural understanding and international mindedness. In this way, music is a catalyst for expanding critical thinking a crucial life skill.

When we understand others and ourselves through music, we are empowered to make positive and effective change in the world.

In this course, students and teachers engage in a journey of imagination and discovery through partnership and collaboration. Students develop and affirm their unique musical identities while expanding and refining their musicianship.

Throughout the course, students are encouraged to explore music in varied and sometimes unfamiliar contexts. Additionally, by experimenting with music, students gain hands-on experience while honing musical skills.

Through realising and presenting samples of their musical work with others, students also learn to communicate critical and artistic intentions and purpose. As students develop as young musicians, the course challenges them to engage practically with music as researchers, performers and creators, and to be driven by their unique passions and interests while also broadening their musical and artistic perspectives.

Main Topics Covered

Students will be given the opportunity to develop as a musician in the role of performer, creator and researcher in personal, local, and global musical contexts, studying the function of music in four areas of inquiry:

1. Music for sociocultural and political expression
2. Music for listening and performance.
3. Music for dramatic impact, movement and entertainment
4. Music technology in the electronic and digital age.

These areas of inquiry given students the scope to investigate a diverse range of musical material, by:

1. Exploring Music in Context
2. Experimenting with Music and
3. Presenting Music

HL students also explore Music as: The Contemporary Music Maker

Course Entry Requirements

The course at both standard level (SL) & higher level (HL) assumes previous experience in Stage 5 Elective Music, or equivalent pre-existing musical knowledge, abilities, and experience in:

- music theory and music literacy skills
(*AMEB Grade 3 Musicianship or equivalent*)
- solo performance skills on their chosen instrument or voice
(*AMEB Grade 6 or equivalent*)

Students in the Music course agree to commit to, for the duration of the course:

- undertake regular private tuition on their chosen instrument or voice.
- perform on their instrument or voice as a soloist on a regular basis.
- attend Music excursions (at an additional cost; outlined at the start of the year)
- Note: Previously, it was mandatory for all Music Elective students to be in Senior Choir for the full duration of Elective Music study. From 2026, students new to Elective Music must be in Senior Choir for the first semester only; after this point it is optional to continue Senior Choir.
- Students are highly encouraged to be involved in the SACS Cocurricular Music Programme.

Additional Considerations

The school provides an accompanist (piano) to rehearse and perform as required for student performances presented as course work. There may be instances where a student elects to perform with additional musicians outside of what the school provides; these optional costs are not covered by the school and should be factored in by the student and their parents.

Music Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information	Weighting	
External Assessment (Standard Level/Higher Level)	70	50
	SL	HL
Exploring music in context Students select samples of their work for a portfolio submission (maximum 2,400 words). Students submit: - Written work demonstrating engagement with, and understanding of, diverse musical material. - Practical exercises. - Creating: one creating exercise (score maximum 32 bars and/or audio 1 minute as appropriate to style) - Performing: one performed adaptation of music from a local or global context for the student's own instrument (maximum 2 minutes) Supporting audio material (not assessed).	30	20
Presenting music Students submit a collection of works demonstrating engagement with diverse musical material from four areas of inquiry. The submission contains: - Presenting as a researcher. - Programme notes (maximum 600 words) - Presenting as a creator. - Composition and/or improvisation (maximum 6 minutes) - Presenting as a performer.	40	30
Internal Assessment (Standard Level/Higher Level)	30	50
	SL	HL
Experimenting with music Students submit an experimentation report with evidence of their musical processes in creating and performing in two areas of inquiry in a local and/or global context. The report provides a rationale and commentary for each process. Students submit: - A written experimentation report that supports the experimentation (maximum 1,500 words). - Practical musical evidence of the experimentation process. - Three related excerpts of creating (total maximum 5 minutes) - Three related excerpts of performing (total maximum 5 minutes)	30	20
The contemporary music-maker (HL only) Students submit a continuous multimedia presentation documenting their real-life project. Students submit multimedia presentation (maximum 15 minutes), evidencing: - The project proposal - The process and evaluation - The realised project, or curated selections of it	N/A	30

Theatre Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 6: The Arts

Course Description

Theatre is a dynamic, collaborative, live artform. It is a practical subject that encourages discovery through experimenting, taking risks, presenting and performing ideas to others. It results in the development of both theatre and life skills; the building of confidence and creativity through working collaboratively.

Theatre is a multifaceted course. It gives students the opportunity to make theatre as creators, designers, directors and performers working individually and collaboratively as part of an ensemble. Theatre offers the opportunity to engage actively in the creative process, transforming ideas into action as inquisitive and productive artists.

Students learn to apply research and theory to inform and to contextualize their work. Students appreciate that through the processes of researching, creating, preparing, presenting and critically reflecting on theatre—as participants and audience members—they gain a richer understanding of themselves, their community and the world.

Main Topics Covered

The Theatre syllabus at HL and SL consists of equal, interrelated areas: Staging Play Texts - This area of the syllabus addresses the transformation of play texts into action. Students examine the ways in which ideas are articulated in texts by playwrights and the ways in which performance and production elements can be used to effectively fulfill theatre-maker intentions.

Exploring World Theatre Traditions
This area of the syllabus addresses the authentic exploration of world theatre traditions through academic and practical research and exploration. Students inquire into and physically explore world theatre traditions, performance conventions and performance material from those traditions in order to acquire a deeper understanding and appreciation of the traditions through the body and/or voice.

Collaboratively Creating Original Theatre:

This area of the syllabus addresses the collaborative development and performance of original theatre as part of an ensemble of theatre-makers. Students formulate intentions for theatre-making and examine the ways in which these intentions can be effectively realised through the collaborative creation of original performance work inspired by a starting point.

Performing Theatre Theory (HL only)

This area of the syllabus addresses the exploration of aspects of theatre theory and the ways in which theory can inform performance. Students research at least one theatre theorist, identify an aspect of their theory and apply this to create and present theatre work that demonstrates this aspect of theory in performance.

Theatre Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	70
Task 1: Collaborative Project- Students collaboratively create and perform an original piece of theatre (lasting 7-10 minutes) created from a starting point of their choice. The piece is presented to an audience as a fully realised production. They submit a project report (max.10 pages), source list, and video recording of the final piece.	40
Task 2: Research Presentation –Students plan, deliver and record an individual research presentation (15 minutes maximum) in which they provide evidence of their academic and practical exploration and learning of a world theatre tradition they have not previously studied.	30
Internal Assessment	30
Task 3: Production Proposal – Students choose a published play text they have not previously studied and formulate a vision for the design and theoretical staging of the entire play for an audience. These ideas are presented in the form of a proposal (maximum 12 pages).	30
Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	Weighting
External Examination	80
Task 1: Solo theatre piece - Students research a theatre theorist, identify an aspect(s) of their theory and create and present a solo theatre piece (4–7 minutes) based on this aspect(s) of theory.	35
Task 3: Collaborative Project- Students collaboratively create and perform an original piece of theatre (lasting 7-10 minutes) created from a starting point of their choice. The piece is presented to an audience as a fully realised production. They submit a project report (max.10 pages), source list, and video recording of the final piece.	25
Task 4: Production Proposal - Students choose a published play text they have not previously studied and formulate a vision for the design and theoretical staging of the entire play for an audience. These ideas are presented in the form of a proposal (maximum 12 pages).	20
Internal Assessment	20
Task 2: Research Presentation – Students plan, deliver and record an individual research presentation (15 minutes maximum) in which they provide evidence of their academic and practical exploration and learning of a world theatre traditional they have not previously studied.	20

Visual Arts Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL)



Group 6: The Arts

Course Description

During the two years of the course, students are supported and guided by their teacher to become progressively more independent art practitioners. For this reason, students should enter the course with proficient technical skills in at least two artforms. They learn to create, communicate and connect as artists, engaging in creative processes and learning artmaking as inquiry.

The core syllabus areas are:

- Create
- Connect
- Communicate
- Integration of create, connect & communicate

Throughout the course students are expected to experience working with different artforms such as two and three-dimensional forms, lens-based, electronic and screen-based forms. Personal responses to the investigations of local galleries and exhibitions together with their own studio work is documented in the Visual Arts Journal. First-hand experiences of art are used wherever possible to inform the development of student work.

In addition, students are expected to engage in, experiment with and critically reflect upon a wide range of contemporary practices and innovative use of media.

Distinction Between SL & HL

The Visual Arts syllabus demonstrates a clear distinction between the course at SL and at HL, with additional assessment requirements at HL that allow for breadth and greater depth in the teaching and learning. The assessment tasks require HL students to reflect on how their own work has been influenced by exposure to other artists and for them to experiment in greater depth with additional art-making media, techniques, and forms. SL students produce 5 artworks, HL students select 5 artworks from a larger body of resolved works (8- artworks) and demonstrate a deeper consideration of how their resolved works connect to context and other artists.

Main Topics Covered

(these may vary slightly due to the introduction of the new syllabus)

Year 1

- Prehistoric art and artefacts- Why do humans make art?
- Industrial Revolution and Modernism- How does society shape art?
- Andy Warhol, 'business art' and Pop Art; postmodernism - What comes after art?
- Contemporary Chinese Art: examining art as a form of social and political activism- Where is art going?

Year 2

- The Curator - How does a culture represent itself through choices made about art that is seen in a community?
- 'I AM' an exhibiting artist- How do I present my work to an urban audience through curatorial choices? Where to now? The Future has it- How do artists express their conceptual thesis as exhibiting practitioners?

Visual Arts Standard & Higher Level (SL & HL) (continued)

Assessment Component Information (Standard Level)	Weighting
External Examination	60
Part 1: Art-making inquiries portfolio (32 Marks) Students select and organise visual evidence of their personal investigations, discoveries and creations, supported by critical reflections in a portfolio. They will include the explicit lines of enquiry that informed their artmaking.	40
Part 2: Connections Study (24 Marks) This is an SL-only task whereby the students select one of their resolved artworks and make connections with their context and with two artworks by different artists.	20
Internal Assessment	40
This component is internally assessed by the teacher and externally moderated by the IB at the end of the course. Part 3: Resolved artworks (32 marks) Students submit a coherent collection of 5 resolved artworks showing evidence of a synthesis of concept and form, accompanied by a rationale outlining the choices and intentions which informed their artmaking.	40
Assessment Component Information (Higher Level)	Weighting
External Examination	60
Part 1: Art-making inquiries portfolio (32 marks) Students select and organise visual evidence of their personal investigations, discoveries and creations, supported by critical reflections in a portfolio. They will include the explicit lines of enquiry that informed their artmaking.	30
Part 2: Artist project (40 marks) This is a HL-only task where the students create and situate a single artwork in context that they imagine as part of a project of their choice. They are to demonstrate how they were informed by context, connections with at least two artworks by different artists and by dialogues. A short video curated by the students show where and how the project artwork was realized in relation to context and audience.	30
Internal Assessment	40
This component is internally assessed by the teacher and externally moderated by the IB at the end of the course. Part 3: Selected resolved artworks (40 marks) This is an HL-only task where the students select 5 resolved artworks from a wider production of at least 8 works, to demonstrate their best achievements, communicate their artistic intention and provide evidence of synthesis of concept and form. In addition, a rationale will articulate artistic intentions and explain selection.	40

St Andrew's Cathedral School Outdoor Education OET / Year 13 and Sports Assistants positions

Up to three Outdoor Education Trainee Positions are awarded to graduating Year 12 students. Key aspects of the program include:

- Assisting with the organisation and leading of younger students on outdoor programs;
- Training toward receiving Certificate 3 Qualification in bushwalking, canoeing and abseiling;
- Maintenance of Outdoor Education equipment and assisting in projects at the Kirrikee site;
- A salary is paid, together with \$1000 equipment allowance and travel and food allowances;
- Shared accommodation and food are provided at the school's outdoor education centre 'Kirrikee'.

Sport:

The Sport/PDHPE Department employ up to two graduating Year 12 students for a year working within sport. These students are recognised as Sports Assistants and help with the conduct of sport and PDHPE by organising equipment and attending training and game sessions. The position receives a salary.

In addition, there is the opportunity to receive training for an Australian Strength and Conditioning Level 1 Certification.

Application Process:

Position Descriptions for each role are available in Term 2 each year.

Students are required to apply in writing (during Term 2 of their Year 12 year) to the Head of Outdoor Education for the Outdoor Ed trainee positions or the Head of Sport for graduating students interested in working within the School's Sports Department. All applicants will be interviewed during Term 3 of Year 12. Notification of appointments will be made prior to the end of Term 3.

Sport and Cocurricular Activities

It is compulsory for all students in Years 7 – 11 to participate in an ISA Sport or co-curricular activity during Terms 2 and 3. This involves at least one training session after school during the week and a competition game on Saturdays.

ISA sports are:

Hockey – Girls
Netball – Girls
Rugby – Boys
Soccer – Boys and Girls
Tennis – Boys and Girls

Other activities that can be considered for compulsory co-curricular include:

Fencing
Fit 4 Life
Squash
Water Polo – Boys and Girls
Basketball 1sts Development Team

During Terms 4 and 1, there is an opportunity for any student to be a member of one of the Summer Sports programs. This is an elective program.

ISA Sports are:

Basketball – Boys and Girls
Cricket – Boys
Softball – Girls
Touch Football – Boys and Girls

Other activities that can be considered for summer co-curricular include:

Fencing
Water Polo – Boys and Girls
Non-competitive tennis
Summer Hockey – Boys and Girls
Volleyball
Squash
Senior School Drama Ensemble
Chess
Mock Trial
Theatre Sports

Debating
Skiing
Makerspace
Athletics/Run Fit
Swimming
Brazilian Jiu Jitsu

Carnivals

The school swimming carnival is held in Term 4 and the school athletics carnival is held in Term 2. School representative teams are then selected to compete at the ISA Championships. The school also competes in the ISA Cross Country Carnival in Term 2.



ST ANDREW'S
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